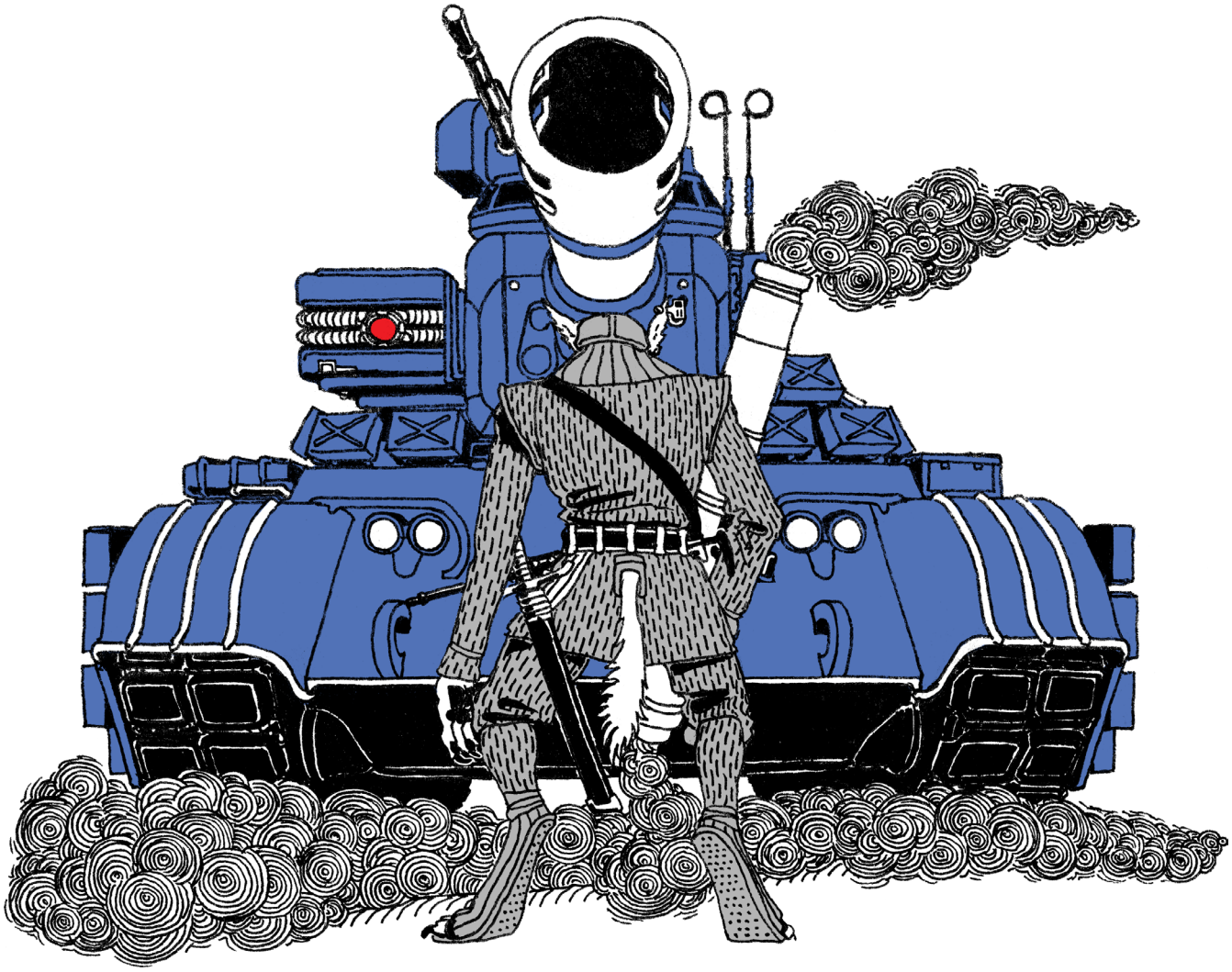
FIRELOCK 198X

FANTASY WARFARE IN THE NUCLEAR AGE



CORE GAMEPLAY RULES

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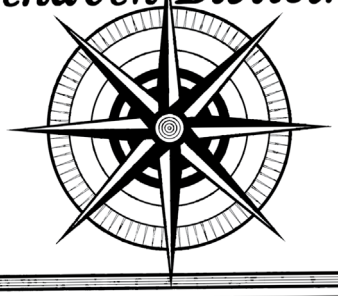

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FIELD MANUAL
No. 1-8X

*** FM 1-8X**
Edition 0.9.8

HEADQUARTERS
DREKFORT M.D.C.
Langport, Vansa, 10/20/86

Core Gameplay Rules

Preface

Firelock 198X is a tabletop wargame about nuclear-age fantasy warfare. It attempts to recreate the broad strokes of Cold War military tactics with unearthly troops. Its rules are meant to provide fast, lethal gameplay, supporting realistic tactics without clunky simulationism.

The game is designed first and foremost to be playable in the real world; it is the hope of the authors that you find it enjoyable to model, paint, and play. A virtual edition of the game is also available via Tabletop Simulator (hereafter "TTS"). Game discussion, organization, art and kitbashing is centered in Stellar Jockeys' Discord server (see the Firelock 198X section).

This ruleset represents a work-in-progress version of the game. Some things may be placeholders, missing, or otherwise subject to change before it's finished. The attached profiles and unit statistics in the TTS module may be slightly outdated at times. If there's a conflict, use what's in the book.

Always remember: it is the spirit of the game, not the letter of the rules, that is important. Not all edge cases can be covered by this manual. Fight well, but mediate with your opponent where such issues arise. If your opponent is joyless, kill him.

The authors express thanks to the community for their continued support and enjoyment of Firelock 198X.

* This manual supersedes FM 1-8X Edition 0.8, 08/24/83.

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GETTING STARTED

The easiest way to learn any tabletop game is to play it with a friend who knows what he's doing. Reading this book thoroughly will help, but there's no substitute for getting your hands on it. Nonetheless, if you're reading, start from the beginning.

Chapter 1 of this manual is a brief overview of the game "in motion", following one example round of play in narrative form (as if you were a spectator). This will help provide context for the following chapters.

Chapters 2 through 6 more fully explain the rules demonstrated in Chapter 1; if you want to get right into the mechanics, skip to Chapter 2. Chapter 7 revisits the example round to show how the rules you have just learned applied, roll-by-roll.

The Appendix sections are highly useful. **APPENDICES A, B, & C**—covering unit and weapon special rules, and terrain types—are particularly important. Glance at them once you've read the rules chapters. When building your first army, **APPENDIX A** and **B** will be useful references, depending on what special rules your troops bring to the table.

Even though much in the way of military technology and tactics is represented in Firelock 198X, we assume no special expertise on your part. **FM 1-8X-3**, the glossary, explains some basic things you might see both in this manual and those of the game's different factions (see **FM 100-1-8X** through **FM 100-4-8X**).

CHAPTER 1

A NARRATIVE ROUND OF FIRELOCK 198X

1. THE COMMANDER SURVEYS THE FIELD

At dawn all was staged and ready. It wasn't much. Capitaine Gevaudan had to his name one working personnel carrier and a little more than a squad of men. The battalion commandant had promised him a little artillery on call. This much was on his mind when he saw the Federal tank.

2. THE CAPITAINE CALLS A MISSION

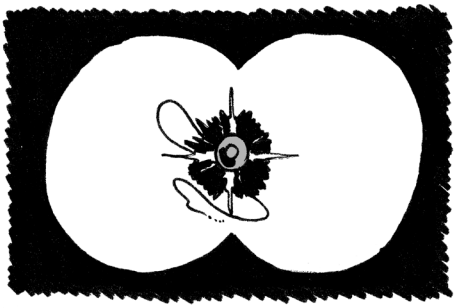
Gevaudan stared at the yawning gun-barrel. This was not in the report. No matter. He growled low into the handset. "Give me smoke. Coordinates to follow."

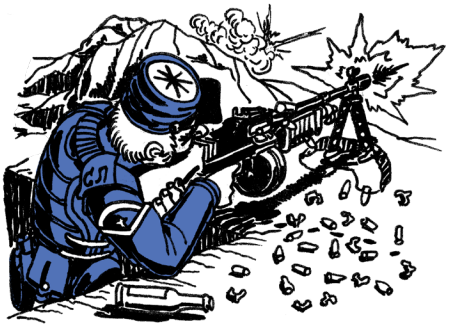
3. SHELLING COMMENCES

Lieutenant Shortstreet was worried about his engine. It'd taken rounds and his driver-mechanic had done what little he could. Somehow the tank clung to life. But it ran damned hot, and it didn't keep its oil. He was thinking about the leaks when the first smoke-shell burst in front of his position. Swearing, he scrambled up the turret and into his cupola.

4. THE SHOOTOUT BEGINS

Dodd, the machine-gunner, was the first to see the crawling beasts in the treeline. He waited for no order to fire. Green tracers cracked out low over the field. He heard, quite distinctly, a furious and painful cry. It was something less than human, more than animal. His blood ran cold.





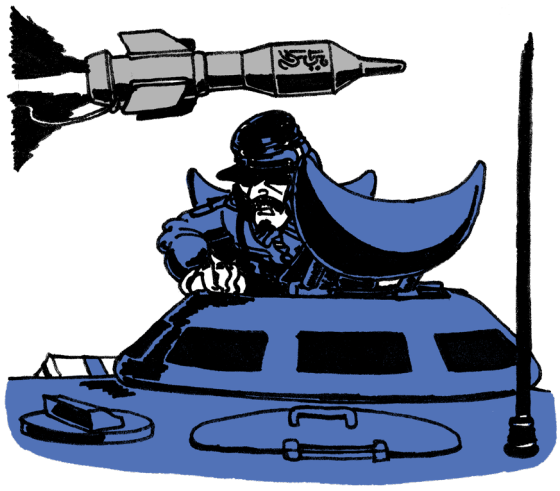
5. FIRE UPON THE TANK

Shortstreet had just ordered a beehive round loaded when his eyes snapped to the right flank. He recoiled at the sight of a trembling red base-fuze: a wire-guided missile coming directly his way. He swore.

6. GUIDING THE MISSILE

Kolaoja was a man of the forest. He had scarcely seen electric lights before being drafted. Now he fought a war he did not understand with weapons he hardly believed could exist. His objective, as he saw it, was to stay alive.

The tank loomed huge and terrible in his missile launcher's reticle. He saw the wide mouth of the gun turn his way. He threw himself down. There was a sound like the whole canopy had been torn away above him.



7. THE MISSILE LANDS

In dragoon officer's school they had beaten into Shortstreet's head that beehives round contained ten thousand flechettes. Ten thousand steel needles, of which most would go to waste in the spread. All he needed was for one to find its mark.

The missile jerked. Shortstreet ducked. The rocket motor howled in his ear and he felt a flash of heat. Then there was an explosion. He blinked. He was not dead.

It'd lasted maybe ten seconds in all; but still too long. Somewhere in the treeline a personnel carrier had stolen up. It was pouring fat half-inch bullets into his infantry's positions. The green tracers stopped.

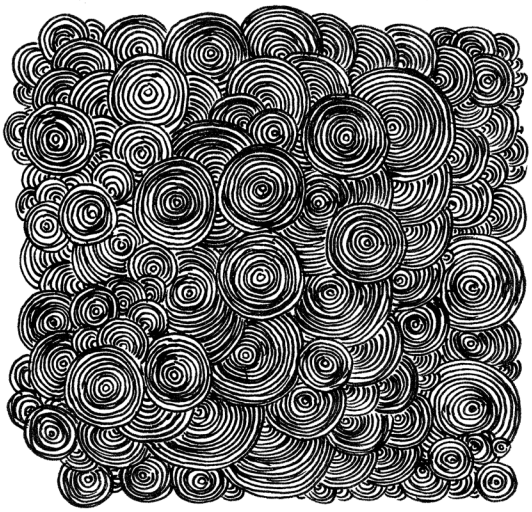
8. THE CARRIER IS KILLED

As soon as he saw the fire-mouth in the woods, Van Hall swung about the recoilless rifle. He had been thorough, ranging out the treeline, walking the sector. It took only a moment to lay the sights on target. The machine gun abruptly fell silent. The dim glow of guttering flames welled through the leaves.

9. SMOKE FILLS THEIR VISION

Gevaudan watched the smoke swallow up the Federal tank. It was one of the lighter machines, without the accursed thermal sights. The wind was picking up and the gun would need to relocate soon. Now or never.

He withdrew a grenade from his belt, wrapped with a purple stripe. It was light, aerodynamic. He wound up like a Langport pitcher and let fly. Even on its whistling arc up and out he caught the chemical smell of the "signal salt" inside. Every fighting lupar was drilled to recognize the laboratory stench. It meant the order to attack.



10. THE CHARGE

Zellner only dimly recognized his rifle in his hands. He stared at the chasseur loping toward him, insensate to the fire crossing both ways. Had someone picked up the machine gun? How many bullets were in his magazine? The questions intruded from far away.

The monster loomed in the iron sights, close and far at the same time. His fingertip wrapped around the trigger and he slowly let out his breath. Then a grenade burst outside his hole and he ducked. There came a howling and roaring that seemed to be from all around him. He swore and unfolded the pigsticker bayonet. He leapt up and faced the whirlwind.

1-4 - A NARRATIVE ROUND OF FIRELOCK 198X

CHAPTER 2

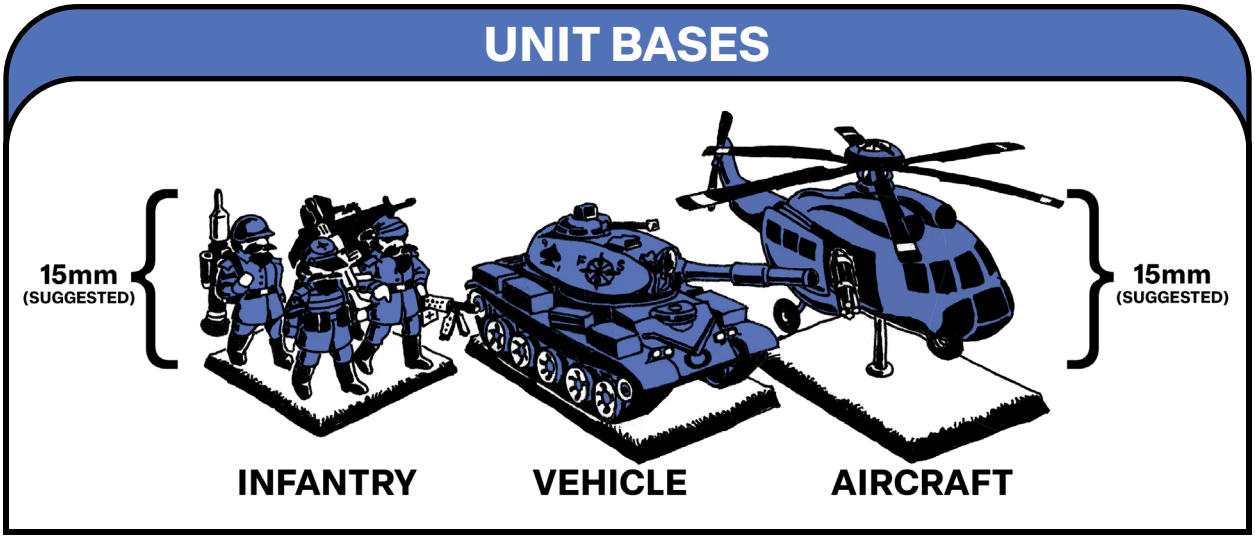
BASIC CONCEPTS

This chapter lays out the underlying concepts of the game: units, dice rolls and target numbers, line of sight and vision, and other necessary underpinnings.

UNITS

Firelock 198X is a game about battles between opposing forces of miniature soldiers on your tabletop. Your force may vary in size and composition, but for simplicity's sake, it's referred to as your **army**, regardless of size. (The average Firelock 198X army is somewhere around the size of a company task force: some infantry squads with personnel carriers, a few tanks, and various other support weapons.) Your army is made up of individual **units**, the roster of which is your **army list**. Each unit represents a group of **infantry**, one **vehicle**, or one **aircraft**.

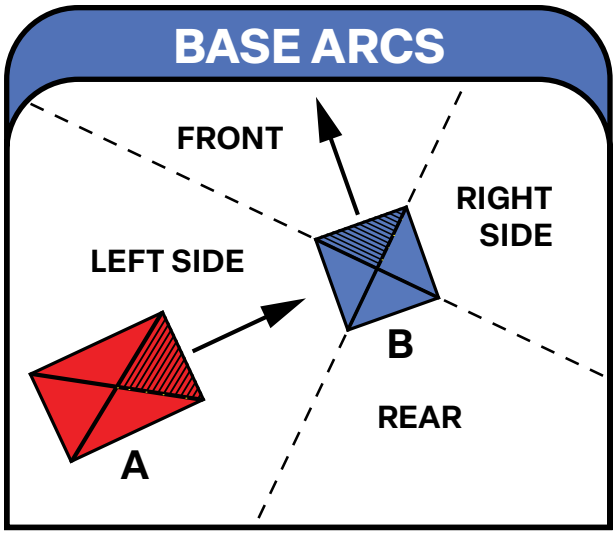
Whether you represent your men with painted models or paper standees, your units must be mounted on **bases**. These are what are important for gameplay purposes, not the physical models standing atop them. Infantry bases are 40mm x 40mm squares; aircraft and vehicles are 40mm x 60mm rectangles. Some units have special base sizes, and are marked accordingly.



BASE ARCS

Every unit base is either a square or rectangle. So, it can be divided crosswise into four triangles. Draw an X over the base, from the corners and through the exact center. You now have four **base arcs**: a **front**, two **sides**, and a **rear**. You can extend the lines of the X all the way across the table to determine which arc another unit is in.

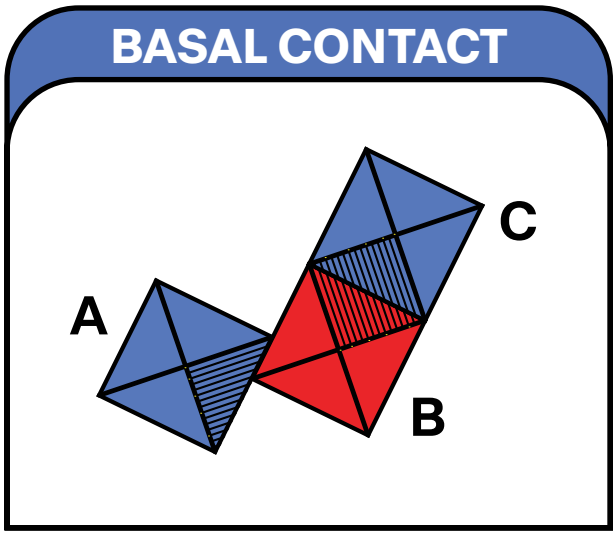
If a unit faces another unit (for instance, a target for its attack), it's facing whatever arc of that target that its own base mostly occupies. If it looks about 50/50, go for the arc that's closer to the front of the target.



Unit A is facing the left side arc of Unit B.

BASAL CONTACT

Basal contact is when any part of one unit's base touches any part of another unit's. **Full basal contact** is when all of one full arc is touching another unit's base.



Units A and C are in basal contact with Unit B. Unit C is in full basal contact with Unit B.

ROLLS & TARGET NUMBERS

Most actions are uncertain (such as whether a shot hits its target), so the outcome is resolved by rolling dice. All dice used in the game are six-sided ("D6"). Sometimes, to simulate a three-sided dice ("D3"), you'll have to roll a dice, halve its result, and round up.

All rolls attempt to meet or beat a **target number** expressed by the notation "X+", where X is the number the roll must meet or exceed for success. If the target number is 4+, for example, a roll of 4, 5, or 6 is a success.

MODIFIERS

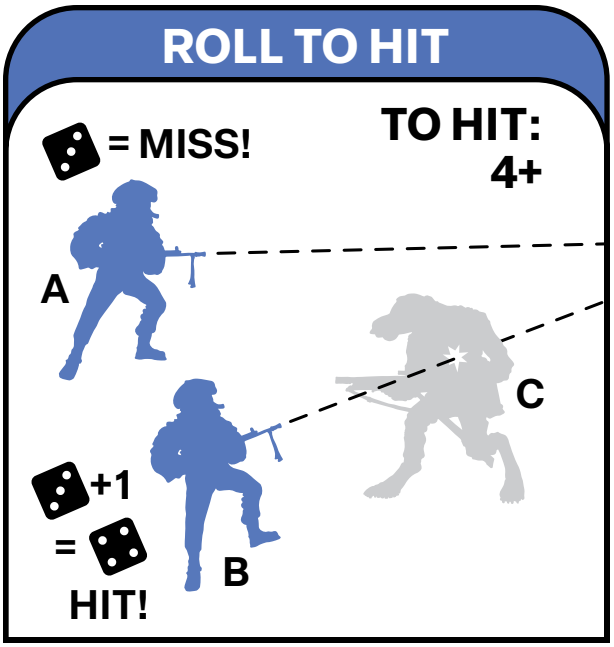
Rolls can be subject to **modifiers**. Modifiers are expressed by the notation "+X" or "-X", where X is the amount by which the die result is shifted. Modifiers are cumulative, and can cancel each other out.

Modifiers can potentially push a roll with uncertain odds of success into absolutely *certain* success or failure. For instance, a roll with a target number of 2+, with an additional +1 modifier, will *always* succeed.

A target number of "1+" means that a roll automatically succeeds if there are no negative modifiers involved. A target of "++" is treated as a 1+, but it *cannot* be modified (i.e. it will always succeed), unless otherwise specified.

MULTIPLE DICE

Often, multiple dice are simultaneously rolled (e.g. for machine gun fire), with a common target number and modifiers. The die results are separate, *not* cumulative. Two dice rolled in one attack means two separate chances, individually modified, to hit or kill.

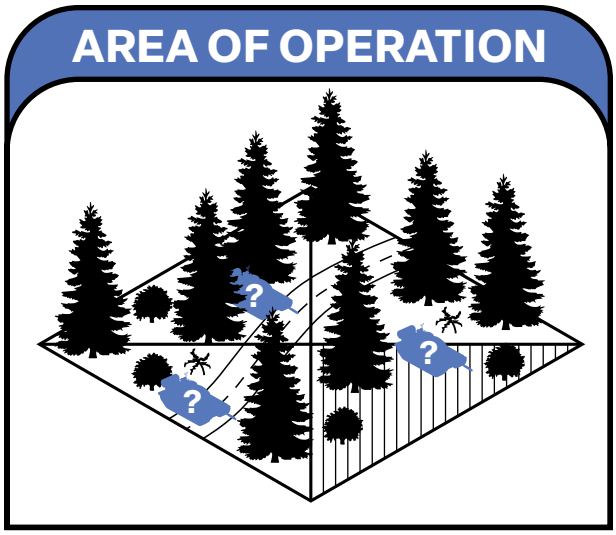


Units A and Unit B are firing on Unit C. Both have a base accuracy of 4+ to hit, but Unit B benefits from a +1 modifier. Both units roll a 3. Unit A misses, but Unit B's modifier turns his result into a 4, making it a hit.

CONFIRMING ACTIONS

Sometimes, if an action is very difficult, a successful roll must be **confirmed**, i.e. re-rolled. The action is only successful if both the initial roll and the confirmation re-roll succeed. Confirmation re-rolls are rolled at the same target number, unless stated otherwise.

A die only ever confirms once. You never have to "re-roll a re-roll".



All units are much smaller in actuality than their prescribed base, or "area of operation". They may be positioned anywhere inside of the area of operation at any time. A single tank could be imagined to exist in any one of the above positions. Remember this when shooting at units partially obscured by terrain!

DISTANCE

All distances in Firelock 198X are measured in inches. You can measure anything on the table at any time. Measurements need not be more precise than a tenth of an inch.

The distances used in Firelock 198X are semi-abstract. For calculating weapon ranges, 1" to 50 meters was used; so, a 6' long table spans about 3.6 kilometers. Ignore that whenever it doesn't make sense, such as on bases.

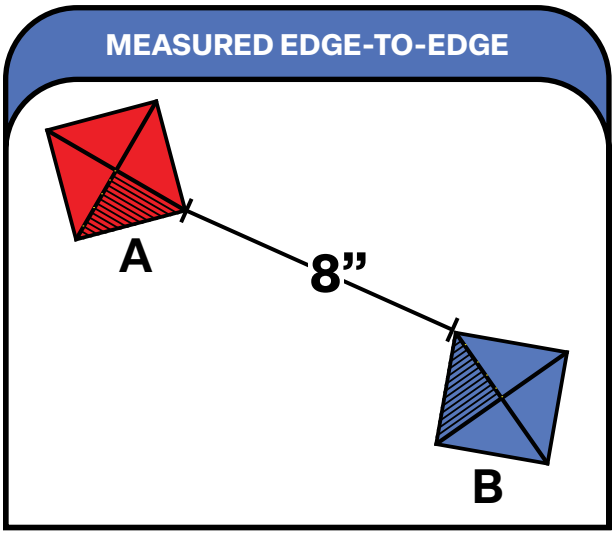
Bases represent a unit's general **area of operation**, not its exact dimensions. That will be important when determining arcs of fire.

MEASUREMENT

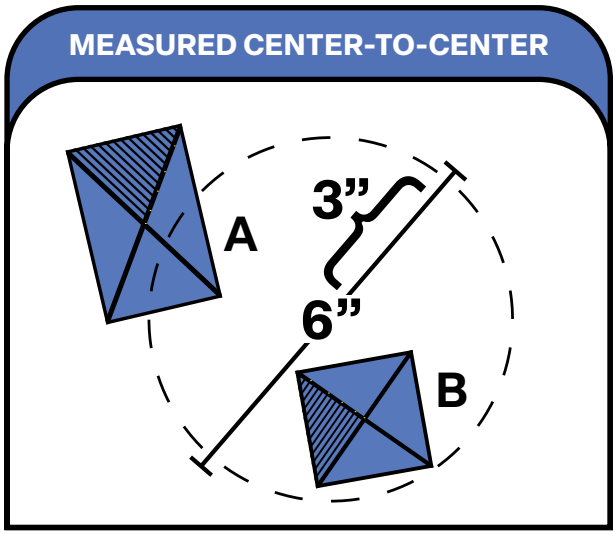
Measurement between bases is done in two ways. Normally, you measure **edge-to-edge**. Choose *any point* on the *edge* of one unit's base, and draw a line toward *any point* on the *edge* of your target's base.

When measuring from a radius, you instead measure **center-to-center**. Draw a line from the exact center of the radius to the exact center of the target's base, or **base center.**

If a model protrudes over its base in a way that makes measuring from it annoying, use its own edges (within reason).



Unit A and Unit B are 8" apart from each other at the closest points on the edges of their bases.



Unit A and B are under artillery fire with a 3" radius of effect (i.e. a 6" diameter). The center of Unit A's base is not within 3" of the radius's center, but Unit B's is. Only Unit B can be hit.

LINE OF SIGHT

Units on the table are not always visible to one another, due to terrain. A unit is said to have **line of sight ("LOS")** to a target if you can draw an unbroken edge-to-edge line between their bases. LOS is *always* mutual. LOS isn't broken by unit bases, but it can be broken by terrain.

When LOS is broken by something it's called **occlusion**. Terrain tall enough to potentially break LOS between units (i.e. cause occlusion) is called **occluding terrain**.

SPOTTING

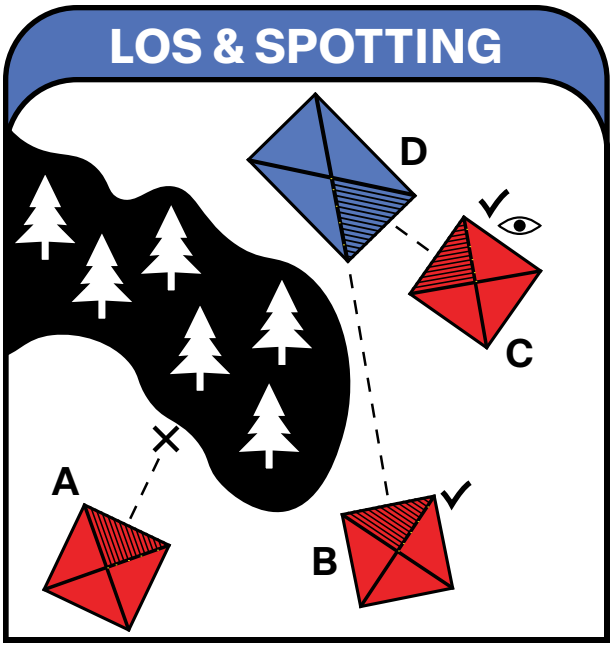
Even if you have LOS to a target, terrain may make it difficult to see that target clearly. All units possess a **spotting distance** in inches. This is the distance within which a unit can clearly distinguish a target against the surrounding terrain, allowing both positive target identification and accurate fire against it. At this distance (and closer), the target is **spotted**. Unless otherwise stated, all units in your army share spotting.

Spotting is measured along the same line as LOS. This means that when you draw LOS, you merely have to see if the distance of the LOS line is equal to or less than the unit's spotting distance.

In short: LOS is whether your shots can possibly reach the enemy at all; spotting is whether you can see him, and thus accurately fire on him, or direct a friendly unit's fire.

A unit can deliberately choose *not* to spot an enemy.

You can check spotting and LOS between units whenever you want. If spotting becomes difficult to read at a glance, placing **spotting tokens** on spotted units is helpful.



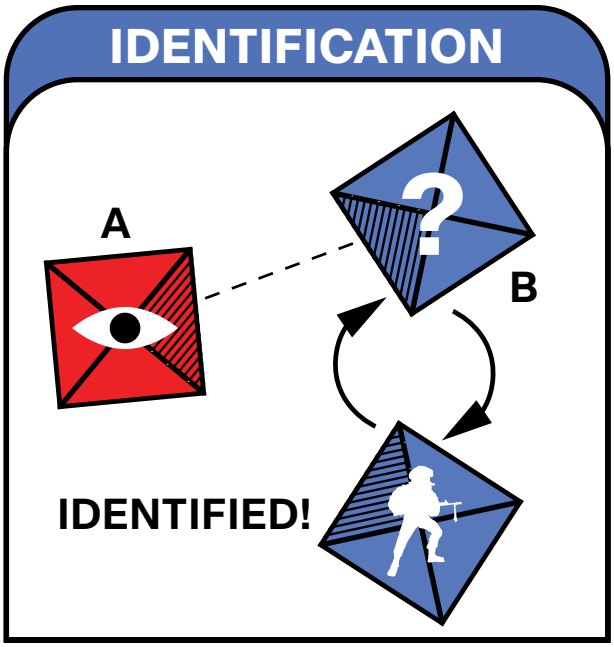
Units A, B, and C are attempting to spot Unit D. Unit A's LOS is broken by an occluding forest. Unit B can draw LOS, but is too far away to spot Unit D. Unit C is within its spotting distance of Unit D and can draw LOS to it. Only Unit C could spot Unit D, but now Unit D counts as spotted for A and B too.

BLINDS & IDENTIFICATION

When the game begins, the opposing armies are mutually **unidentified**. Neither side knows what exactly the other has brought. Every unit in your army should be accompanied by a **blind**. A blind is an "empty" base of the same dimensions as the "real" unit it corresponds to. For example, an infantry blind would be a 40mm x 40mm base with no models on it.

Each blind should have a way to uniquely identify it (a number, letter, callsign, et cetera). Before the game, write a secret **army key** to tie each blind to the unit it corresponds to. Don't let your opponent see your key!

When a blind is spotted by the enemy, it's permanently **identified**. Replace the blind where it stands with the real unit it corresponds to. This is called **revealing** the unit.



Unit A spots Blind B, identifying it. Blind B is removed from the table and replaced by the unit it was representing, Unit B. Unit B is now permanently identified. It will not become a blind again for the rest of the game, even if it's no longer spotted by any enemy.

CHAPTER 3

UNIT CLASSES, WEAPONS, & EMPLACEMENTS

This chapter describes the behavior of different types of units, their statistics, and weapons.

UNIT CLASSES

The fundamental abilities and behaviors of a unit are described by its **unit class**: infantry, vehicle, or aircraft. All units in Firelock 198X fall into one of these three basic classes.

INFANTRY *(Inf)*

Infantry are dismounted troops, marching and fighting on foot. They come as either **teams** of a few men or larger **squads**. Squads are abbreviated as *Inf (S)* on their unit profile. Otherwise (i.e. *Inf*), the unit is a team.

The first time a squad suffers a successful **kill** (see **CHAPTER 4 — II. FIRE PHASE, p. 5-6**), it is instead considered to be **depleted**: shot to team-size. It gains a **depletion token**. Thereafter, it counts as a team for all purposes.

All infantry units can **sprint**, **go to ground** to seek cover, and **clear** emplacements such as landmines. Importantly, they are the only class of unit that can **capture** objectives.

Infantry are generally cheaper, slower, and less powerful than vehicles or aircraft, but they are stealthier, more effective at crossing rough terrain, and more tenacious in cover.

VEHICLES *(Vec)*

The vehicle class covers all forms of fighting or logistics machines, including towed guns. Vehicles can either be **tracked**, **wheeled**, or gun **carriages**. Wheeled and carriage vehicles are abbreviated *Vec (W)* and *Vec (C)* respectively. Otherwise (i.e. *Vec*), a vehicle is tracked.

Wheeled vehicles can perform a **road dash**, moving faster on roads than tracked vehicles, at the cost of worse off-road performance.

Carriage vehicles are typically slow, but may move and rotate freely like infantry, giving them more leeway in rough terrain.

Vehicles are almost always much faster, tougher, and more heavily armed than infantry. In return, they are harder to conceal and may be targeted with more powerful weapons.

Vehicles cannot capture objectives on their own. They can, however, **contest** an objective, preventing enemies from capturing it.

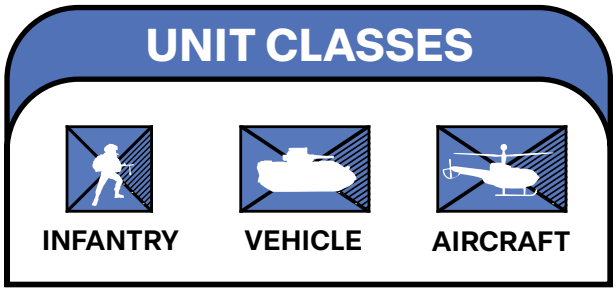
AIRCRAFT *(Air)*

The aircraft class includes **helicopters** and fixed-wing **planes**. Helicopters are abbreviated as *Air*; planes as either *Air (CAP)* or *Air (CAS)*. Like infantry and vehicles, they exist on the table throughout the match. Planes can only enter the table if they are called in via **support cards**. Planes will be described further later in this chapter.

Helicopters are highly mobile. They are very fast, can **take off** or **land**, and can easily obtain superior positions and vantage over other units. They are hard to hit by ground weapons that are not specialized against aircraft, but in turn are extremely vulnerable to dedicated anti-aircraft (AA) weapons.

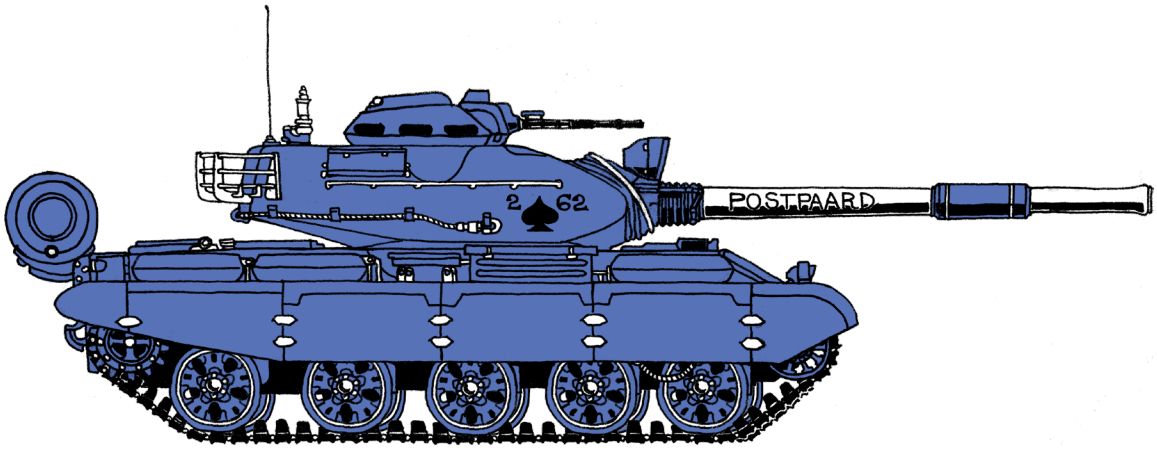
Aircraft can neither capture nor contest an objective. They can flatten its defenders, but you need boots on the ground to seize it.

This chapter covers unit behaviors only in broad overview. Precise game mechanics will be explained in-depth throughout the **PHASE** sections of **CHAPTER 4**, then recapped in **APPENDICES E, F, & G**.



UNIT CARDS

A unit's behavior in combat—including its basic characteristics, weaponry, and any special rules—is fully described by its **unit card**. Featured below is an example: the Federal States-Army's Type 71 "Tusker-K" main battle tank. This war machine is powerful on open ground.



Here is the Tusker-K's unit card:

TYPE 71 "TUSKER-K" - *50 pts*

MAIN BATTLE TANK

Vec, H2, S32", M8", Q3, T16/8/6

NBC, Steel Watchbands

6GZ1 14.5mm HMG
All, R24", A4+/5+, S3/4, D2, *Turret*

2K43 115mm Gun
R40", A2+/3+, D1, Ammo 4, *No CC (Inf.), Thermal Sights, Turret*

→ ***115mm Sabot***
Vec, S14/21

→ ***115mm HEAT***
Inf/Vec, S12/2, *Slow Round, Shaped Charge*

902V 81mm Smoke Launchers
Gnd, R6", A++/++, D2, Ammo 1, *Light Indirect (1), No CC, Smoke (3"), Turret*

FEDERAL STATES-ARMY - DREKFORT M.D.C.

We'll go over it from top to bottom.

TYPE 71 "TUSKER-K" - *50 pts*

MAIN BATTLE TANK

Vec, H2, S32", M8", Q3, T16/8/6

NBC, Steel Watchbands

The Tusker-K costs 50 **points ("pts")**. The more points, the stronger the unit. The subheading (MAIN BATTLE TANK) indicates the unit's role. The bolded **unit statline** describes the unit's combat statistics.

Unit Class: This unit is a vehicle (Vec).

Height (H): The higher the statistic, the taller the unit. This unit has Height 2.

Spotting Distance (S): This unit can spot at 32".

Move (M): The number of inches the unit can move (before terrain multipliers) in one turn.

Quality (Q): The higher the statistic, the better the unit's discipline and nerve. This unit is Q3.

Toughness (T): Three numbers indicating the unit's resilience to damage on its front (16), side (8), and rear (6) arcs respectively.

Generic **special rules** (see **APPENDICES A & B**) are *italicized*. Faction-specific rules, such as *Steel Watchbands*, are also underlined.

6GZ1 14.5mm HMG
All, R24", A4+/5+, S3/4, D2
Turret

This is a **weapon statline**, describing one of the weapons mounted to this unit: the 6GZ1 14.5mm heavy machine gun (HMG).

Target: A list of all unit classes that this weapon can be used against.

- **All:** May target all unit classes.
- **Inf/Vec/Air:** May target only the listed unit classes.
- **Gnd:** May target a point on the ground, and all Inf & Vec in the listed *Radius*.

This weapon can target any unit, since it's All-targeting.

Range (R): The weapon's range in inches. It can't be fired outside this range. All weapons also have a **half range** that is half of this value.

This weapon has a 24" range, and thus a 12" half range.

Accuracy (A): Two target numbers, indicating the stationary and moving accuracies of the weapon, respectively. All weapons get a +1 Accuracy modifier at half range unless otherwise stated.

This weapon hits targets on a 4+ when fired stationary, and a 5+ when fired moving. At half range, it gets +1 to either roll.

Strength (S): Two numbers indicating the weapon's firepower. The second number is the weapon's **half range Strength**; i.e. weapons get stronger at closer ranges. Some weapons, depending on their special rules, use their second number in a different way.

This weapon is Strength 3 at 24", and Strength 4 at 12" and under.

Dice (D): The number of dice rolled per attack. More dice means more lead in the air. Each die is a separate, independent chance to hit and/or kill the same target.

This weapon rolls two dice per attack—i.e. two 4+ or 5+ rolls to hit the same target.

As with units, weapons have **weapon special rules** (see **APPENDIX B**). This weapon has the *Turret* special rule.

As with unit special rules, any underlined weapon special rules are faction-specific. Both faction-specific unit and weapon special rules can be found in their factions' manuals.

2K43 115mm Gun
R40", A2+/3+, D1, Ammo 4,
No CC (Inf.), Thermal Sights, Turret
→ ***115mm Sabot***
Vec, S14/21
→ ***115mm HEAT***
Inf/Vec, S12/2, *Slow Round, Shaped Charge*

A weapon may only fire as many times as it has **Ammo**. Limited ammunition is indicated by the presence of an Ammo statistic. If it doesn't have one, the weapon has **unlimited** ammunition. You can track a weapon's Ammo with a D6, since the statistic never exceeds six.

Only one unit of Ammo is consumed per attack, even if the weapon has a Dice statistic of more than one. When the weapon's Ammo runs out, mark the unit with a **spent ammo token**. Ammo is tracked as a single value per weapon, regardless of which shot types are used for each attack.

Shot types for a weapon are bolded and italicized, then indented beneath their weapon with an arrow (→). Only the characteristics common to all shot types are retained in the weapon's own statline. The shot types' partial statlines indicate their unique characteristics.

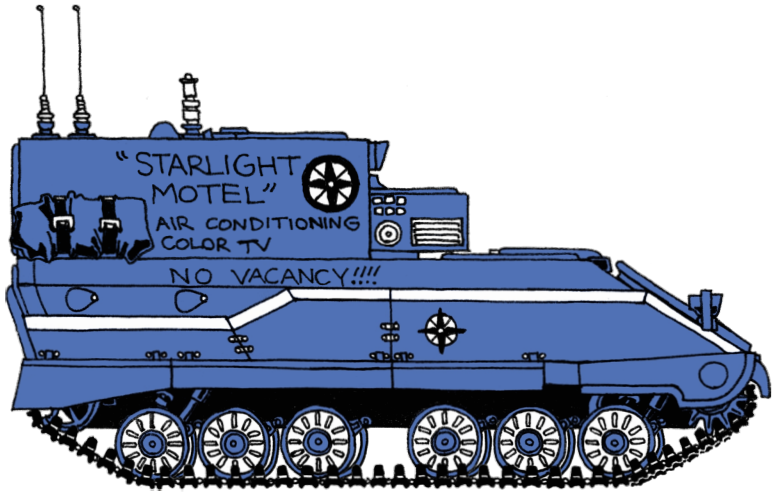
Shot types may have weapon special rules associated with them in particular. For example, the ***115mm HEAT*** shot type has the *Shaped Charge* special rule.

902V 81mm Smoke Launchers
Gnd, R6", A++/++, D2, Ammo 1,
Light Indirect (1), No CC, Smoke (3"), Turret

This weapon's Target statistic is Gnd; therefore, it is **ground-targeting**. It may automatically strike any point on the ground within its range, assuming it or a friendly unit can spot that point on the table.

TACOMS

Every army is led by at least one **tactical command unit ("TACOM")**. You must field one TACOM for every 100 points in your army list. Every faction offers several TACOMs, of which at least one is free. Featured below is an example TACOM: the Federal Type 68C "Appomattox".



TACOMs, like normal units, have a unit card (partially shown below) and a statline:

TYPE 68C "APPOMATTOX" - *0 pts*
COMMAND POST CARRIER

Vec, H2, S32", M8", Q3, T6/4/4, C3
Amphibious, Brigade (3, 12"), NBC

TACOMs have one important addition to their statline: the **Command (C)** statistic. This indicates how many command tokens they generate each round, spent to move your troops and leverage support weapons. They also always have the *Brigade* special rule which is crucial for coordinated maneuvers.

Brigade and command tokens will be explained in **CHAPTER 5**.

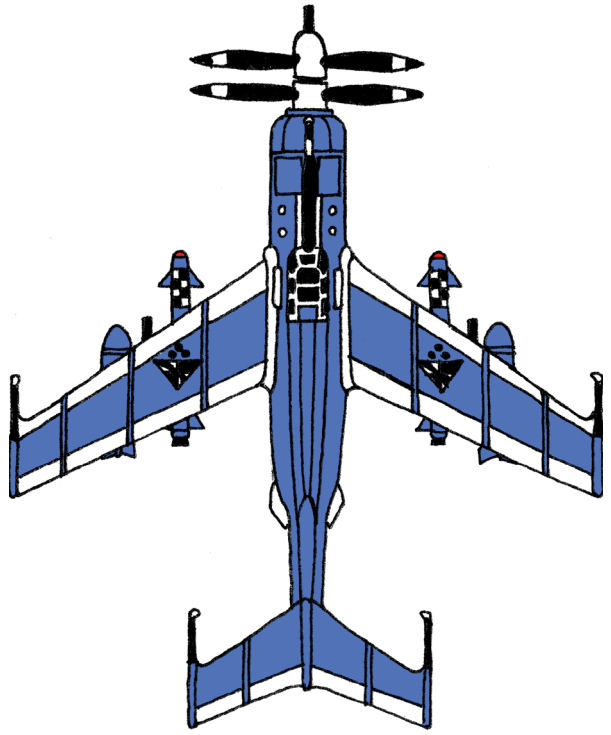
LOSING TACOMS

Losing a TACOM means losing the command tokens it generates. If you lose all of your TACOMs, your force's cohesion is shattered. At the end of the current round, if not otherwise dictated by the battle scenario, any player with no surviving TACOMs will lose. (If nobody has any remaining TACOMs, it's a tie.)

TACOMs must be exposed to risk to effectively coordinate your army's maneuvers and support weapons. Their potential is wasted if you leave them hidden in deep cover. You must carefully balance protecting and leveraging them.

PLANES

Once a plane is called onto the table to fulfill a support mission, it can target enemies and be targeted like any other unit. Featured below is an example plane: the Federal SiG-16 "Rufe". This aging turboprop fighter-bomber is kitted out for both ground attack and air-to-air roles.



Planes have unit cards, but their statlines are simpler than those of ground units.

SiG-16 "RUFE" - *20 pts*

MULTI-ROLE FIGHTER

Air (CAP), M10", Q2, T4, E1

Sprint Motor

2A34 23mm Autocannons, triplet
All, R8", A4+, S4, D3, Ammo 3
4BN2 350kg Napalm Bomb
Gnd, R0", A3+, S1+, D2, Ammo 2
Barrage (2), Ignore Cover (2), Lingering, Radius (2"), Rear Attack
9GR4 120mm Infrared AAM
Air, R24" A4+, S6, D1, Ammo 2
Air-Filling, Guided Missile (1), Homing

FEDERAL STATES-ARMY - DREKFORT M.D.C.

All planes belong to the Air unit class. They are marked either **CAS (close air support)** or **CAP (combat air patrol)**. Remember: if it's just Air, and not *Air (CAP)* or *Air (CAS)*, it's a helicopter. That is, planes are a special category of aircraft.

Planes lack a Spotting Distance statistic. On the terminal approach, they don't have the time to find a target! Since spotting is shared between friendlies, you must use ground units or helicopters to guide them in.

Planes only have one Toughness stat, reflecting their armoring across all arcs. Similarly, they have only one (moving) Accuracy statistic for their weapons, and, unless required by a special rule, have only one Strength statistic.

Planes have a unique **Evasion** statistic. The higher the Evasion, the more maneuverable the plane, making it more adept at evading incoming fire and in dogfighting. At E1, the Rufe is sluggish by modern combat standards.

CALLING IN PLANES

Planes begin the battle in **reserve**—flying somewhere off the table and awaiting strike orders from your TACOMs. Once called in, they enter the table, seeking a specific ground or air target they have been ordered to intercept. If they are not shot down, they then move back off the table and return to reserve.

Full rules for how planes are called in, how they move and how they fight are in **CHAPTER 5**.

EMPLACEMENTS

Depending on the battle scenario, they may be static **emplacements** on the field. These can be active, hazardous **traps** (like landmines) or defensive **fortifications** (like rifle pits).

Traps have weapon statlines with a listed *Radius*. Featured below is an example trap: Federal "Torpedo" wooden anti-personnel landmines.

APM4 "TORPEDOES"

ANTI-PERSONNEL MINES

Trap

APM4 "Torpedo" Wooden Mine
Inf, A++, S1, D1, Ammo 6,
Radius (4"), Rear Attack, Undetectable

Whenever a unit enters the trap's listed *Radius*, the trap is **triggered**, targeting that unit and ignoring all Cover Modifiers (see **CHAPTER 6**). Traps cannot be spotted or identified from beyond 6".

Fortifications modify the terrain they're deployed on. Featured below is an example fortification: Federal rifle pits.

1F15 MVI "RIFLE PITS"

HASTY FORTIFICATION

Fortification

Designate a 40mm x 40mm square of terrain as "rifle pits", which offers -1 Cover Modifier to infantry. Cannot be placed on terrain which already has a Cover Modifier, but units inside can go to ground to gain a -2 Cover Modifier. Vehicles may traverse this terrain at no penalty.

Emplacements can start revealed or as blinds, depending on the scenario. All emplacements have Height 1 for spotting and terrain occlusion purposes; they are subject to normal rules regarding LOS.

DUMMIES

A **dummy** is a blind that doesn't correspond to any real unit. They represent both battlefield uncertainties (the "fog of war") and deliberate ruses-of-war. Dummies cost 5 points and can have the base size of any unit class.

Dummies cannot spot. (Remember: you can choose not to spot with a real unit, either!). If a dummy is identified by an enemy, it's immediately removed from play.

GIVING INFORMATION ABOUT UNITS

Most information about units, such as their remaining Ammo, is tracked on the table with dice and tokens. Thus, all players can see such information for identified units. Information tied to dummies and blinds, however, doesn't always have to be revealed.

The only things an enemy always gets to know about a blind is:

- Its height,
- Whether it is landed or airborne,
- Whether it has units desanting on it,
- How much pin it has.

These are explained in **CHAPTER 5.**

Aside from these facts, you needn't reveal anything about your blinds. Measuring ranges from multiple units, deceptively aggressive placements of weak units, and other mind-games are useful to keep the enemy guessing as to your disposition.

CHAPTER 4

BUILDING TABLES, ARMIES & BATTLE SCENARIOS

This chapter describes how to build army lists and write your own combat scenarios.

MATERIALS FOR PLAY

Firelock 198X is designed for play with simple, easily-procured materials. While best played with painted models and sculpted tabletop terrain, the game at minimum only needs distinguishable regions of terrain and unit bases of the correct sizes. It can be played with cardboard cutouts on a dry-erase board, or with construction paper unit bases, fields, and forests.

Comprehensive lists of all necessary game materials, and possible terrain types, are provided in **APPENDICES C & D**. Use these as resources when preparing for a game or building a table.

MAPS & TERRAIN

Terrain is *extremely* important in Firelock 198X, as in real combat! It provides cover for troops, blocks sightlines, and makes gameplay more interesting in general.

While terrain should ideally be represented with modelled regions, it only needs to be visually distinct from other terrain to actually work. Firelock 198X can thus be played on a completely flat table. We call a table's complete set of terrain features its **map**, because the top-down terrain on such a flat table resembles one.

The suggested size of a Firelock 198X map is 72" x 48" (6' x 4'). Maps with sizes below 48" on any side are not recommended except for small and infantry-centric battles. Larger maps are possible, but may be awkward to move units on closer to the center.

Terrain rules are fully explained in **CHAPTER 6**.

POINT CAPS

Firelock 198X is designed to be played at five **point caps**—a fixed number of points given to each player to spend on units and army support elements before the battle. Two armies that cost the same number of points are theoretically equal in capability, even if one is more numerous than the other.

The list of point caps (and the number of TACOMs you can field) is as follows. Note that you cannot field more or less TACOMs than the scale permits, unless otherwise stated.

Border Skirmish: 100 points, 1 TACOM

Escalation: 200 points, 2 TACOMs

Conventional Battle: 300 points, 3 TACOMs

Grand Battle: 400 points, 4 TACOMs

Mass Casualty Event: 500 points, 5 TACOMs

100 points is appropriate for an introductory or speed game; 200 for pick-up games. 300 points is a good "standard" game size, at which well-rounded combined arms lists are easy to make. 400 point battles and above are complex and highly tactical, but can be time-consuming for newer players.

If using point caps not divisible by 100, it's best to "round up" for the purpose of fielding TACOMs. For example, at 150 points, field two TACOMs instead of one.

Nothing stops you from playing with an arbitrary points cap, but 100-500 are ideal.

SELECTING A FACTION

To begin building an army, you must choose its **faction**. Each faction's **field manual** describes its roster of units, its strengths and weaknesses, and faction-specific special rules.

An overview of the available factions and their field manuals is given on the following pages.

THE FEDERAL STATES-ARMY (F.S-A.)

FIELD MANUAL NO. 100-1-8X

"RUSTING THUNDER"

GOOD GRUNTS - TOUGH TANKS - BAD FLYERS

I can still see it when I close my eyes.

It's a beautiful day. The diesel's roaring, shaking the whole tank, a deafening, juddering clatter. I'm welded by my feet, a fixture of the open hatch. The rushing air is biting my oily face, rubbing it red, but the warmth of the steel runs through my bracing hands and up my spine. I'll roll on. I'll never die.

- Rayleigh Irving, Federal Intelligence

PERSONNEL:

ACTIVE DUTY	1,197,800
READY RESERVE	954,100
ARTICLE 49ERS	1,272,700
AIR CORPS	386,000
IRREGULAR MILITIA (est.)	1,209,000

TANK ACE RECORDS:

KILLS IN CAREER	102
KILLS IN ONE ACTION	16
MEN TRAMPLED	7
LUPAR TRAMPLED	31
MISSIONS SOBER	9

LEADING CAUSES OF PENAL SERVICE (% OF YEARLY DRAFT):

LARCENY	1.5%
INDECENCY	1.7%
BOOTLEGGING	1.8%
ASSAULT	2.1%

ARMY OF THE EBON FOREST (A.E.F.)

FIELD MANUAL NO. 100-2-8X

"TOOTH, CLAW, AND ATGM"

SHOCKTROOPS - CHEAP RIDES - SHARP PILOTS

The earth heaves underfoot. A man cries out: One of ours? Theirs? I can no longer tell. A thousand different stenches and sounds assault my nose and ears. Distantly I feel my weapon pounding against my shoulder. My mouth is watering. I am bleeding and it is a rich iron smell. I must not stop running. There are dead men sprawled here and I know that if I lie down I will gnaw at their exposed faces.

- Conchar Goronwy, Chasseur, 96e Inf.

PERSONNEL (EST.):

ACTIVE DUTY (REGULAR)	360,000
ACTIVE DUTY (IRREGULAR)	410,000
SECURITY FORCES	50,000
THEORETICAL MANPOWER	2,000,000

LUPARIC PRISON TIME SCHEDULE (CONDENSED):

WAKE UP	5:00 AM
ROLL CALL/BREAKFAST	5:15 AM
WORK	6:00 AM
CASUALTY RECOVERY/SUPPER	8:00 PM
LIGHTS OUT	9:00 PM

LEADING CASUALTY INFLICTORS (CYDOLAND FRONT):

SHELL, GRENADE FRAGMENTS	31%
SMALL ARMS	24%
MACHETE, TEETH, CLAWS	19%
LANDMINES & BOOBY TRAPS	14%

THE NEW RYGOLIC HOST (N.R.H.)

FIELD MANUAL NO. 100-3-8X

"STATELESS ORGAN"

HIGH QUALITY - HIGH SPEED - HIGH PRICES

[21]Erst of the hour the marchers will teem as ants from the hide of their tower. [22]At the 5th minute they will sign to the citizens to gather. [23]At the 10th minute the citizens will receive their jobs by symbols. [24]At the 15th minute their jobs will have been signed. [25]You will know the marchers by the black of their eyes. [26]The marchers are mine and it is by them that I will keep the time. [27]I will prove they are mine by the 20th minute.

- The Master Brain's Dicta, Monstrations 5

MATERIEL (EST.):

CONSTRUCTS (HUMANOID). 100,000
CONSTRUCTS (VEHICLE) 25,000
CONSTRUCTS (AIRCRAFT) 5,000
DRONES. 30,000

PILOTS MISSING IN N.R.H. AIRSPACE:

CPT. THOM WATERVLIET . . . . . 15 DAYS
MAJ. ULLMAN FRANK . . . . . .33 DAYS
2ND LT. MARTEL VRIES . . . . . 107 DAYS
LT. COL. LEWIS MIKKEL . . . . . .461 DAYS

FINAL COMMAND OF THE MASTER BRAIN:

LINE 1 . . . . . P.A. 1201
LINE 2 . . . . . P.A. 1202
LINE 3 . . . . . P.A. 1201
[...]
LINE 15406. . . . . P.A. 1202

ATOM BARONS OF SANTAGRIA (A.B.S.)

FIELD MANUAL NO. 100-4-8X

"KNIGHTS OF THE BLAST SHADOW"

MILITIA - TANKSKNECHT - MISSILE JOUSTS

...The flash at first had swallowed up the fishermen astray,
And laid death second on those who had refuged far away,
Worst were they who heard the siren call the saints to shelter:
Bunkers became hecatombs amid the city's welter.
Soon there came an ampler rain as roofs ejured their tiles,
Striking down the few who'd weathered through that blasted mile.
A sun to blot the moons, another seething symbol..."

- Cantar de Rampo Guerrero, C. I.9-15

PERSONNEL (EST.):

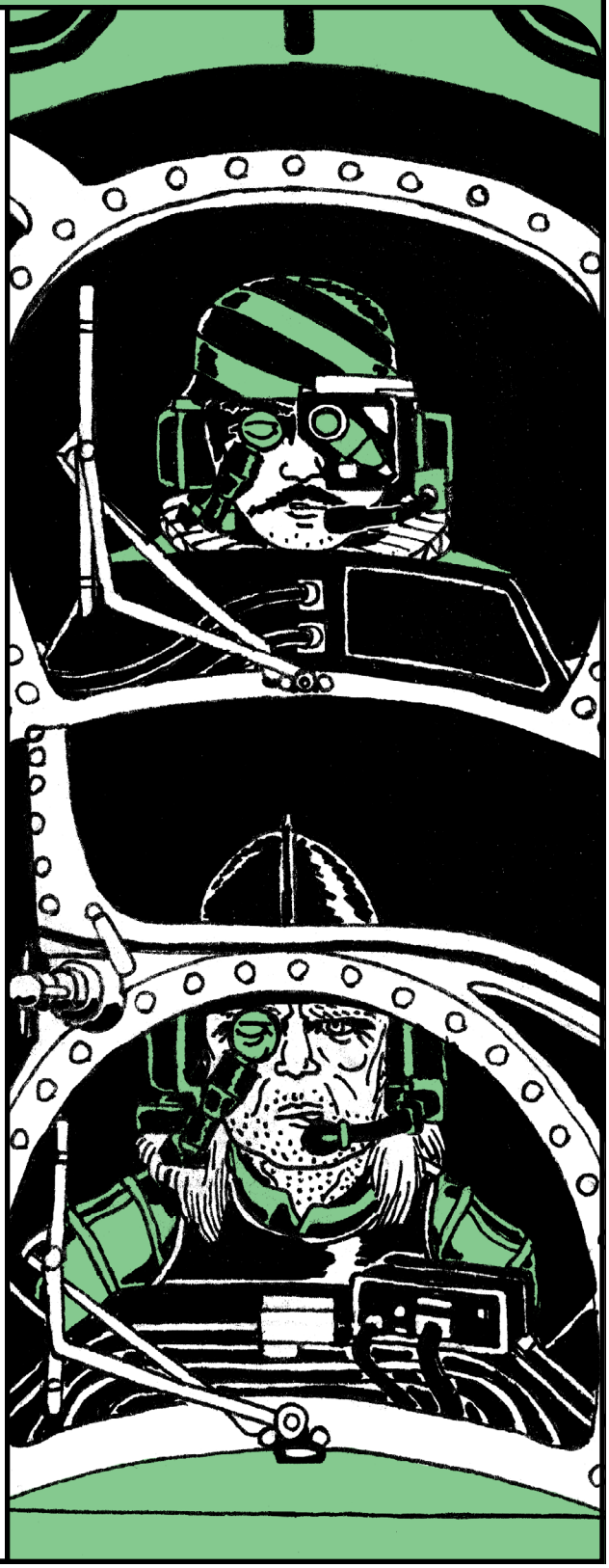
ACTIVE DUTY (NOBILITY) 30,000
ACTIVE DUTY (YEOMAN) 180,000
MILITIA (HIGHEST LEVY) 1,300,000

UPBRINGING OF A KNIGHT:

SMALL ARMS TRAINING . . . . . AGE 7
FORWARD AIR CONTROL . . . . . AGE 14
PILOT & GUNNER'S SCHOOL . . . . . AGE 16
VIGIL & DUBBING CEREMONY . . . . . AGE 21

CASUS BELLI BETWEEN BARONS (RANKED BY POPULARITY):

ANCESTRAL LAND CLAIM. 1
FAMILY BLOOD VENDETTA 2
INSULTED AT MEAL 3
ENVIABLE TRADE ROUTE 4



GETTING READY

After selecting your faction, you can prepare your army list by choosing units from that faction's field manual until you reach your point cap. Having created your army list, you must then make or procure tabletop models to represent the units in your list. Printable paper standees are provided for all units in the game if you want to experiment with new units on short notice or do not desire to spend money on miniatures.

Firelock 198X doesn't assume that you are committed to a single army list. Before a game, you can improvise a new list based on what models you have available and what your army's faction offers. While the game is quite replayable with a single list, you are encouraged to try many different force compositions and see which you like best.

WRITING AN ARMY LIST

After selecting your faction, you can write your army list by choosing units from that faction's manual until you reach your agreed-upon point cap. You may write down your list (and army key, for your blinds) any way you'd like. Part of a 100 point army list is presented below as an example of how army lists are written across all field manuals.

F.S-A. MOTORIZED PLATOON
EXAMPLE - 100 PTS, 3 COMMAND

Uther Section - HQ
Type 68C "Appomattox" - ***0 pts (TACOM)***
LaF-18 "Ox" - ***10 pts***

The name of the list, its point cap, and the number of command tokens provided in total by all TACOMs is given at the top. Under the header bar, the list's units are divided into tactical groups. These have no gameplay effect themselves, but merely help organize a list.

The first tactical group on this list ("Uther Section") is a headquarters section. It contains one TACOM and a logistics truck.

Aart Section - AT
Type 60 "Grumble" - ***10 pts***
- [E] States-Grenadiers - ***10 pts***
- [E] ATGM Team - ***10 pts***

This tactical group, Aart Section, is made up of an APC and two infantry units (a squad and an anti-tank weapons team). Both are subheaded under the APC, and marked "[E]", indicating that they're embarked inside.

At the bottom of all official army lists is a key for unit assignment abbreviations: [E] for "embarked", [D] for "desanting", and [T] for "towed". Usually, these assignments are only advisory. If so, a disclaimer will state such.

A MAP READY FOR PLAY

SCENARIOS & OBJECTIVES

A game's **scenario** determines the **objective(s)** and victory or defeat conditions for each army involved. It should also list whether the armies have specific or asymmetric point caps, whether they deploy differently from one another, or whether and how they benefit from preplaced emplacements.

In essence, the scenario is the "where, why and how" of the battle to be fought.

Scenarios may vary wildly in points caps, terrain complexity, and objective difficulty. Depending on the experience of the players involved, one to two hours per 100 points is a good estimate for the time it will take. Thus, multiple 100 or 200 point battles may be fought in an afternoon, but only one 400 point game.

The heart of the game lies in your own creativity! You are encouraged to write unique objectives and scenarios of your own. When you have enough experience with the game, you may even want to create your own units for these scenarios as well. Use the material in the official field manuals to familiarize yourself with the system and setting until you are comfortable enough to write your own scenarios.

EXAMPLE SCENARIOS

Example narrative scenarios are found in in **FM 1-8X-2**. We recommend starting with the **BEGINNER SCENARIO**.

While the first three are intended as tutorials for new players, they can also be used as bases for creating your own. Each of them specifies a premade map. These are available to print (as individual paper terrain regions); alternately, you can manually recreate them on your table through your own terrain modelling, find them in the TTS module, or simply create your own terrain layout anyways.

QUICK PLAY SCENARIO

If you have armies and a map, and want to get into the game immediately, use this:

DEPLOYMENT
Standard; any two opposing table edges.

OBJECTIVES
Place three objective tokens on interesting terrain roughly equidistant from the deployment edges. Objectives can be captured or contested by units within 6".

VICTORY CONDITIONS
Capture all three objectives for two consecutive rounds or have the most objectives captured at the end of the eighth round.

Other generic objective types can be found in **FM 1-8X-2**. These are recommended as more vigorous alternatives to quick play once you've gotten games under your belt.

AP

CHAPTER 5

PLAYING THE GAME

This chapter describes the structure of a game round and how it is played.

ROUND PHASES

Firelock 198X is played in **rounds**. Each round is divided into **phases**. During each phase, a different part of combat (such as firing or maneuvering) is carried out; you and your opponent take turns performing **actions** with your units.

A unit chosen to take an action on your turn is said to be **activated**; when that unit has finished acting on your turn, it's **spent**.

Sometimes, actions taken on your turn still allow you to do something else before the turn ends. These are called **free actions**.

The list of phases is as follows:

I. SUPPORT PHASE
II. FIRE PHASE
III. MANEUVER PHASE
IV. IDENTIFICATION PHASE
V. CLOSE COMBAT PHASE
VI. OBJECTIVE PHASE

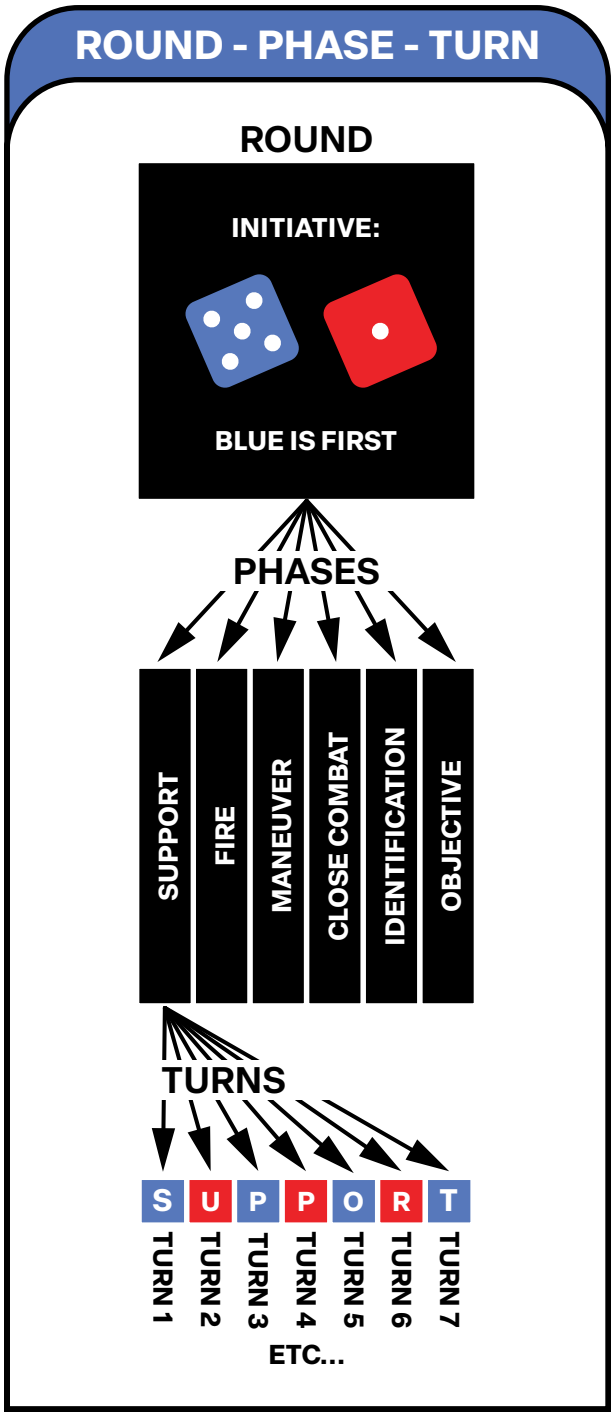
Before the first round begins, armies must **deploy** onto the field. To determine who starts deploying first, all players roll for **initiative** (unless the scenario specifies otherwise).

INITIATIVE

When rolling for initiative, each player rolls a single dice. Any players that get the same number must re-roll until their results are different. Whoever gets the highest roll wins.

If a game involves three or more players, initiative goes in descending order. Only players with matching rolls need to reroll. Continue until you've established the order for the round.

For example: if in a three-player game Player A rolls a 4, and Players B and C each roll 3, then Player A is guaranteed to go first. Players B and C should re-roll to see which of them goes second and third.



Once you've determined initiative for the round, remember it! It will determine who goes first in each phase.

DEPLOYMENT

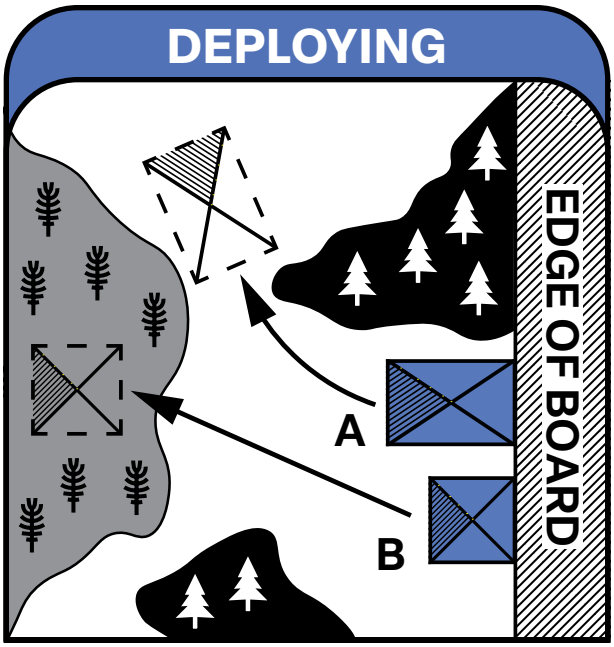
Deployment is how units enter play. Each army should have a **deployment edge** of the table, opposite to that of the enemy. If the scenario doesn't specify deployment edges, you can either just pick two arbitrarily, or let the player who won initiative pick first.

Players take turns deploying units in order of initiative. All units are deployed starting as blinds. Place the blind with its rear arc touching your deployment edge. Then, it takes a standard movement action (see **III. MANEUVER PHASE, p. 5-12** in this chapter). No command token is spent to do this, and it can't be a *Brigade* move.

As part of a deployment move, units can act as if they did in the Maneuver Phase. They can sprint or road dash. If embarked in a personnel carrier, desanting on a vehicle, or being towed by another unit, they may deploy simultaneously with that unit. Embarked or desanting infantry can disembark and move away from their carrier as a move of their own on a separate deployment turn.

All units must deploy, unless otherwise stated by the scenario or special rules.

Be sure to check LOS to enemies for spotting and identification (see **IV. IDENTIFICATION PHASE, p. 5-15**). If any close combat is already happening as a result of deployment, resolve it immediately after finishing deployment (see **V. CLOSE COMBAT PHASE, p. 5-16**).



Unit A and Unit B are owned by the same player, and are deploying from the same deployment edge at the easternmost edge of the table. They both begin in full basal contact in their rear arc with the deployment edge. Unit A makes a standard move, turning and heading northward. Unit B later makes a standard move to hide in a tall field to the west.

SPECIAL DEPLOYMENT

Sometimes, the scenario may call for unusual deployment. A defensive force may occupy a **deployment zone**, for example, and thus start already in position within some specified area of the table. During an ambush, the ambushed force and the ambushers might deploy all at once (first and second, respectively). The standard deployment rules are appropriate for a meeting engagement between maneuvering forces; use your creativity and judgement in altering them as the scenario requires.

Some units' deployment may be altered by their own special rules, such as *Paradrop* units **parachuting**, or luparic *Infiltrator* units **infiltrating** (see **APPENDIX A** & **FM 100-2-8X**).

END OF DEPLOYMENT

After deployment ends, the first round begins. Remember: Firelock 198X is played in **rounds**. Rounds are made of several **phases**. In each phase, you take **turns** activating units to do things. At the start of every round, you roll **initiative**. Whoever won initiative acts *first* in each phase.

I. SUPPORT PHASE

During the Support Phase, you carry out administrative action (like cleaning up tokens), generate command tokens from your TACOMs, and leverage support weapons.

The order of operations in the Support Phase is as follows:

i. Upkeep and command tokens.

Remove a number of pin tokens from each unit (including those in reserve, like planes) equal to its Quality statistic. Dummies may lose as much pin as you'd like.

Remove stationary/moving fire and command tokens placed in the previous round, but leave others. Remove cleared emplacements.

Roll to see if any *Lingering* radii with Strength values inflict kills on units caught within (see **APPENDIX A** — *Lingering*). Then roll to see if any such radii dissipate. The player that placed a *Lingering* radius should handle its rolls.

Collect a number of command tokens equal to the sum of the Command statistics of your living TACOMs. Command tokens are not saved between rounds: use them or lose them! Keep your number of command tokens a secret.

None of the above actions need to be done in turns. Just let your opponent know when you've finished.

ii.Resupply Ammo to friendly units.

Each player takes turns replenishing their units' Ammo from friendly units with the Resupply special rule (see **APPENDIX A** — *Resupply*).

iii. Declare support missions.

Players have a number of turns equal to the number of their still-living TACOMs. In initiative order, players alternate either **calling a support mission** with one of their TACOMs or **passing** for the turn. Each type of support mission has an associated **support card**.

Declare that you are calling the mission, what type it is, and which TACOM is calling it, then spend a command token on that TACOM. Place the card face-up next to that TACOM. If calling in a plane, reveal what plane it is (you needn't place the plane on the table yet).

Each TACOM can only call one mission per Support Phase. Passing a turn does not force you to pass for the entire phase.

iv. Declare support mission targets.

Each player takes turns declaring targets for the support missions they just called. Indicate which unit is the target, and move the support card to be face-up next to it. If declaring a target for a plane, also place the plane on the table at its entry point (see **SUPPORT MISSION TYPES, p. 5-5**).

TACOMs may call missions on targets or points of ground within their own LOS. They do not necessarily need spotting to do so. If they cannot draw LOS to a point, they cannot call a mission on it unless otherwise stated.

Unit A, a TACOM, declares a support mission. Initially, the support card is placed next to Unit A. When both players have called or passed with their support turns, Unit A targets the unit it can see: Unit C. The support card moves to Unit C.

TACOMs may call missions on units not in their LOS if:

- The unit has a **designation token** (see **APPENDIX B** — *Designator*).
- The unit has a **counterbattery token** (see **APPENDIX A** — *Heavy/Light Indirect*).
- The TACOM is personally spotting the target with *Sense* (see **APPENDIX A** — *Sense*).
- The target is a plane.

Missions be cannot be called through *Smoke* or if the TACOM is in *Chemical Weapons*.

Instead of declaring a target for your mission, you can instead choose to withdraw it when it's your turn. If a mission targets a support card that has withdrawn (e.g. a plane mission targeted against a withdrawing plane), your card also immediately withdraws, but the command token you spent is not refunded.

Otherwise, missions always follow through, even if the TACOM that called it dies later that round. They follow targets that move.

Missions, after being declared and given a target, resolve during the Fire Phase.

v. Declare close-in fire.

Each player takes turns declaring **close-in fires** against enemy planes on approach to their mission targets. Close-in fires are not missions; you can think of them as a sort of "reactive action" available only to a player with at least one unoccupied TACOM.

Only TACOMs that have not called any missions are eligible to call close-in fires, and each TACOM can only call one per Support Phase. A TACOM which called and then withdrew a mission is not eligible to call a close-in fire. Close-in fire costs a command token.

Close-in fires involve a firing unit and a target plane. The firing unit must be a friendly, non-plane unit armed with an Air-targeting *Guided Missile* (see **APPENDIX B** — *Guided Missile*). The target plane's entry point must be within range and LOS of the firing unit. Mark the firer with a face-down support card.

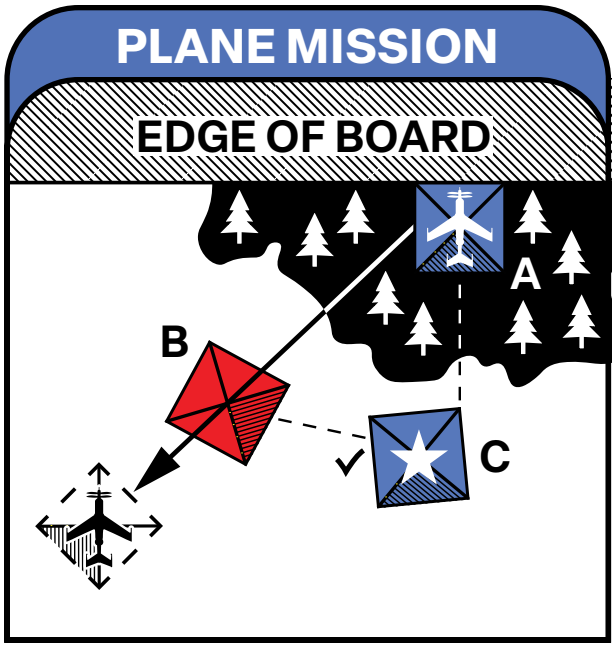
Essentially, close-in fire permits guided missiles to commence fire against planes on approach to the table but which have not yet entered it, representing their long-range stand-off capability.

Close-in fire is resolved in the Fire Phase, later in the round.

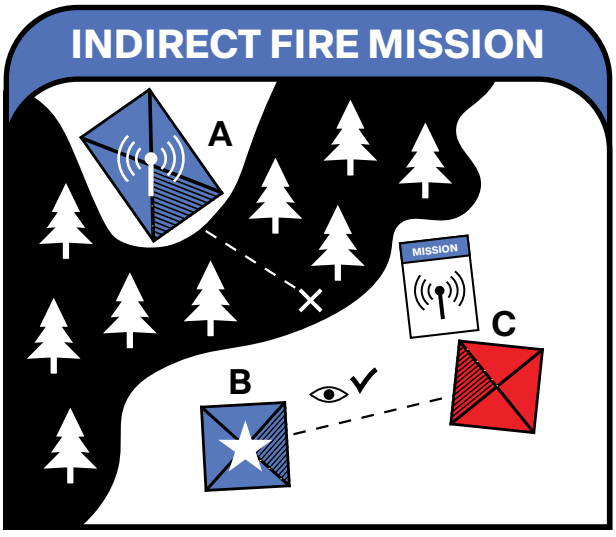
vi. Remove counterbattery tokens.

Counterbattery tokens from the previous round are now removed. This happens after missions are declared. Thus, a new fire mission can be declared against a target with a counterbattery token that it acquired in the previous round's Fire Phase. Remember: that fire mission does not go away when the counterbattery token is removed!

TACOMs which activated in the Support Phase (either to call a mission, or to call a close-in) cannot act in the Maneuver Phase later in the round. TACOMs which called and then withdrew a mission may act in the Maneuver Phase, but do not get their command token back.



Unit A is a plane being called in by a TACOM, Unit C. During the Support Phase, Unit C called in Unit A as a plane mission. Unit C then selected Unit B, an enemy, as Unit A's target. Unit A is placed with its rear arc against its deployment edge, and a strafing line is drawn between it and Unit B. Unit A will later fly toward, then over and past, Unit B.



Unit A is an artillery piece with no LOS to Unit C. Unit B, a TACOM, does have LOS to Unit C. Unit B, in the Support Phase, calls an indirect fire mission that targets Unit C. In the Fire Phase, Unit A may respond to that fire mission to fire on Unit C, even though it does not have LOS to its target.

SUPPORT MISSION TYPES

i. Plane Mission

A plane mission selects a plane to enter the table from reserve. Planes follow a **strafing line** during their mission. The strafing line starts at an **entry point**: the point on your deployment edge (or the board edge closest to your deployment zone), closest to the base of the calling TACOM. The strafing line then crosses through the center of the mission target's base (or the targeted point of ground), and then runs off the other end of the table.

Essentially, planes fly onto, across, and then off of the table during a mission.

CAP planes may be sent to **intercept** an enemy plane instead of an on-table target. The interceptor deploys at the opposite end of the intercepted plane's strafing line. If two CAP planes intercept one another, draw the strafing line between the two TACOMs calling the missions. Interceptors can't target planes they can't kill.

If a CAP plane is intercepted while trying to target another unit, it is forced to instead target its interceptor (shifting the strafing line), but it does not "lose" its original mission completely. If the unit intercepting the CAP plane dies before the CAP plane has activated to fire, the CAP plane immediately draws a new strafing line and may proceed to fly over and fire on its original target again.

Intercepted CAS planes aren't forced to do anything; they simply continue on their original strafing line against their original target and may ignore the interceptor.

ii. Indirect Fire Mission

Indirect fire missions allow friendly *Indirect* units to target a unit or point of ground not within their own LOS (see **APPENDIX B** — *Heavy/Light Indirect*).

iii. Factional Special Missions

Some armies have unique mission types only they may call. Consult their respective army books.

II. FIRE PHASE

During the Fire Phase, players take turns declaring **fire actions** until all decide to pass or have no more fire actions to take. Fire actions don't cost command tokens. All units have one fire action, unless otherwise stated.

To **declare** a fire action, choose a friendly unit that has not already spent its fire action. Then, choose one of its weapons (and a specific shot type, if that weapon has multiple).

Attacks may only be declared against units of a class that the chosen weapon can target. The target must be within range of the chosen weapon (measuring edge-to-edge), and within the firer's LOS. Unless otherwise stated, the target must be within the firer's frontal arc.

Weapons with an Ammo value must spend one Ammo to fire.

To **resolve** a fire action:

i. Determine the target number for the to-hit roll.

If the target is spotted, choose either the stationary or moving Accuracy of the weapon. This will determine whether the unit can move in the Maneuver Phase, later in the round. Add a +1 **half range modifier** to Accuracy if the target is within half range. Place a stationary fire token on the target if it used its stationary Accuracy. If the firer was a blind, it is immediately identified.

If the target is not currently spotted, the firer is forced to **blind-fire** into the target's vicinity. The target number becomes 6+ to hit, regardless of the weapon's Accuracy or whether you choose to fire stationary or moving. Blind-fire gets no positive modifiers (such as from half range). Remember: spotting is shared by all friendly units!

Lastly, add any negative modifiers, even if blind-firing. The result is your target number to hit the enemy.

Be familiar with your weapon's special rules before pulling the trigger! Some, such as *Scoped* (see **APPENDIX B** — *Scoped*), affect blind-firing and other parts of the fire action.

ii. Roll to hit.

Roll a number of dice equal to the Dice statistic of the chosen weapon. Track each result separately. Any die that meets or beats the target number is a **hit**; otherwise, it's a **miss**. Unless otherwise specified, a to-hit number of "++" *always* hits, regardless of modifiers, and never has to blind-fire.

iii. Roll to kill.

For each dice that hit the target, roll again to see if the hit **kills** it. Compare the hitting weapon's Strength to the target's Toughness in the arc the firer is facing. If the attack is within half range, use the weapon's half range Strength, unless it doesn't have one.

A kill roll of 7+ or 1+ **automatically** fails or succeeds, respectively. Unlike ++, 1+ is still subject to modifiers.

Weapon's S vs. target's arc's T:	*To kill*
Strength 1/4 or less than Toughness	7+
Strength 1/2 or less than Toughness	6+
Strength less than Toughness	5+
Strength equal to Toughness	4+
Strength more than Toughness	3+
Strength 2x or more than Toughness	2+
Strength 4x or more than Toughness	1+
Strength 8x or more than Toughness	++

A value of "1+" or "1-" for Strength or Toughness is usually equal to 1, but considered one step superior or inferior to 1 (respectively) when directly opposed to 1. For example, S1+ vs. T1 is 3+ to kill, but S1+ vs. T2 is still 6+ to kill.

Some weapons may have variable Strength values, listed as S[D3] or S[D6]. Roll a three or six-sided dice (respectively) per hit to determine the weapon's Strength for the subsequent kill roll. Don't confuse these for the weapon's Dice statistic!

If the target is in terrain that offers a Cover Modifier (see **CHAPTER 6 — TERRAIN TYPES & STATISTICS, p. 6-1**), apply it as a negative modifier to the roll result.

A to-kill number of "++" means that a hit inflicts *two* automatic kills, not one.

If the to-kill number was not 7+, then a roll result of 6 *always* kills, regardless of other modifiers (see **APPENDIX F**).

A successful kill means that the target is **removed from play** unless otherwise stated.

iv. Apply pin tokens.

Put one **pin token** on the target for every die that missed, and three for every die that hit but did not kill (a **failed kill**). A unit can accrue at most six pin tokens at any time. (You might instead track it with a single dice.) Weapons with no Strength value *cannot* apply pin.

If the weapon's kill roll is 7+, it cannot increase the target's pin beyond a maximum of two pin tokens. In simultaneous attacks, apply its pin last.

PIN EFFECTS

Infantry lose 1" of movement per *each* pin token. All unit classes suffer -1 Accuracy to all weapons per *each two* pin tokens. Vehicle and aircraft movement is unaffected by pin.

If a unit has six pin tokens, it's at **max pin**. Units at max don't share their spotting with allies, some weapons cannot be fired, and planes can't use their Evasion

CONFIRMING HITS

Against fast-moving air targets, or those with special protective systems, hit rolls must sometimes be confirmed. A failed confirm roll is treated like a failed kill and thus applies three pin to the target.

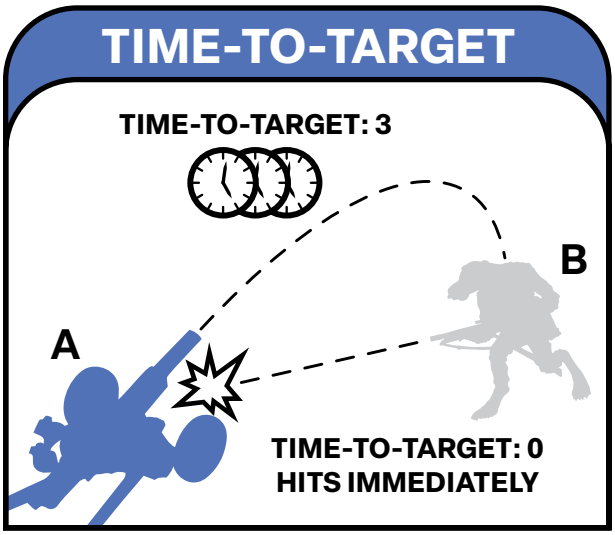
TIME-TO-TARGET

Some weapons, such as *Guided Missiles* and *Indirect* fire barrages, do not immediately affect their targets when fired. These are called **time-to-target** weapons. All of them have an associated number.

When a time-to-target attack is declared, place as many **time-to-target tokens** as the weapon's number on the target. Then, on every one of your subsequent turns (*not* rounds!) in that *same* Fire Phase, remove one of the tokens. When you remove the last token, the attack resolves as a free action. (Firing the weapon, on the initial turn, is not a free action.)

Pin accumulated on the firing unit, *after* firing but *before* resolving the attack, reduces the attack's Accuracy upon its resolution. If the firer dies, the attack automatically misses.

Sometimes, time-to-target attacks can have their time-to-target reduced (e.g. *Guided Missiles* within half range). If time-to-target is ever reduced to zero, the attack resolves immediately.



Unit A fires first, declaring an indirect attack with a time-to-target of 3. Unit B fires second, using a direct fire weapon with no time-to-target. Unit B gets a chance to shoot back before Unit A's attack lands. If it survived, Unit A's attack will resolve on the third of its player's turns after it fired.

FIRE PHASE TURN SEQUENCE

While fire actions are the main part of your turn, you can potentially conduct additional free actions, according to the following sequence:

i. Remove time-to-target tokens.

Remove one time-to-target token from each enemy or point of ground on the board that is subject to a time-to-target attack you previously declared. Only remove your *own tokens* on your *own turn*—not those from enemy weapons!

Remember: time-to-target weapons don't lose a token on the same turn that they were initially fired.

ii. Resolve time-to-target attacks which land.

When a time-to-target token stack runs out, the attack lands and resolves.

If there are any time-to-target tokens left at the end of the Fire Phase, remove them all and resolve the attacks in order of which will land first. Attacks that resolve on the same turn are considered simultaneous.

iii. Move planes.

All of your planes automatically move a distance equal to their full Movement statistic, forward along their strafing lines. They may only deviate from their strafing lines to avoid overlapping another unit's base. This movement does not cost a command token. The strafing line may also shift to follow a target that moved before the plane's mission is over.

Once per round, a plane may **wave off** instead of moving forward. It turns 180 degrees in place. On your subsequent turns, it will move forward in the opposite direction (back towards your edge of the table). Planes that wave off abandon their mission target.

If a plane enters basal contact with its target, it may halt mid-movement to attack in a **dive**. On your next turn, regardless of whether the target is dead or not, the plane overshoots it and continues along its strafing line.

A plane that flies off the edge of the table returns to reserve. When this happens, all non-*Homing* attacks immediately miss, and *Homing* attacks resolve (see **APPENDIX B** — *Homing*).

Opposing planes that enter basal contact as part of their movements immediately enter a **dogfight**.

iv. Resolve dogfights.

See **DOGFIGHTS, p. 5-18**.

v. Declare dives, close-in fires, and free attacks.

Dives and close-in fires are both types of **free attack**. The unit that fired them is still spent—i.e. it can't then execute another fire action or dive if it already fired earlier in the Fire Phase. However, another of your units can still activate on the same turn that the free attack happened.

Diving planes may make a free attack on their mission target only. They can do it on any of your turns after entering basal contact with their target. If attacking with a time-to-target weapon, the attack resolves immediately.

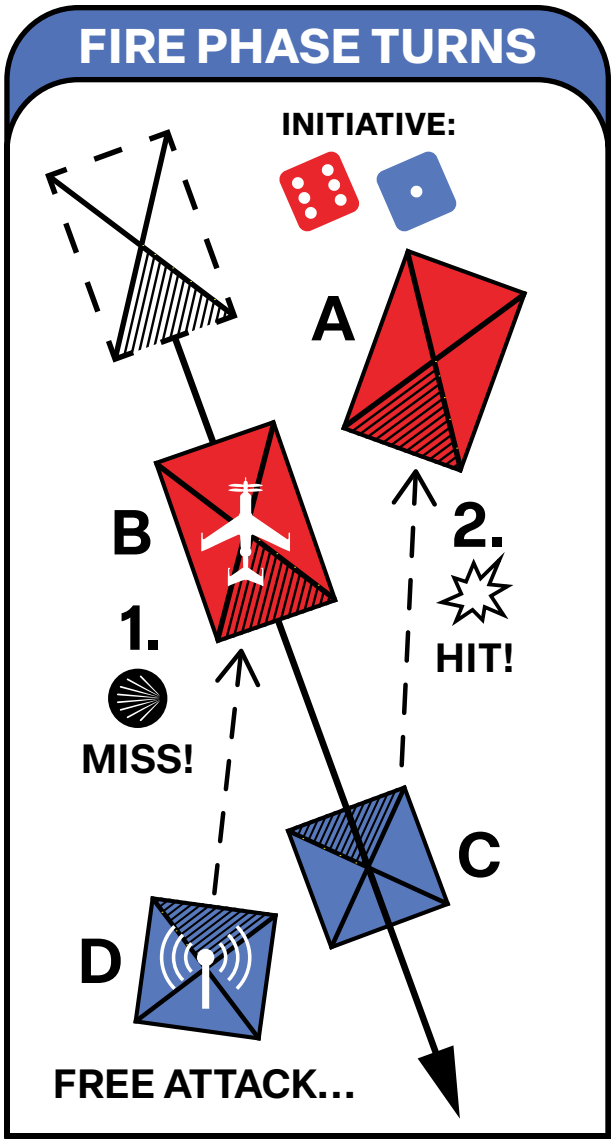
Close-in fire is a free attack that always fires at stationary accuracy and must be declared on your first Fire Phase turn. If not declared in the first turn, the opportunity for close-in fire is lost for the rest of the phase.

Any other attack that is a free action may also be declared now.

vi. Declare your main fire action or pass.

Any on-table unit (including planes not presently diving) may now make a fire action as normal. You can instead choose to **pass** your turn without firing. Remember: time-to-target weapons do not immediately resolve after being declared!

You may pass as many turns as you'd like, even if you still have units that can fire. This can be useful if you are waiting for the impact of a time-to-target weapon to act. Generally, though, it's best to attack with a unit before it is pinned or killed.



The Fire Phase has just commenced. No player has any time-to-target tokens to remove.

The red player has initiative. The red player moves his plane (Unit B) forward, and has no free attacks. He chooses to pass his first turn's main fire action.

It is now the blue player's first turn. He has no plane to move, so he goes right to his free attack: a close-in fire, from Unit D, against Unit B. Unit D rolls to hit Unit B and misses, but applies one pin.

Afterward, for his main fire action, the blue player has Unit C fire at Unit A. Unit C rolls to hit on Unit A and succeeds.

FIRE PHASE UNIT CLASS TRAITS

i. Infantry

Infantry that fire stationary may also **go to ground** as a free action, if the terrain they are in provides no cover (see **CHAPTER 6 — COVER MODIFIER, p. 6-1**). Units with a **gone to ground token** gain a -1 Cover Modifier.

If the unit subsequently fires at moving Accuracy, it loses its gone to ground token. A unit may also activate without shooting, in order to either gain or lose a gone to ground token.

Infantry squads (*not* teams) receive a **depletion token** when they suffer a kill result. Instead of being removed from play, they receive three pin (as if from a failed kill). They count as teams thereafter. Thus, squads require two successful kill rolls to remove from play.

A squad that suffers a kill from an attack with a to-kill number of ++ (i.e. a Strength eight times or more than their Toughness) is **over-killed**: it immediately suffers two kill results, and is removed from play without being depleted first.

ii. Vehicles

When vehicles fire, they temporarily lose the **benefit of ambush** (see **CHAPTER 6 — CONCEALMENT & AMBUSH, p. 6-3**) for the rest of the Fire Phase. It is much harder for large muzzle blasts and silhouettes to be concealed! However, vehicles regain the benefit of ambush at the end of the Fire Phase.

iii. Aircraft

Any unit that is airborne *cannot* be affected by ground-targeting attacks (i.e. most *Radius* attacks). Aircraft generally interact with terrain, spotting, and LOS differently from ground units (see **CHAPTER 6 — AIRCRAFT & TERRAIN, p. 6-9**). Any unit embarked on, or towed by, an airborne unit that is killed, is also immediately killed. They don't survive the crash, at least in any fighting trim.

Landed aircraft count as both vehicles and aircraft for targeting purposes and for losing ambush when firing. They cannot fire their weapons when landed except for *Door Guns* (see **APPENDIX B** — *Door Gun*).

Ground units firing against aircraft at any range must confirm their hits unless otherwise stated.

iv. Planes

All traits that apply to aircraft in general also apply to planes.

Planes may not be targeted by anything but other planes and weapons with either the *Guided Missile* or *Anti-Air* rules, unless otherwise stated. Planes, and units targeting planes, do not benefit from half range Strength or Accuracy modifiers.

Planes are always spotted; thus, fire against them is never blind-fire.

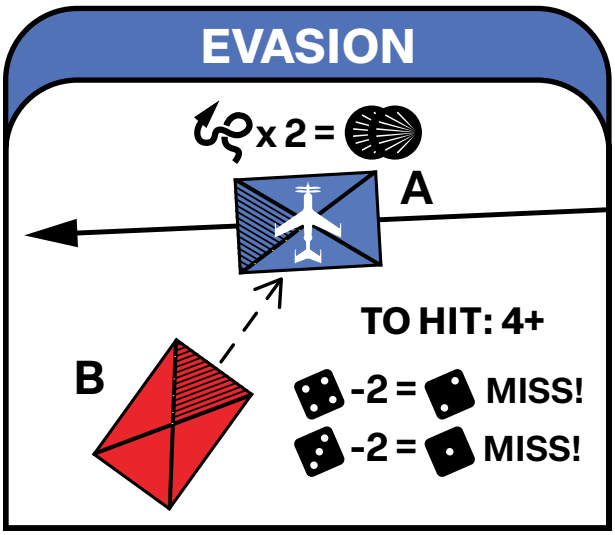
Planes may not fire against targets that are not their mission target or an enemy plane. When firing against enemy planes, they may not be presently diving or engaged in a dogfight, and may only fire Guided Missiles.

Planes may use their Evasion statistic to **evade** incoming attacks. Before rolling hits against a plane, the player controlling the plane may apply a negative modifier on the incoming hits, up to the value of their Evasion. They also receive that many pin tokens, as an evading plane has a much harder time staying on-target.

A plane cannot apply Evasion such that it would exceed max pin as a result. Evasion can't be used whatsoever when at max pin.

v. TACOMs

A TACOM that called a mission earlier in the round may still fire at stationary Accuracy.



Unit A is a plane under attack by Unit B, an anti-aircraft gun. Unit A has Evasion 3, but chooses to use only two points of it. It immediately accrues two pin, but Unit B's attack suffers a -2 modifier on its hit rolls. Unit B rolls two dice, and gets a 4 and a 3, which are modified to become a 2 and a 1 respectively. Both dice fall short of their to-hit number of 4+ and miss.

FIRING FROM VEHICLES

Infantry that are embarked inside of a vehicle may fire *Small Arms* (see **APPENDIX B** — *Small Arm*). They may do this at stationary Accuracy, without forcing their carrier (or themselves) to lose their move action later in the round. Embarked units use their carrier's pin for spotting and firing not their own, and don't accrue pin from incoming fire themselves.

Desanting infantry may fire any of their weapons in any arc, but only at moving Accuracy (although in Close Combat they may fire at stationary Accuracy). Desanting infantry fire with their own pin, *not* that of their carrier.

Embarked or desanting infantry that fire their weapons identify their carrier along with themselves.

Embarked and desanting infantry may *not* be separately targeted from their carrier. If a vehicle with desanting infantry on it is hit, the closely-packed infantry are also simultaneously hit by the weapon, even if it can't normally target infantry. They gain pin as normal. Embarked infantry only suffer a kill result when their carrier is killed.

A vehicle with desanting infantry on it *cannot* fire any of its weapons, but a vehicle with only embarked infantry *can* fire as normal. If the only desanting units are dummies, the vehicle may still fire. Immediately remove the dummies from play when the vehicle fires.

See **DESANTING, p. 5-14** and **APPENDIX A** — *PC(X)* for fuller explanations of how infantry and personnel carriers work.

FIRING AT INVALID TARGETS

If an attack targets a blind, with a unit class that the weapon cannot hit based on its Targeting type, the attack automatically misses and applies no pin.

Emplacements which are blinds can be shot at by anything in the game, though no weapon may actually kill the emplacement unless otherwise stated. For the sake of deception, emplacements can accumulate pin from misses as if they were dummies.

HUSKS & CORPSES

When a vehicle or aircraft is killed, replace it with a wrecked **husk** of the same base dimensions (or simply leave the model in place, marked appropriately; cotton balls over the hatches for smoke is one good approach). A unit may overlap a husk's base, but not such that its center is inside the husk's base.

When a vehicle with infantry is killed, any survivors must be placed somewhere in basal contact or overlapping their former carrier's husk.

Infantry units that are removed from play are replaced with **corpses** that occupy the same base dimensions. Corpses do not inhibit unit movement whatsoever, and are thus best represented with something flat. Embarked infantry do not create corpses if they die within their carrying vehicle or aircraft.

SIMULTANEOUS RESOLUTIONS

When multiple attacks land at the same time for any reason, such as during a *Multi-Gun* attack (see **APPENDIX B** — *Multi-Gun*), or when multiple time-to-target attacks land during the same turn, then all dice hitting the target at once—even if the attacks came from different firers—must be rolled and resolved simultaneously. There can be some wasted dice as a result of this.

FRIENDLY FIRE

In the spirit of sportsmanship and realism, it is not allowed for a player to ever willingly *directly* target one of his own troops with an attack that has a chance to kill them, if there is no potential benefit to the unit in question; beneficial actions, such as using *Rally* or concealing a unit in *Smoke,* are not restricted, of course. Nonetheless, sometimes **friendly fire** is unavoidable, such as from *Radius* attacks that overlap them (see **APPENDIX B** — *Radius*).

Whenever friendly fire occurs, it is considered to be against a spotted target at standard accuracy (modified by half-range bonuses, pin, and so on); i.e. Murphy's Law applies.

III. MANEUVER PHASE

In the Maneuver Phase, players take turns declaring **move actions** until all units eligible to move have done so, or both players have run out of command tokens.

When it is your turn, a command token must be spent: either to move one unit, or **pass** without moving. You needn't repeatedly pass once you have moved all your desired units; simply declare that you are taking no more turns. This keeps your number of command tokens secret, but is binding once declared.

Units may only move once per Maneuver Phase unless otherwise stated.

Units that previously fired at stationary Accuracy, or have 0" of Movement (due to pin, TACOM mission calling, or other effects), cannot activate in the Maneuver Phase.

MOVING & ROTATING

When moving a unit, move it up to its Movement statistic in inches, directly forwards or backwards. Reversing costs 2" of Movement per every 1" reversed.

At any point during a move action, a unit may also **rotate** in place. The cost of rotation in inches differs by unit class. All rotations are cumulative; a number of small turns split across a movement, for example, add up. This should be eyeballed, not exhaustively calculated.

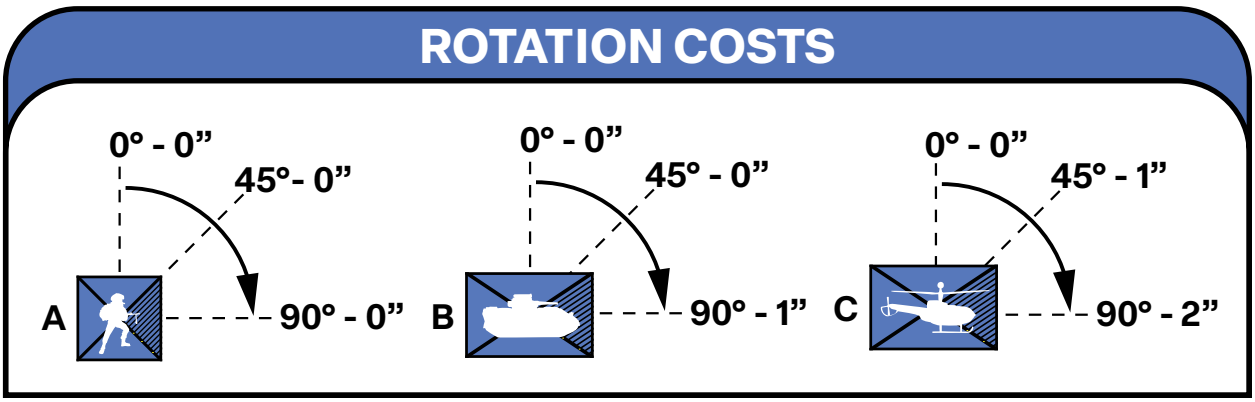
Friendly units may move through each other, and through husks, but not through enemies.

No unit may end its move with its base overlapping that of another unit.

Unit rotation and terrain entry/exit costs are never modified by terrain multipliers (see **CHAPTER 6 — TERRAIN TYPES & STATISTICS, p. 6-1**). Turning 90 degrees or paying 1" to enter dead ground, for example, always costs exactly 1" of movement, regardless of whether the unit is sitting on a road or in woods.

When making a move action which involves hard turns, or crosses over multiple terrain types, it's advisable to measure movement in whole numbers as much as you can. A little rounding is fine. It is generally easiest to try and break up your movements into nice round numbers. Don't break out calipers.

See **CHAPTER 6** for a full explanation of how terrain influences unit movement.



MANEUVER PHASE UNIT CLASS TRAITS

i. Infantry

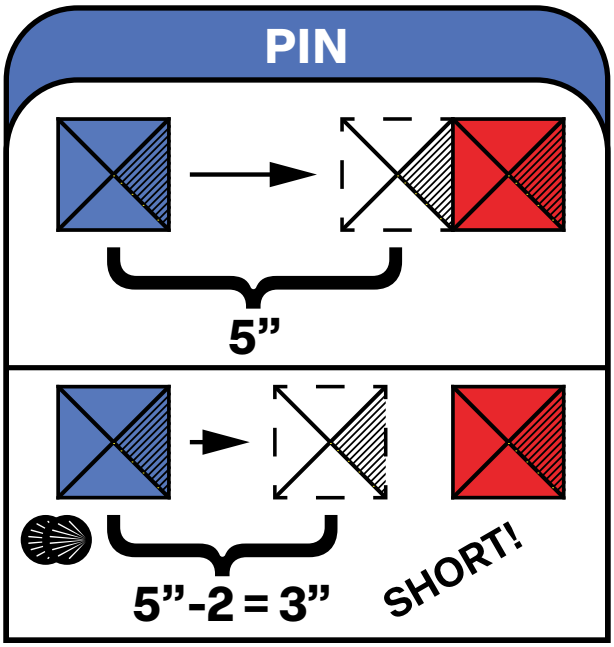
Infantry rotate for free.

An infantry unit that did not act in the Fire Phase may **sprint**. It adds half its Quality (rounded down) in inches to its Movement.

Infantry units may **clear** one emplacements per Round by ending their movement in basal contact with it. The emplacement is removed during the next round's Upkeep.

Infantry may avoid triggering traps by moving 2" or less while within their *Radius*.

Infantry lose 1" of their Movement per each pin token they have.



Unit A, an infantry unit with 5" Movement statistic, wants to charge Unit B, which is 5" away. Since Unit A has two pin, its Movement is reduced to 2". It cannot reach Unit B in a single move action.

ii. Vehicles

Vehicles pay 1" to rotate for each full 90 degrees they make over the course of a move.

Wheeled vehicles that begin and end their entire movement on a road may **road dash**, adding their Quality statistic in full to their base Movement before the road's movement multiplier. They also pay an additional 1" whenever they enter or exit occluding terrain, even if that terrain lacks an entrance/exit cost.

Carriages move like infantry: they ignore terrain multipliers, can sprint, and may rotate for free. When unhitched, they may still move themselves to get into a firing position. (see **APPENDIX A** — *Tow (X)*).

iii. Aircraft

Helicopters pass over any terrain in their way when airborne. They may **take off** at the beginning of an action, and **land** at the end of it, but not both in the same activation. Both cost 4" of Movement. Landed aircraft must take off before they can rotate or change position.

Indicate whether a helicopter is airborne or landed with a double-sided **helicopter token**. ("Landed" can mean both actual landings, such as what transport helicopters make, and hovering skids-to-the-earth.)

Helicopters may not land on buildings, or inside of any terrain with an Occlusion Height, unless otherwise stated.

Helicopters do not benefit from LOS occlusion while airborne, and they do not use the Cover Modifier of their respective terrain.

Planes never land and are always airborne.

See **CHAPTER 6 — AIRCRAFT & TERRAIN, p. 6-9** for a full explanation of how aircraft interact with terrain.

iv. TACOMs

TACOMs that activated in the Support Phase, to call a mission or close-in fire, cannot activate in the Maneuver Phase: they remain stationary for that round.

DESANTING

Any vehicle can, in a pinch, be used to carry infantry riding on top of it. This is called **desanting**. Unless otherwise stated, every vehicle can carry up to two desanting teams. Squads count as two teams, so any vehicle can carry one desanting squad. Aircraft cannot carry desanting infantry.

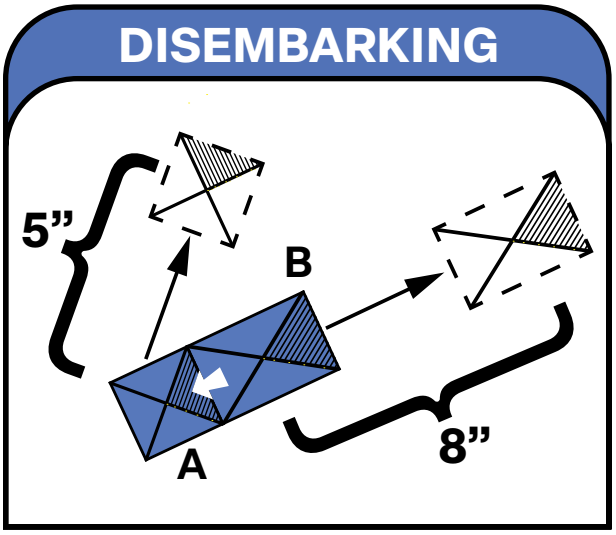
To desant on a vehicle, move infantry into full basal contact, then set them aside and mark the vehicle with a **desanting token**.

In a later Manuever Phase, you can **disembark** by placing the infantry in contact with any of the vehicle's arcs and moving them away as normal. Friendly units don't block disembarkation, so long as the movement ends without overlapping bases.

Similar to desanting is **embarking** (see **APPENDIX A** — *PC (X)*).

Embarking and disembarking are part of the infantry unit's move action, not that of their vehicle. Thus, it costs a separate command token. The vehicle moving does not count as the infantry moving; so, they can disembark and move after the vehicle moves.

Infantry can never embark and disembark a vehicle in the same round.



Unit A disembarks from Unit B's rear and immediately sprints 5" as part of the same action. Unit B, which has not moved yet, separately moves 8".

CHARGING

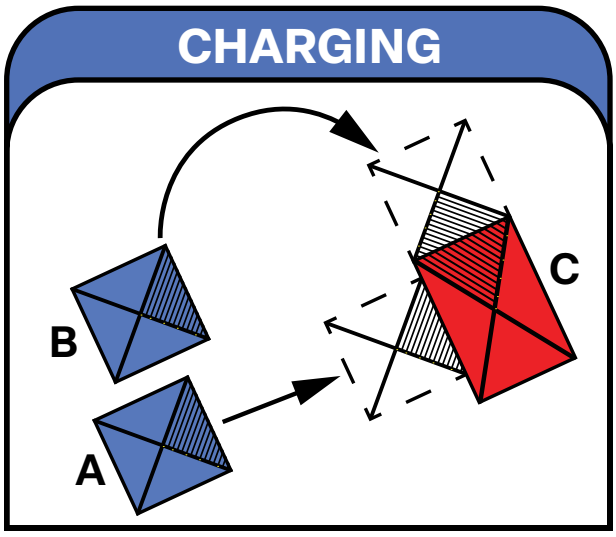
A unit that moves into basal contact with the enemy is said to charge into close combat. Close combat is mandatory against enemies in basal contact. Units in close combat cannot move until it has concluded.

Units cannot charge targets they have no chance of killing, unless the target is a blind; however, if they discover they cannot kill the unit they charged, the unit they charged will remain unharmed, and the charger will be forced to **fall back** automatically (see **FALLING BACK, p. 5-16**).

A unit can only charge the arc of an enemy that it begins its movemnt inside of, unless that arc is already occupied by another unit in close combat. Once contact is achieved, wheel the charging unit to maximize contact between the two units' arcs. You may do this even if the charger has no movement left.

Aircraft can't charge ground units (and vice versa). Carriers may charge an unkillable target if embarked or desanting infantry can.

A unit may not charge an enemy unit if that unit would have to pass through a different enemy unit's base in order to create a valid charge.



Unit A and Unit B charge Unit C on separate turns, wheeling to maximize contact. Because Unit A already occupies Unit C's side arc, Unit B can choose an adjacent arc to charge.

Units may overlap other units' bases in otherwise illegal positions when setting up a close combat so long as they enter valid positions after the combat concludes.

TRIGGERING TRAPS

A unit that enters a trap's Radius (or which makes basal contact with it), that can be targeted by the trap, **triggers** it.

The target's movement immediately stops, and the attack is resolved like a normal fire action against it. If the target survives, it may resume its movement afterwards as part of the same move action.

CHECKING SPOTTING WHILE MOVING

You cannot check spotting in the middle of a move action; only after the move action ends. Thus, there is no "peeking" at enemies with impunity. Units cannot spot or be spotted crossing open terrain if they end their move in concealment; their exposure time is judged to be too low to identify and engage.

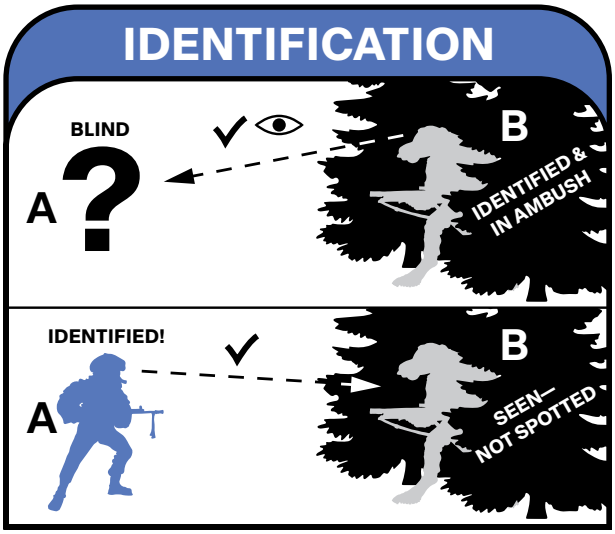
MOVING DUMMIES

Dummies normally require a command token to move, like any other unit. They can be moved wherever and as far as you'd like, so long as they don't affect anything. It's up to you to make that movement believable to your enemy.

IV. IDENTIFICATION PHASE

While spotting (and thus identification) can happen during the Fire and Maneuver Phases, this phase serves as a formal once-over of the board to ensure nothing is missed. Seasoned players might dispense with it accordingly.

Make sure to brush up on terrain and remember to consider advanced terrain concepts when checking LOS for the purpose of identification (see **CHAPTER 6**).



Unit A is a blind. Unit B was identified earlier in the battle, but is now in ambush at the edge of a forest, and is not currently spotted by any unit.

Unit B spots Unit A, identifying it. Unit A is not close enough to the forest to spot Unit B. If Unit A was to fire on Unit B, it would be blind-fire.

V. CLOSE COMBAT PHASE

Opposing units that end up in basal contact enter a **close combat engagement**. A unit begins close combat by **charging** into basal contact with a **defending** unit.

Close combat engagements represent all forms of fighting at 50 meters and under: bursts of rifle fire, hand grenades and sidearms, bayonet actions, and the physical overrunning of positions by vehicles. Close combat is short, extremely vicious, and lethal.

CLOSE COMBAT BEATS

Close combat engagements are resolved in repeating **beats**. In a single beat, every unit in a close combat engagement acts simultaneously. An engagement goes on, beat after beat, until one side or the other is dead or fleeing. (That is, a beat is essentially a "round" of close combat; but we needn't confuse this with a round of the game.)

Attacks between units in close combat are mostly akin to normal fire actions, with the following exceptions:

- Units in close combat always have LOS to and spot other units in the engagement. Only those in basal contact with the unit may be targeted.
- All attacks are at stationary Accuracy, *even* if the unit *charged* or is currently *desanting*. Units also benefit from half range Accuracy and Strength.
- To-hit numbers are always at least 6+.
- Units don't benefit from Cover Modifiers!
- Pin cannot be gained from close combat attacks. It may be lost during close combat, and pre-existing pin does affect close combat attacks.

All attacks in close combat are simultaneous. No unit is removed or affected by attacks during a beat until every unit that has a chance to act has done so. Mutual kills can happen.

OBLIGATED COMBATANTS

Embarked and desanting infantry must participate in close combat if their carrying unit is engaged. They cannot dismount until the close combat engagement is over. If their carrier charged, they are also considered to have charged.

If the carrier is killed, surviving embarked or desanting infantry are placed in basal contact with the enemy, where the carrier stood. Their bases may temporarily overlap with the husk's.

Units in a **tow chain** participate in close combat with any part of that chain (see **APPENDIX B** — *Tow (X)*).

FALLING BACK

A unit may fall back instead of firing in a beat. If it survives the beat, it reverses directly away from the engagement (i.e. a half-move), unaffected by pin.

If a unit in close combat cannot possibly kill any enemy with which it is engaged, it must fall back. If it cannot move backwards at all, or falls back into basal contact with an enemy, it is removed from play immediately.

REFORMING

A unit may **reform** instead of firing in a beat. When reforming, it turns in place either 90 or 180 degrees. Units in basal contact with it remain in contact, albeit on new arcs. For vehicles and other units with non-square bases, you may have to move other units in the engagement to retain basal contact. Units in tow chains can't reform.

OVERRUNNING

Close combat engagements proceed, beat after beat, until one side or the other has either been wiped out or all fallen back. The winning side's units get to perform **overrun moves**. An overrun is a 2" movement into valid terrain, unaffected by pin or terrain modifiers. You may rotate for free during an overrun. Embarked and desanting units may disembark.

Overruns may potentially lead a unit to charge into another preexisting close combat engagement, or to begin a new one entirely (possibly into an opponent that just fell back from it). A unit that overrun-charges immediately incurs two pin.

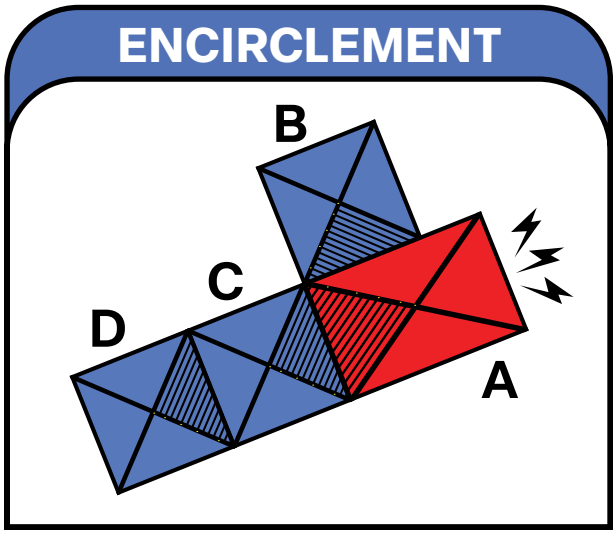
Unit A and Unit B win a close combat and may take overrun moves. Unit A makes an overrun charge into Unit C, gaining two pin. Unit B is unable to get close enough to move into a charge, so it moves 2" away into cover.

ENCIRCLEMENT & SCREENING

Infantry in close combat with an enemy vehicle can spread out and **encircle** it. That permits them to attack the arc of the vehicle with the lowest Toughness regardless of their mutual facings.

Friendly infantry in basal contact with a vehicle in close combat, or with an enemy infantry unit attempting to encircle, will **screen** the vehicle, preventing encirclement. Even units that are not in close combat, but still in basal contact with a vehicle, may still screen it.

Desanting infantry may screen vehicles, but embarked infantry cannot.



Units A, B, and C are in close combat. Unit A is a vehicle, with no friendly infantry in basal contact. Units B and C are encircling it. Unit D, which is not in contact with Unit A, is not part of the close combat engagement at all.

AIRBORNE CLOSE COMBAT

Aircraft can never enter close combat against ground units unless they are landed. If airborne, they can only enter close combat against opposing non-plane aircraft.

DOGFIGHTS

A **dogfight** is a modified form of close combat that happens between opposing planes, during the Fire Phase.

There are no overrun moves after a dogfight; the winning side simply continues along its strafing lines, completing the movements that led them into the dogfight in the first place. Planes may enter consecutive dogfights without incurring overrun pin.

Beats in a dogfight are *not* simultaneous. Instead, engaged planes act in initiative order. Initiative is rolled with a D3 per plane, with a +3 bonus for CAP planes. Planes that roll equal initiative act simultaneously.

Planes in a dogfight cannot use Evasion to protect themselves against attacks. They can instead use their Evasion to improve their initiative at the start of each beat. Each point of Evasion used grants +1 to their initiative at the cost of one pin, and planes cannot exceed max pin by doing so.

If a plane falls back from a dogfight, it does so by waving off and moving away. If its pursuer catches up, creating a new dogfight, the waving-off plane is immediately removed from play (as not to waste time; otherwise, it'd just catch up after every fall-back).

Guided Missiles, fired by the participants at each other before the dogfight, resolve and apply pin *before* the first round, even if they still have time-to-target remaining. These may be Evaded as normal. *Guided Missiles* can also be fired in dogfights, in which case they resolve immediately and apply no pin.

VI. OBJECTIVE PHASE

Before the round ends, take stock of the objectives held by each player. What an objective is, and how to hold it, can vary by scenario. The following rules describe the "default" nature of objectives (**CHAPTER 4 — QUICK PLAY SCENARIO, p. 4-7**) if the scenario doesn't specify otherwise.

Objectives are tokens placed on areas of interest on the map, such as strategic hills or building clusters. Infantry units within 6" of an objective may **capture** it. Opposing infantry or vehicles within 6" of an objective are said to **contest** it. Contested objectives count toward neither side.

Vehicles may only contest, not capture, objectives. Aircraft can neither contest nor capture.

The player with more objectives held at the end of the game (either by player resignation, or by reaching an agreed round limit) wins the game. If both sides hold the same number of objectives, or have failed to fulfill the scenario's victory conditions, the result is a draw.

ENDING A ROUND

After the Objective Phase ends, the next round immediately begins, starting with Upkeep in the Support Phase. Rounds continue indefinitely until the scenario reaches its round limit or victory is attained.

CHAPTER 6

TERRAIN, STRUCTURES, & HEIGHT

This chapter describes important mechanics relating to terrain, structures, and unit height, crucial for an interesting battlefield. Remember that terrain can be modelled or completely flat—so long as it is clearly distinguishable, it works. The rules that follow work for both types.

TERRAIN TYPES & STATISTICS

Terrain is divided into **types**—plains, forests, fields, and so on. All terrain types have unique statistics describing how they affect units moving and fighting within them. For example, consider forests:

FOREST TERRAIN TYPE	
Occlusion Height:	2
Cover Modifier:	-1 Inf / -1 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost:	0" Inf / 0" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier:	½

Occlusion Height: Terrain with Occlusion Height breaks the LOS of any unit with a Height statistic equal to (or less than) the terrain's Height. For example, an Occlusion Height 2 forest blocks the LOS of Height 1 and 2 units.

Terrain with Occlusion Height greater than zero is generically called **occluding terrain**. Hills can also occlude (**HILLS, p. 6-3**).

Cover Modifier: Terrain often gives cover to units inside it. This is expressed as two values: one for infantry, and one for vehicles, respectively. (Infantry typically make better use of cover than vehicles.)

Kill rolls against units are affected by their Cover Modifiers. For example, a 2+ to-kill against a unit in Cover -1 will need 3, 4, 5, or 6 to succeed.

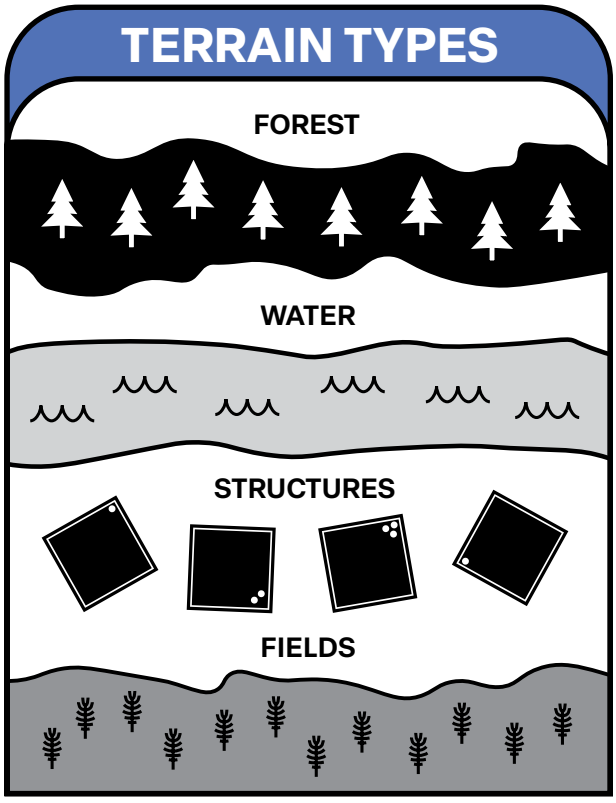
A ++ to-kill roll is reduced by Cover Modifiers as if it was 1+. It still inflicts *two kills* if successful.

If the to-kill roll was *not* 7+ to begin with, a result of 6 will *always* kill regardless of the unit's Cover Modifier.

Entrance & Exit Cost: These movement costs, in inches, are subtracted from the Movement infantry and vehicles when trying to enter or exit the terrain. Remember: wheeled vehicles pay an *additional* 1" to enter and exit terrain.

Vehicle Multiplier: For each inch of Movement a vehicle pays to move on this terrain, it moves a distance equal to its Vehicle Multiplier in inches. Thus, a vehicle with 8" of Movement only moves 4" through a forest.

A full list of standard terrain types and their statistics are given in **APPENDIX D**. These are provided for use with the maps bundled with the game; however, you are encouraged to also make new terrain types by using them as examples.



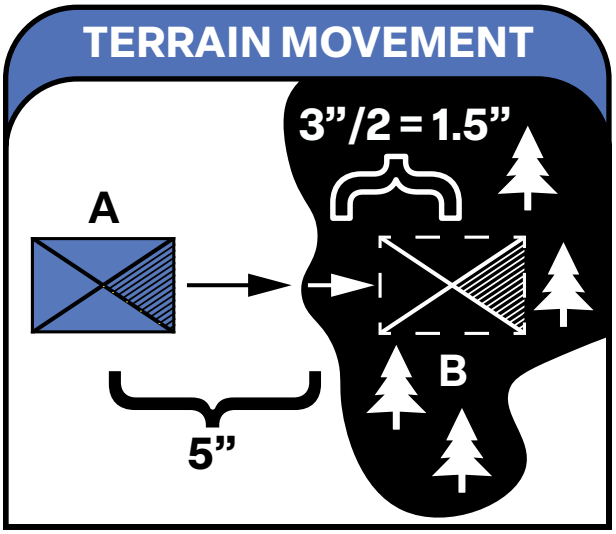
MOVEMENT & TERRAIN

A unit is considered to be in whatever terrain its **base center** is sitting on. If it's hard to tell, you can go with whatever terrain the base mostly occupies.

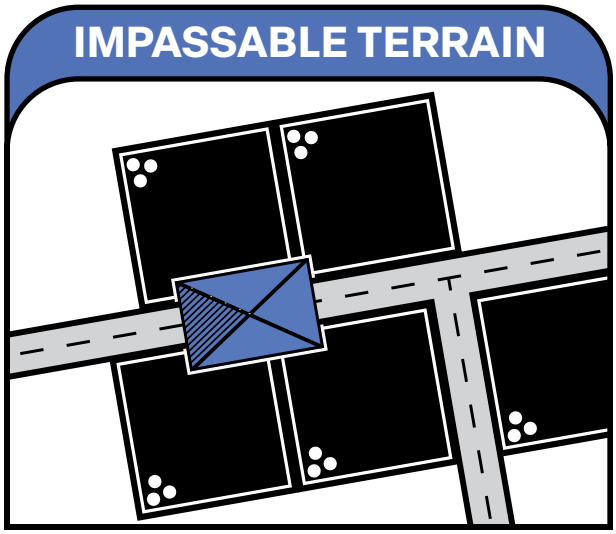
When measuring a move action that crosses between terrain types (e.g. moving from plains into a forest), split the move accordingly. Measure a segment along the first terrain type until the center of the unit base is on the border; then, measure the second segment, applying movement multipliers as appropriate.

IMPASSABLE TERRAIN

Some terrain, depending on its type, may be **impassable** to one unit type or another. It's alright to let the base overlap a little onto this so long as the center of the unit remains in navigable terrain. Remember that a unit's base is much larger than the real thing at-scale, and give leeway accordingly.



Unit A, a vehicle with an 8" Movement statistic, is moving in a straight line. For the first 5" of its move, it crosses plains. It has 3" of movement remaining, but the terrain ahead of it is forest, which has a movement multiplier of 1/2. It may only move 1.5" into the forest before its move ends.



Unit A, a vehicle, follows a highway between two closely placed clusters of buildings. Even though its base overlaps the buildings, it's considered to be on the highway, where its center lies. Remember: the actual vehicle isn't as big as the base implies!

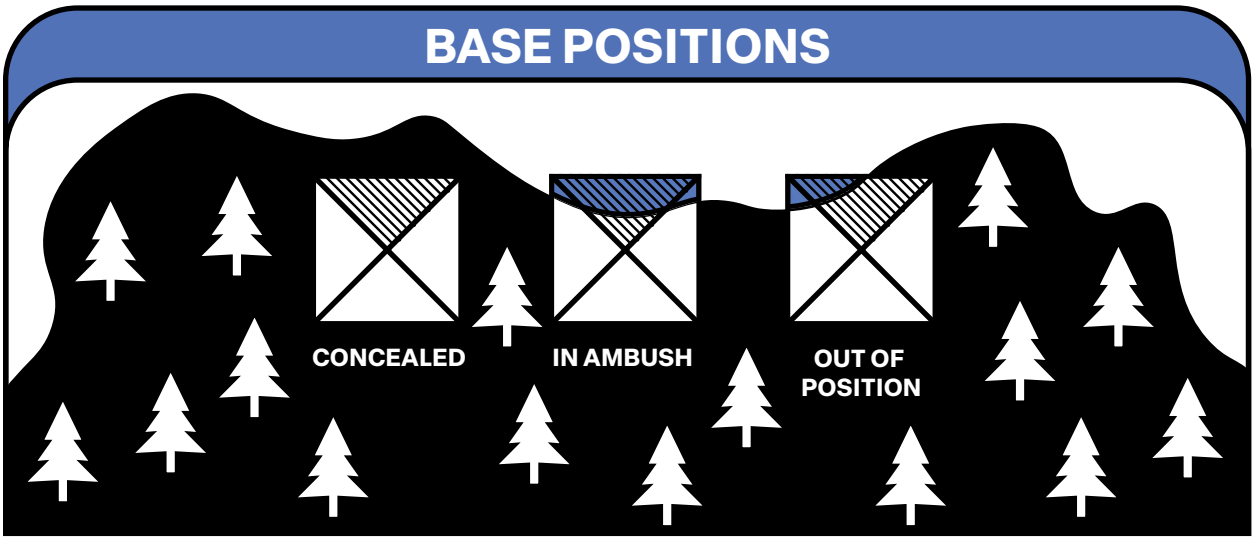
CONCEALMENT & AMBUSHES

A unit whose base is fully inside occluding terrain is **concealed** from the enemy. LOS (and thus spotting) cannot be drawn to or from a concealed unit under normal circumstances.

A unit whose center is in occluding terrain, but which has at least one of its arcs fully exposed in the open, is **in ambush**. LOS may be drawn to and from the exposed parts of an ambusher for spotting and firing.

A unit in ambush can only be spotted by enemy units that are within 6"; this is called the **benefit of ambush**. It may spot enemies at longer ranges as normal.

A unit may end up in a position where it is mostly concealed, but a small part of its base (not a full arc) is exposed. This unit is **out of position**. It is treated as if in ambush, but cannot draw LOS or spot out of the exposed parts of its base.

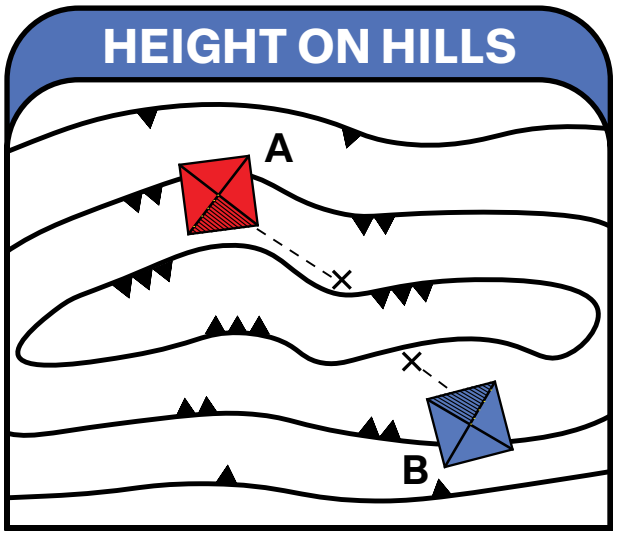


HILLS

Areas on the table may be elevated to form **hills**. Hills increase the Height statistic of both units and terrain that stand on them. Hills have no "Occlusion Height", only *intrinsic* Height that adds to the Height of things atop them. Occlusion Height is for terrains you walk through. You can't walk through a mountain.

On a flat table, hills are indicated by contour lines like those of a map. These represent steps of one Height each. Indicate the contour line's Height by drawing groups of triangles inside of each line pointing towards the hilltop. The more triangles, the taller the hill.

Each triangle means an increment of one additional Height for units and terrains standing on that step. Hill steps that are as tall as, or taller than, a unit occlude LOS through themselves, like terrain types with Occlusion Height. They do this even if the hill's terrain type has no Occlusion Height itself.



Units A and B are both Height 1 infantry. They stand on opposite slopes of a hill. Both of them are on the Height 2 steps; so, their effective Heights are increased to 3. The summit of the hill is a Height 3 step (indicated by three triangles). Thus, it breaks the units' LOS to one another.

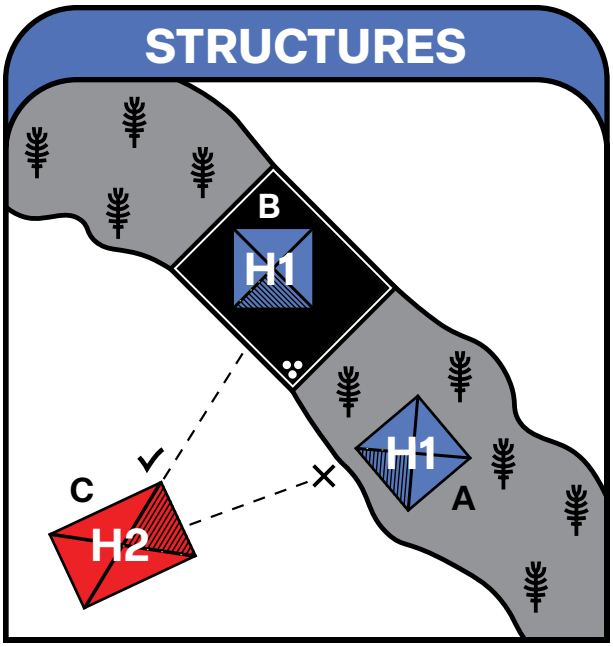
STRUCTURES

Structures represent grouped buildings, bunkers, and other artifice. They are a special form of terrain that obey their own rules.

WOODEN BUILDING STRUCTURE TYPE
Structure Height: 1, 2, or 3
Cover Modifier: -1

Structures have a **Structure Height** (akin to terrain Occlusion Height) and a **Cover Modifier** (as in terrain). Structure Height can vary depending on what kind of building you are representing—is it a small cluster of huts, or a single massive hangar? Remember that structures needn't necessarily be monolithic buildings. They can be small residential blocks or sprawling compounds grouped together.

Structure Height is typically marked directly on the building with dots or a number. It's best practice to account for any hills the building is resting on, such that it might be more easily read at a glance. For example, if placing a Height 2 structure on a Height 1 hill, mark the building as Height 3 and don't worry about adding Heights mid-game. (You might do this with regular terrain on hilltops as well.)



Units A and B are both Height 1 infantry. Unit C is a Height 2 vehicle. Unit C cannot draw LOS to Unit A, since it is concealed within a Height 1 field. It may draw LOS to Unit B, which is garrisoned inside a Height 3 structure (indicated by 3 dots). Unit B, because it is inside the structure, is in ambush. Unit C cannot spot it until it moves within 6" of the building, but it can be spotted by Unit B.

GARRISONING

Structures can be **garrisoned** by infantry that enter them. Vehicles and aircraft can never enter structures.

Structures cost 1" of Movement for infantry to enter or exit. Moving between touching structures thus costs 2" of Movement. Units *cannot* move through a structure without first entering it. They may enter or exit from any point that is in full basal contact with the structure.

Up to three infantry units (either squads or teams) can be garrisoned in an individual structure at any time.

Keep structures to about 80-100mm a side at most. Divide up urban sprawl and great fortresses accordingly.

Garrisoned infantry are considered to be in ambush. When drawing LOS, they use the structure's footprint as their own base, and its Structure Height as their own. The frontal arc of a garrisoned unit faces out in *all* directions; thus, it can't be flanked, and can direct fire in all directions, even with weapons that are normally restricted to the frontal arc.

The exact placement of garrisoned units inside a structure is normally irrelevant for firing and LOS, since the structure becomes their base. However, it's important when hit by weapons with radii (see **APPENDIX B** — *Radius*).

STRUCTURES IN CLOSE COMBAT

Enemy units which end their movement "in contact" with a defending garrison by any means—either by entering basal contact with the structure, or paying Movement to enter the structure itself—are considered to be charging into close combat.

Charging infantry that win a close combat may choose to overrun into the structure, thus becoming garrisoned, or outside of it (anywhere in full basal contact with the building). They may not overrun into adjacent buildings.

Opposing units garrisoned inside directly adjacent buildings (those contacting one another) are *not* considered to be in close combat. Chargers must enter the enemy building to initiate close combat.

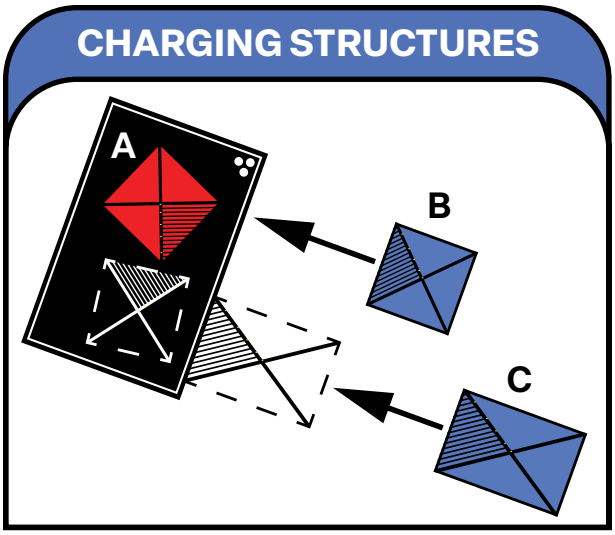
Garrisoning a building that a hostile unit is already in basal contact with counts as charging that unit.

If a unit overruns into a structure that is in basal contact with *another* enemy unit, the unit entering the structure counts as charging into a subsequent close combat. As a result, the unit in the structure gains two pin as per normal overrun-charge rules.

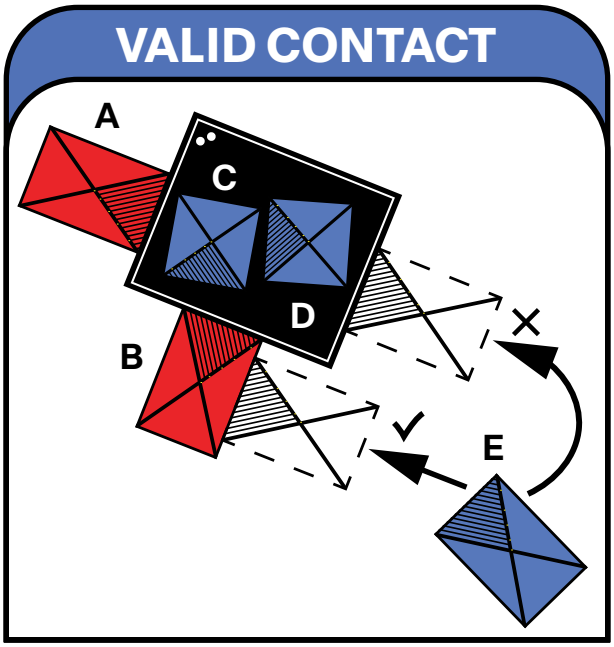
All enemy units in basal contact with a defending garrison are considered to be participating in a single, contiguous close combat with that garrison.

If a friendly unit wants to support a defending garrison in close combat, the friendly unit must find a way to make direct contact with one of the enemy units involved in the close combat. A friendly unit does *not* get to participate in the close combat just by making contact with the structure itself, without having any direct contact with an enemy unit.

The standard rules of close combat *always* apply, even when some units are garrisoned. Combatants may only attack units which they are considered to be in direct basal contact with.



Unit B and Unit C want to engage in close combat with a defending garrison, Unit A. Unit B opts to charge into the close combat by entering the building. Unit C charges the building's exterior. Both of the will participate in the same close combat regardless of how they made contact with Unit A.

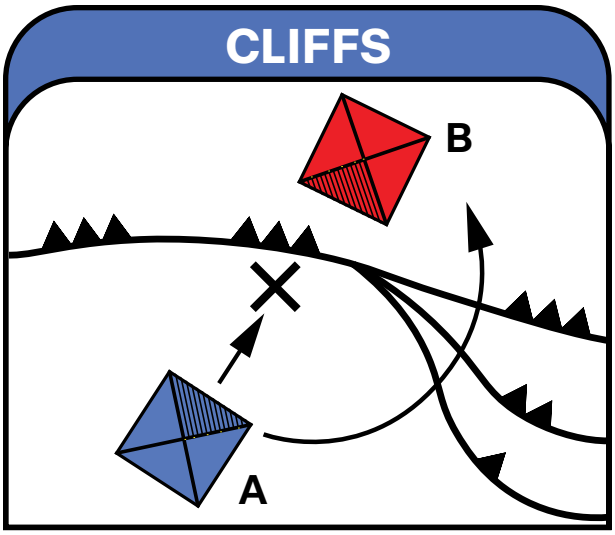


Unit A and Unit B are charging the exterior of a structure in which Units C and D are garrisoned. Unit E wants to join the close combat. If Unit E moved into contact with the building itself, it would not participate in the close combat. It can participate by charging Unit B's side, but it won't be able to fire upon Unit A.

CLIFFS

Normally, contour lines on a hill add one Height per each level. A **cliff** is created by a contour line that adds *more* than one Height relative to the ground around it. No ground units can cross over a cliff, as the edges of a clif are considered impassable. Instead, they must get around it, or be delivered by aircraft to the clifftop.

If a structure touches a cliff edge, and it has Structure Height equal or greater to the height of the clifftop, infantry can exit that structure and move onto the clifftop as normal. Things like stairways or access elevators can be represented this way.



Unit A wants to charge into close combat with Unit B, which stands on a clifftop. To get to Unit B, Unit A will have to climb the slope around the cliff.

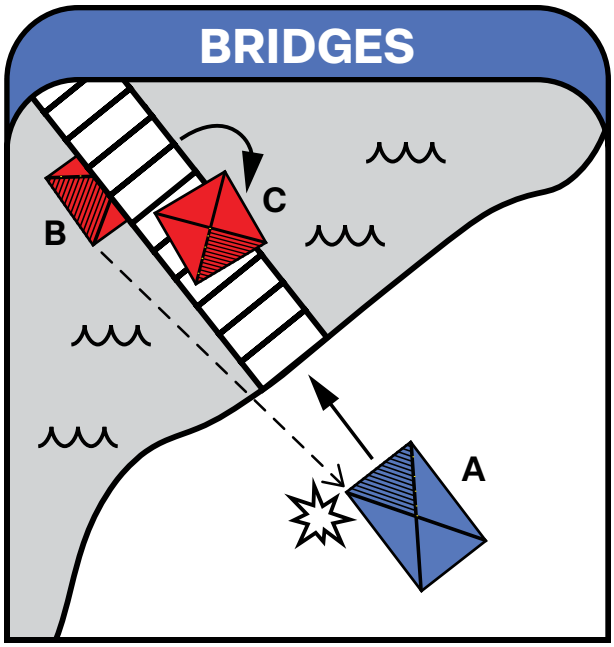
WALLS

A **wall** is a thin line on the table that possesses Height, is occluding, and is impassable by ground units. As with structures, make sure the height is legible by means of dots or a number.

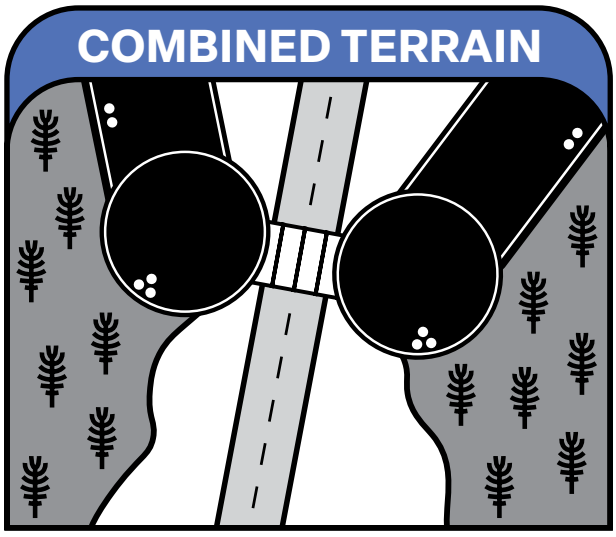
Walls are too narrow to be occupied by any unit. However, infantry can **scale** walls that are one Height taller than the ground they're standing on, by spending 3" of Movement. Place them in basal contact with the wall on its other side.

VOIDS

A **void** is an area on the table representing a very long drop; for instance, the empty sky between two floating islands. Aircraft cannot land on voids. A ground unit that ends up on a void is immediately removed from play, leaving neither a husk nor corpse.



Unit A, a vehicle, intends to cross over a bridge by entering from the land-adjacent side. Unit B, a watercraft carrying embarked infantry (Unit C), moves under the bridge and enters ambush. Unit C then disembarks from Unit A and climbs onto the bridge to block Unit A's path. From its position under the bridge, Unit B can still fire at Unit A.



With some imagination, buildings, roads, and bridges could make the gatehouse of a castle.

WATER & BRIDGES

Water can be either **deep** or **shallow**. Deep water is impassable to all units unless otherwise stated. Shallow water can be forded by all units.

Bridges are areas of terrain that span bodies of water. They neither occlude LOS nor offer cover, unless the terrain they are made of does. Units able to move through water can pass under bridges, but only from one of the sides facing the water. Units under bridges are considered to be in ambush.

Units on top of a bridge can enter close combat with units underneath a bridge.

Bridges have a height equal to the land they are connected to. Bridges can't connect land of different heights. *Amphibious* vehicles can drive from a bridge to water if the difference in Height is not greater than 1.

COMBINING TERRAIN

The goal of Firelock 198X is to be quick to play, easy to learn, and most importantly, easy to improvise. The provided terrain types in **APPENDIX D** are only guidelines! Ingenuity is king. Feel free to combine them in a logical manner to make new and interesting features for your table.

A bridge with buildings on it—like old London Bridge—could be a span of Height 2 or 3 buildings combined with intervening segments of road bridge, for example. (You might rule that vehicles can follow the road "under" the buildings, through tunnels, and thereby gain concealment, even if they're not actually inside the buildings.) Between tall buildings, footbridges at Height 3 could create elevated walkways that vehicles could drive under.

So long as it's legible, you can make it work.

HEIGHT DIFFERENCES & VANTAGE

Differences in height can defeat terrain occlusion. A unit that has at least one Height greater than any occluding terrain between it and a target can **look over** terrain to draw LOS.

If a unit has a Height value *that is at least 2 greater* than the Occlusion Height of its target's terrain, then that unit has **vantage** on its target. It can **look into** the lower-lying target's terrain as if it was not occluding, and thus draw unoccluded LOS, even against targets that are concealed or in terrain shadow. Essentially, this allows taller units to look down and spot enemies moving through terrain.

Vantage only ignores terrain that has an Occlusion Height. Vantage does not permit a unit to "see through" hills and their Height.

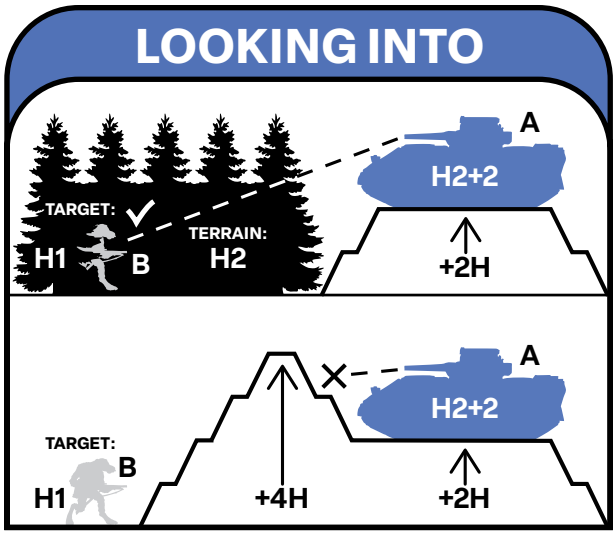
Vantage gives unoccluded LOS to units within 12". Within 6", units with vantage also spot all targets within LOS. Thus, a unit with vantage can draw LOS to and spot a concealed target within 6", but it does *not* automatically spot beyond 6" away. Vantage is *always* mutual.

TERRAIN SHADOW & HULL DOWN

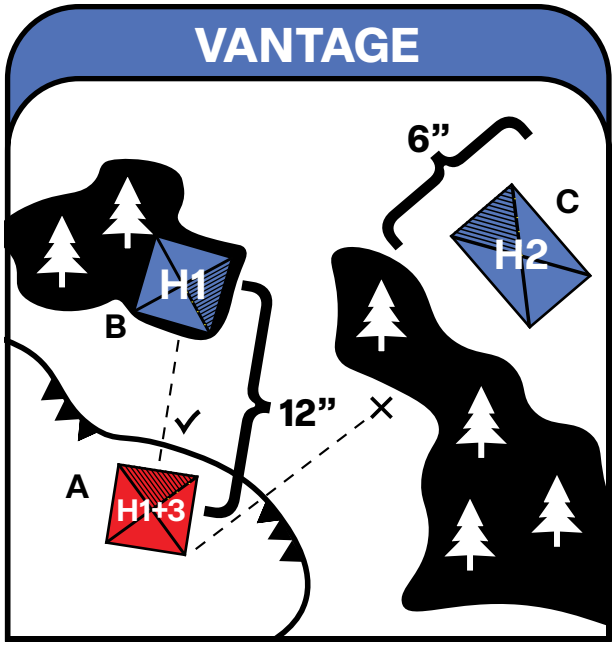
Terrain that would occlude LOS for any reason casts 6" of **terrain shadow** over ground units and landed aircraft. So long as a unit's height is equal to or less than the occluding terrain, it is said to be in **full shadow** if its base is *entirely* covered by that 6" span (relative to a unit trying to draw LOS). A unit in full shadow is thus occluded from the other unit.

If a unit's base Height statistic is *at least 2*, and its current overall Height is *only 1 higher* than the occluding terrain between it and its attacker, it is said to be in **partial shadow** (also called **hull down**). LOS is not occluded to the unit, but it *does* gain a -1 Cover Modifier against attacks which must draw LOS through the potentially occluding terrain. This does not stack with any preexisting Cover Modifier.

Enemy units within 12" are **too close!** Terrain shadow no longer occludes units that would have otherwise seen each other, *but hull down Cover Modifier is still granted.*



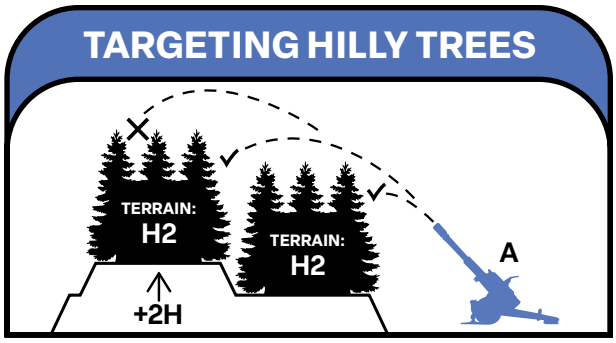
Unit A is a vehicle (Height 2) atop a Height 2 hill, giving it a total Height of 4. In the top diagram, Unit B's total height is 2 greater than the Occlusion Height of the forest concealing Unit A. Unit A can "look into" the forest and draw LOS to Unit B. Below, Unit B is behind a hill as tall as Unit A. LOS is broken, as vantage cannot "look through" a hill.



Unit A, which has Height 1, is atop a Height 3 cliff overlooking forests (Occlusion Height 2). It can draw LOS to (but not spot) Unit B due to vantage, even though Unit B is concealed. It cannot draw LOS to Unit C, because Unit C is within the 6" of terrain shadow, and not within 12" of Unit A.

GROUND-TARGETING TALL TERRAIN

When targeting ground with occluding terrain on it, you target the tallest part of the occluding terrain that the attacker (or spotter) can draw LOS to. You can thus hit the "front" of occluding terrain (like forests), but not deeper into them, unless there is a contour line where the Height increases. You *may* target the ground along this line.



AIRCRAFT & TERRAIN

All airborne aircraft have infinite Height, and thus always have vantage within 12". LOS to aircraft may still be broken by terrain shadow beyond this range.

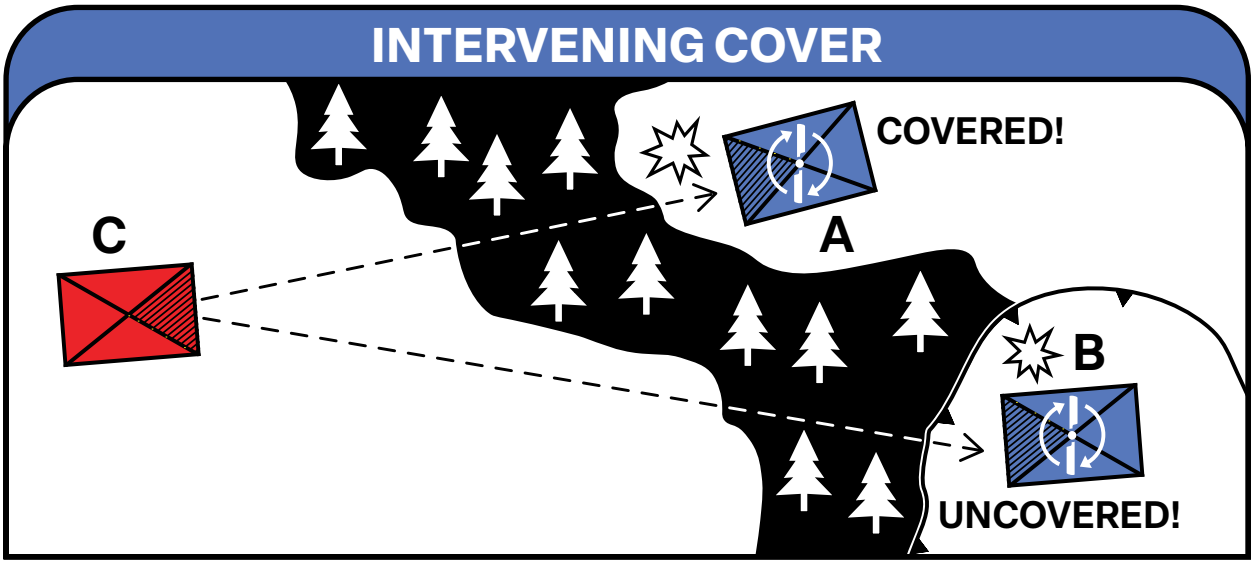
Aircraft do not interact with or benefit from the terrain they directly fly over. Aircraft can never land in occluding terrain, unless otherwise stated.

Landed aircraft interact with terrain as if they were vehicles, meaning they cannot land in terrain that is impassable to vehicles. They benefit from concealment, cover, terrain shadow, and can even enter ambush (although they cannot fire while landed unless otherwise stated).

INTERVENING COVER

Planes never get Cover Modifiers of any kind. Other airborne units, i.e. helicopters, can acquire a special kind of partial shadow called **intervening cover**.

Rather than checking the helicopter's innate Height statistic against the height of adjacent terrain, intervening cover simply checks the difference between nearby terrains themselves. If the helicopter's base is within the 6" terrain shadow of a terrain with a Height that is *at least 2 greater* than that of the terrain the helicopter is currently flying over, the helicopter gets a -1 Cover Modifier. This represents the ability of helicopters to fly relatively low to the ground and to conduct "pop-up" attacks.



Units A and B, both helicopters, are threatened by fire from Unit C. Both Unit A and B are behind a forest (Occlusion Height 2). Unit A is over a flat plain (Height 0). Thus, it gains a -1 Cover Modifier from intervening cover. Unit B is flying over a Height 1 hill. Since the difference between the forest and the hill's Height isn't 2 or more, Unit B does not benefit from intervening cover.

MODELED TERRAIN

When using modeled terrain, accept that terrain models may not be portrayed "to scale". Allow units to move freely through and around terrain models within the zone demarcated by the terrain, with the exception of structures. If you need to move an individually-based model tree to make way for a unit within the terrain, do so.

The following points are only advisory. Everyone's terrain setup is a bit different. Use what works for you and your best judgement.

i. Terrain Boundaries

If the boundaries of a given terrain area aren't clearly demarcated by the models representing it, either using something to mark them (e.g. string and bluetack) or just agreeing on whether a unit is in the terrain or not will do.

ii. Non-buildings

If your standing models for trees and other occluding objects are individually based, then cluster all of the models into a visible boundary between that terrain type and the terrain which it borders, then move the terrain models to make way for units entering the terrain type that the models represent.

If your standing models are on one large, integrated base, then use the base itself as the terrain boundary and freely move your troops into or around any obstructive models built into the base.

iii. Buildings

If you are using flat-topped buildings, placing your models on the roof is sufficient.

If using buildings with angled or irregular roofs, positioning your models on top may be untenable. In this case it may be worth marking units as garrisoned and temporarily removing them from the table or placing them next to the building.

iv. Hills & Cliffs

The contour line system works elegantly with string and bluetack.

If not using string, incremental height increases on the slope of a hill can be benchmarked using the height of most 15mm infantry models (or a small coin of equivalent size). Put the infantry at ground level and measure from the top of the most upright model's head to the slope of the hill: Below his head is Height 1, and above it is Height 2. Stack two models to get the line between Height 2 and Height 3, etc.

A "wedding cake" type hill model, with several flat layers representing different Heights, is an easily readable approach.

The lazy man's rule requires no measurement whatsoever. The slope of the hill is Height 1, and its plateau is Height 2. Height 3 is reserved for evidently massive terrain features.

iv. Thin Terrain

If using fences, hedges, or other low, thin terrain, use models to indicate the terrain's boundary, then treat everything between those edges as being part of one contiguous block of occluding terrain. An empty yard surrounded by low cobblestone walls, for instance, can be treated as a single field.

CHAPTER 7

A ROUND OF FIRELOCK EXPLAINED

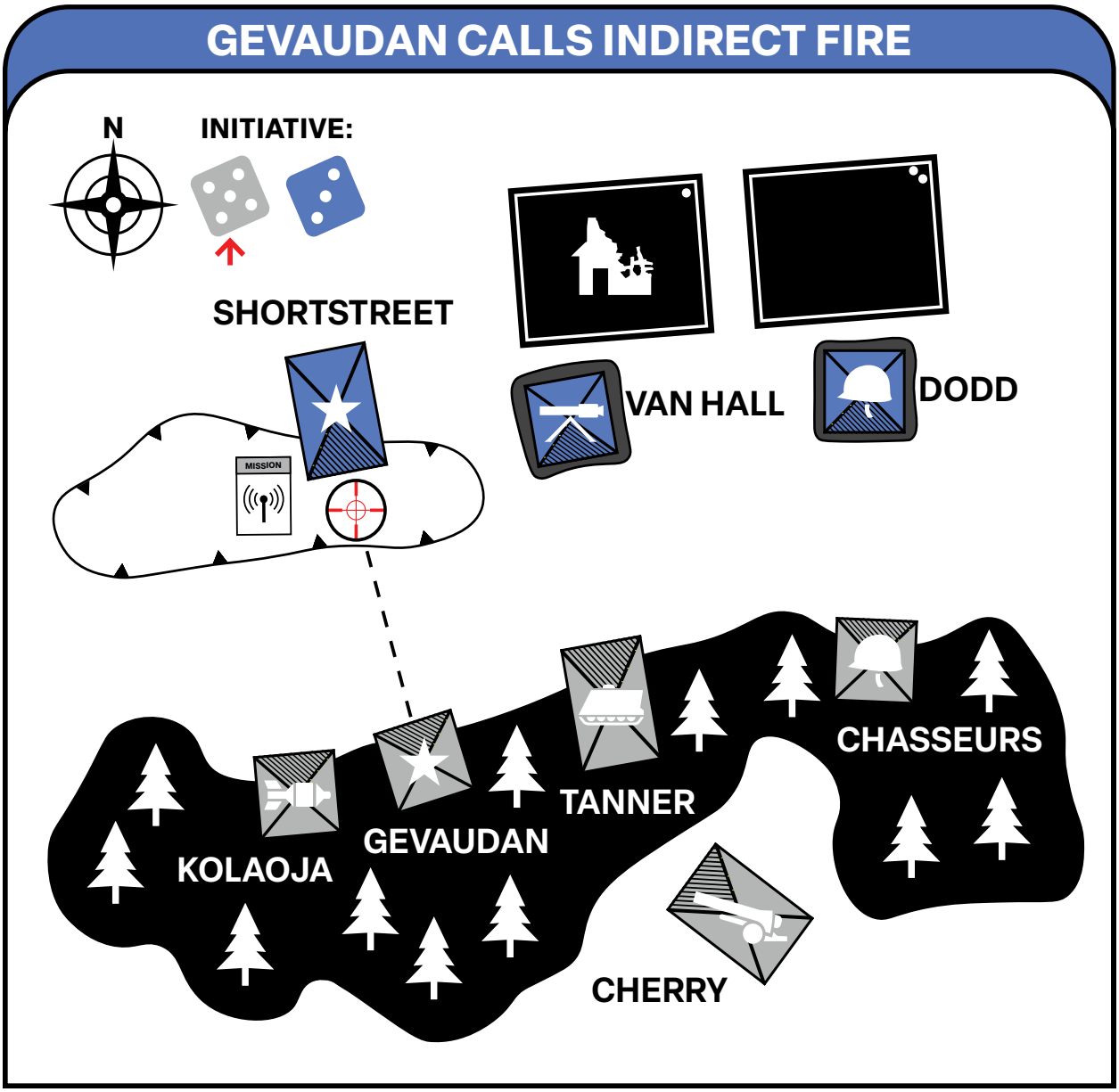
Cross-reference this chapter with Chapter 1 to get a mechanical explanation for every event described.

1. THE SUPPORT PHASE

The round begins by rolling initiative. The Ebon Forest player rolls a five; the Federals, three. Thus the lupar have the initiative. They will have it at the start of each phase in the round.

Capitaine Gevaudan, the lupar TACOM, spends a command token to call a fire mission in front of Lieutenant Shortstreet's tank.

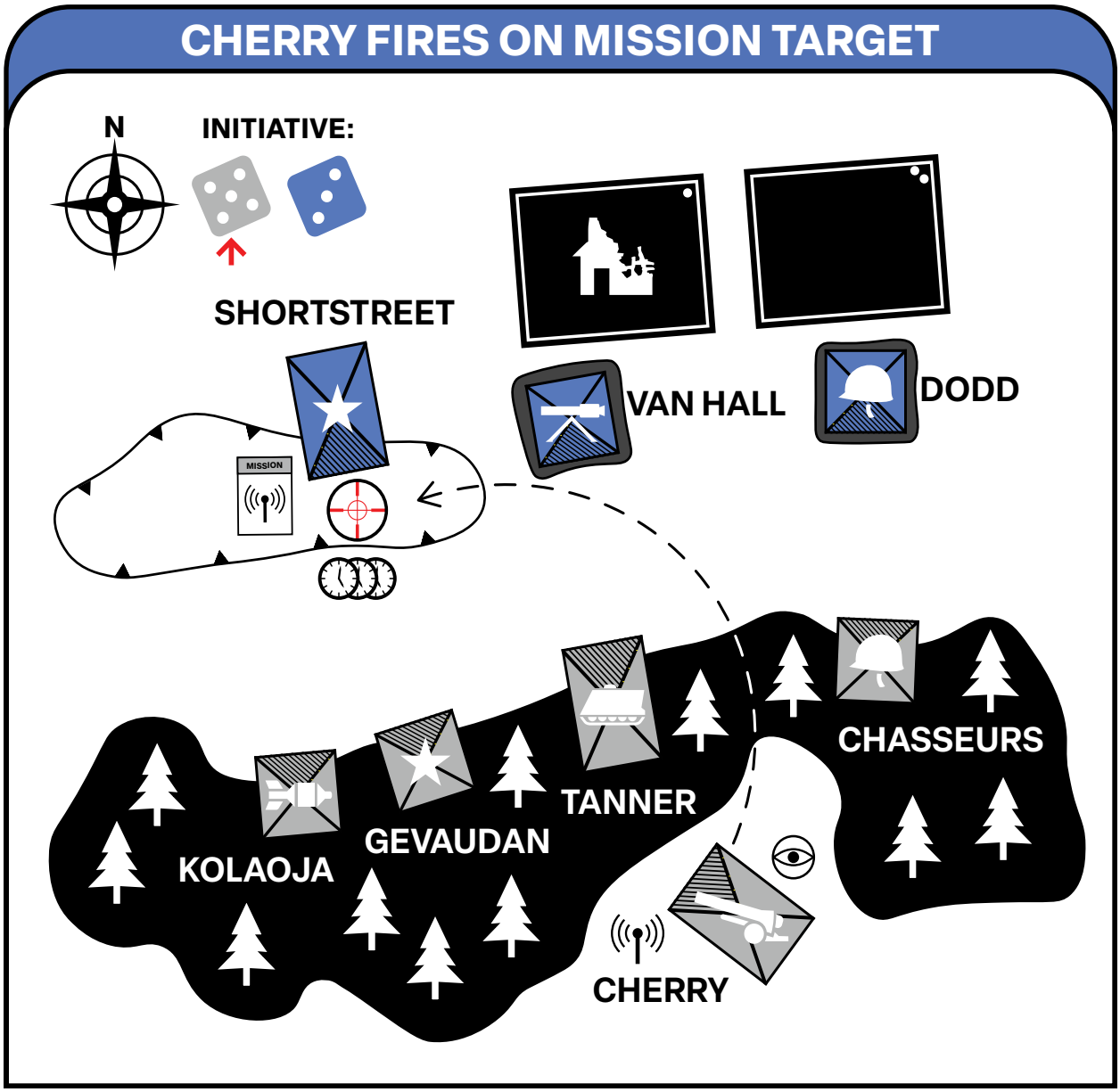
The Federals have no support assets to leverage, and so they pass the Support Phase.



2. **FIRST EBON FOREST FIRE TURN**

With the initiative, the Army of the Ebon Forest has the first Fire Phase turn. Gevaudan's supporting artillery piece, a "Cherry" heavy howitzer to the rear of his troops' positions, responds to the fire mission he called in the Support Phase. It fires smoke shells, beginning a *Heavy Indirect* barrage with a time-to-target of three turns. The Cherry gains a counterbattery token, having fired *Heavy Indirect.*

Although the attack has been started, and the Ebon Forest player's fire turn is over, it will not immediately resolve. For now, there is insufficient smoke to block spotting from (or to) Lieutenant Shortstreet's command tank.



3.

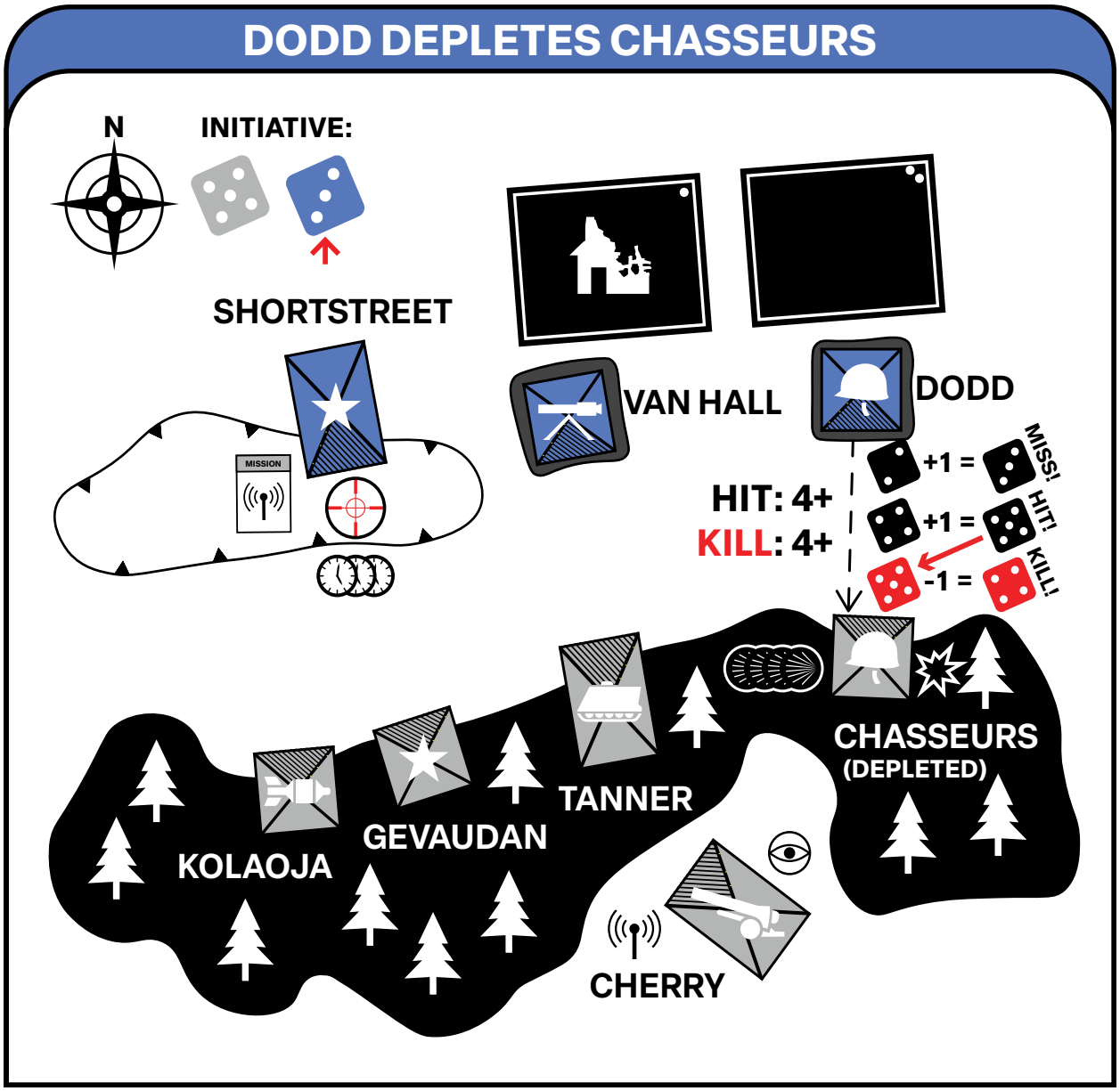
FIRST FEDERAL FIRE TURN

On the Federals' turn, Dodd's infantry squad open fire on the lupar in the treeline with the squad's machine gun. The enemy squad in the treeline, here, is within 6" of their position. Thus, they do not have to blind-fire, even though the lupar have the benefit of ambush from the forest.

The Federals roll two dice, at 4+ to hit. As they are within half range of the enemy, Dodd's machine gun enjoys a +1 Accuracy modifier to both rolls. The dice turn up as a 2 (modified into a 3) and a 4 (modified into a 5), making for one miss and one hit, respectively.

They then roll to kill. The machine gun, at close range, is Strength 1+; the lupar are Toughness 1+, and furthermore enjoy a -1 Cover Modifier from the forest. Though the target number is 4+, the modifier means a 5 or 6 must be rolled to kill. They roll a 5. Although the chasseurs have suffered a kill roll, they are a squad. They are depleted instead of being removed from play.

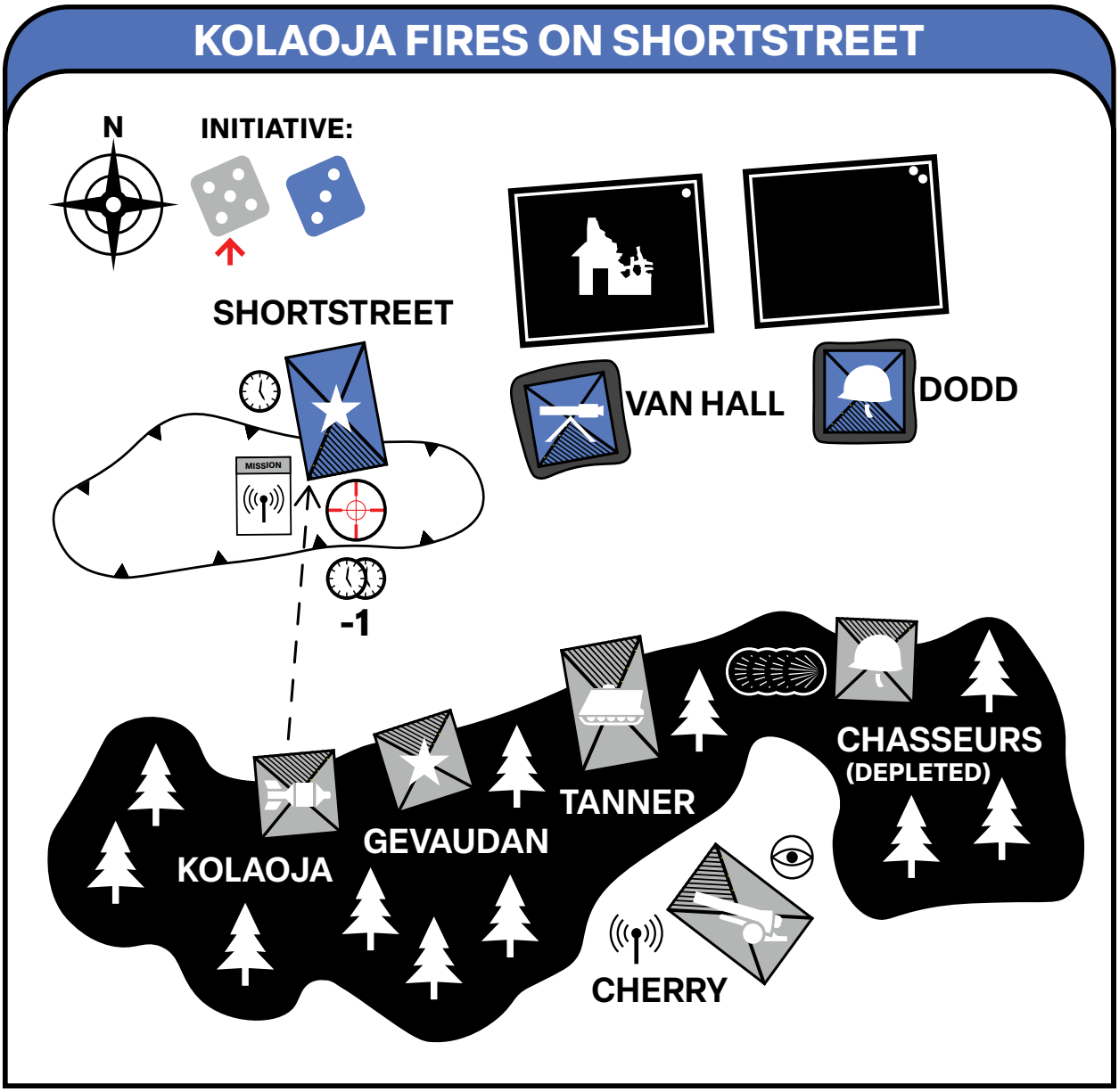
The miss applies one pin, and the depletion three pin. Thus, the lupar squad now has four pin tokens. Its Accuracy is reduced by -2, and its Movement by 4", so long as it keeps that pin.



4. **SECOND EBON FOREST FIRE TURN**

On the Ebon Forest's left flank, Kolaoja's anti-tank guided missile team now fires. This is another time-to-target weapon, aimed at Lieutenant Shortstreet's tank. Being a *Guided Missile* within half range, it gains no Accuracy bonus, but does shave one turn off its time-to-target (reduced from its base value of 2 into 1). Thus, it will resolve its attack on the *next* lupar turn, instead of on two of its player's turns from now.

In addition, the Cherry's artillery smoke mission removes one time-to-target token. It still has two tokens, and thus two lupar turns, left before it resolves. More smoke-shells burst.



5.

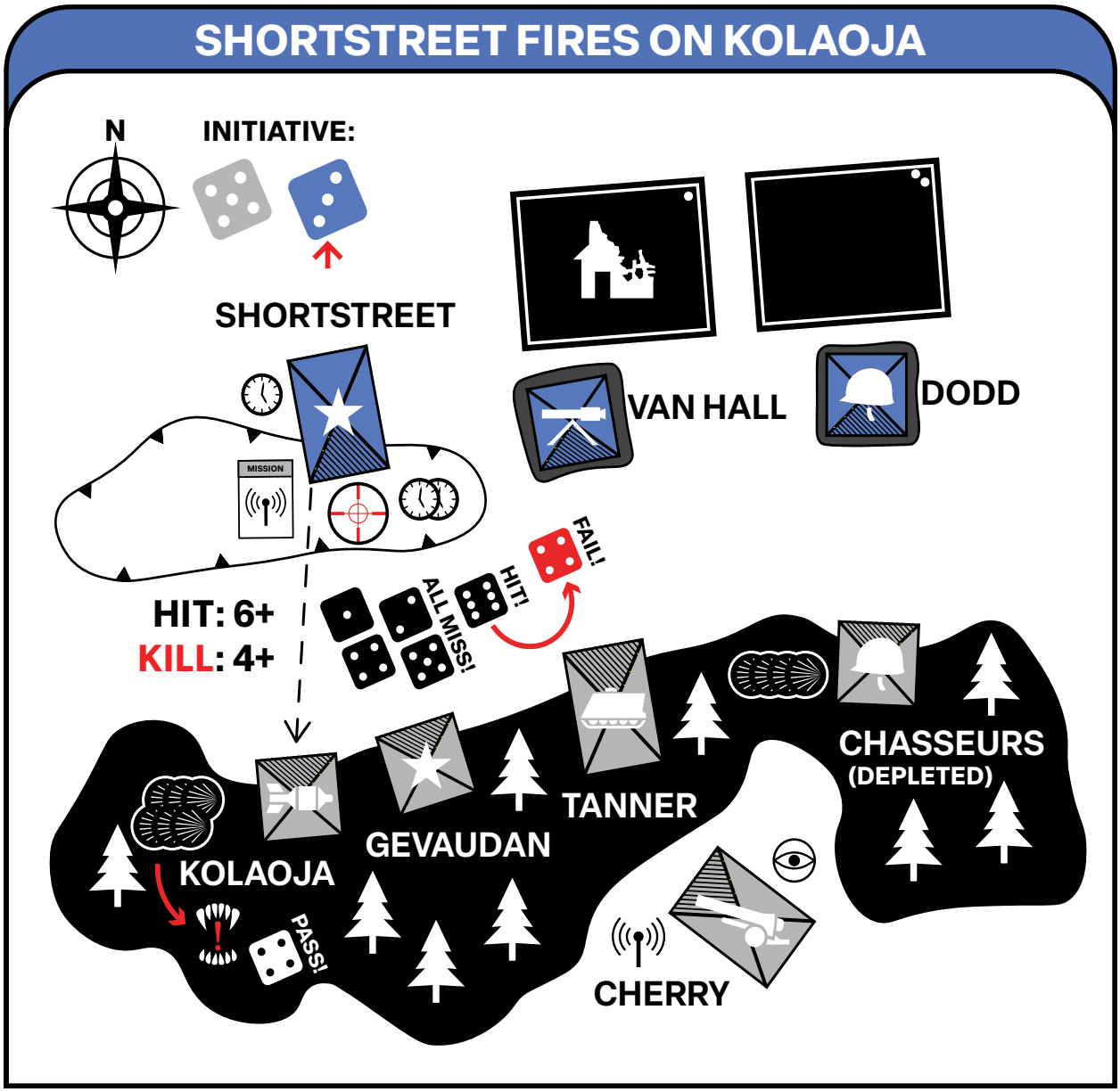
SECOND FEDERAL FIRE TURN

With the missile inbound, Lieutenant Shortstreet must act if the Federal player wishes to protect his TACOM. Seeing that the missile team is within range of his tank's weapons, Shortstreet fires a beehive round at it.

The missile team is within LOS and range, but *not* currently spotted by any Federal. So, the tank must blind-fire. All five of its beehive dice, regardless of their base Accuracy, have a target number of 6+ to-hit. They come up as 1, 2, 4, 5, and 6—four misses, one hit.

Beehive rounds are Strength 1 at long range; their target is Toughness 1. In the forest, the missile team gains a -1 Cover Modifier. Thus, the to-kill roll is 5+. The roll turns up as only a 4; so, the trees stop the incoming flechettes from striking the missile team.

The four misses apply four pin tokens; the failed kill, another three. Since max pin is six, the missile team takes no more than that. Kolaoja's team rolls a 4+ check, according to their *Bloodlust* factional special rule. They roll a 4, passing the check, and do not go berserk.



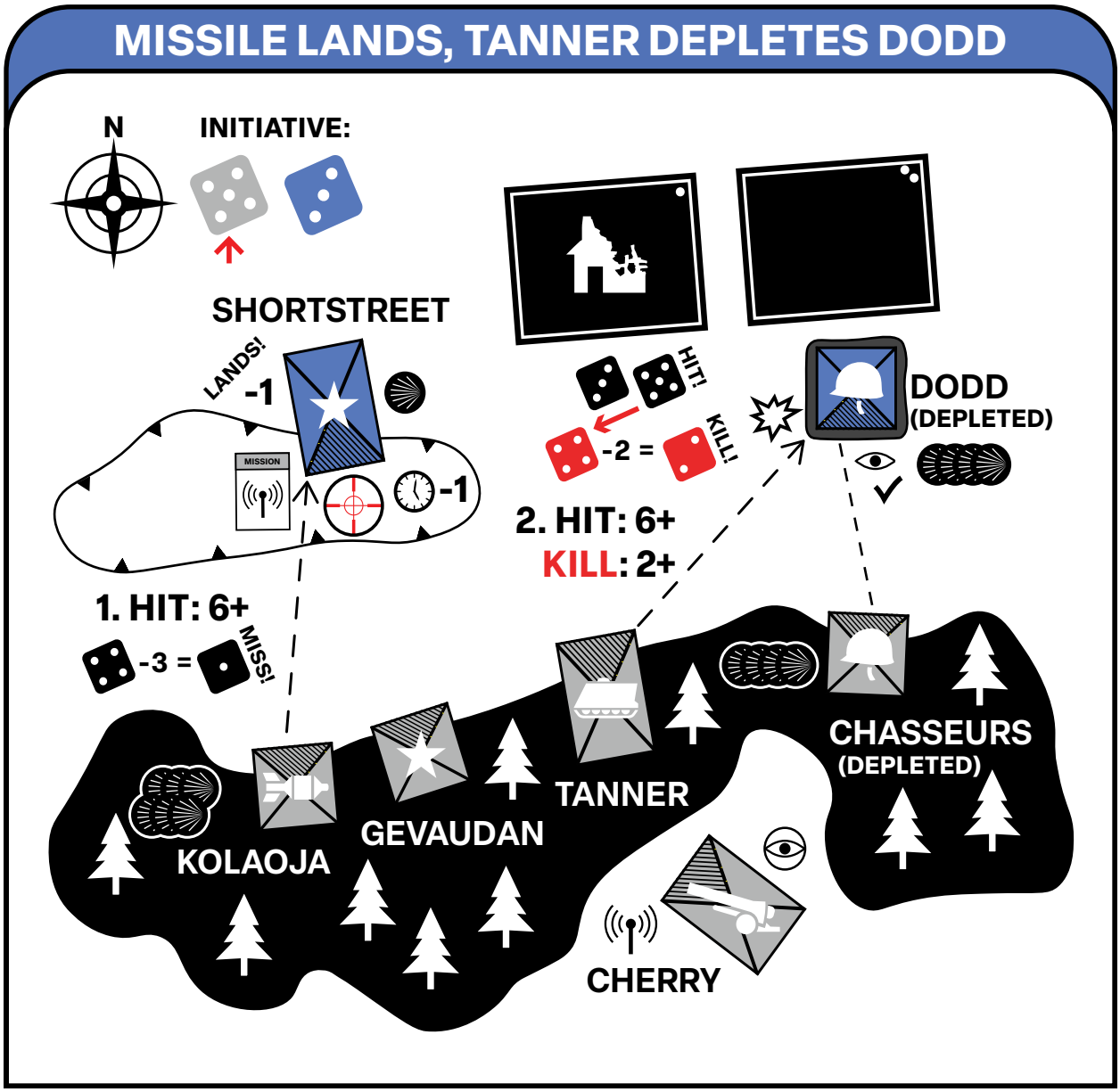
6. **THIRD EBON FOREST FIRE TURN**

It's the lupar turn again, so time-to-target ticks down on the *Guided Missile* and the smoke.

The *Guided Missile* has run out of time-to-target tokens, and the attack now resolves. With six pin on the missile team, the to-hit roll suffers a -3 Accuracy modifier (-1 per two pin). It must roll a 6 to still hit. It rolls a 4, and thus misses. Shortstreet's tank takes 1 pin from the miss.

Since the missile resolution was a free action, the lupar player can still act this turn. The "Tanner" personnel carrier in the treeline fires at Dodd's infantry squad with its heavy machine gun. Although the Federals are in ambush within entrenchments, and are more than 6" from the vehicle, they *are* spotted by the now-depleted Chasseurs. They share their spotting to the vehicle.

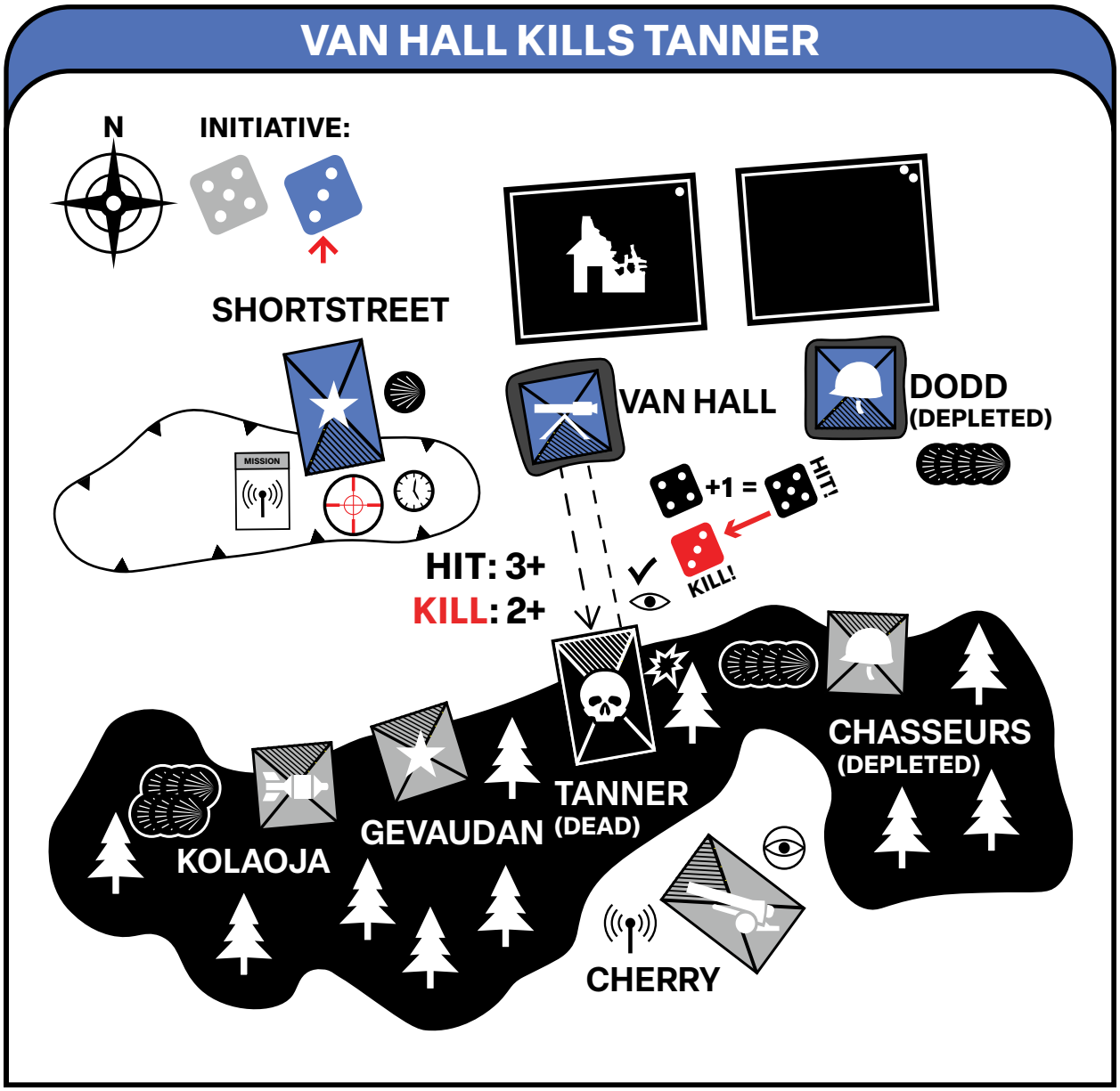
The Tanner rolls two dice, each at a base Accuracy of 4+ to-hit. The results are 3 and 5; thus, one miss and one hit. At Strength 2 against Toughness 1, the to-kill roll is 2+. The entrenchments grant a -2 Cover Modifier against the attack, so a roll of 4 or better will be necessary to kill. The result is a 4, and thus the Federal infantry are depleted. They end up with four pin tokens.



7. **THIRD FEDERAL FIRE TURN**

By firing, the Ebon Forest personnel carrier lost the benefit of ambush (being a vehicle, and not infantry). Now, because it is within the LOS and Spotting Distance of Van Hall's recoilless rifle team, it can be spotted as normal.

Van Hall's recoilless rifle fires, rolling a 4, and succeeding on a 3+ to-hit roll with a +1 half range bonus. The kill roll is Strength 8 against Toughness 4; moreover, as a *Shaped Charge*, it enjoys a further +1 modifier on the to-kill roll against such light armor. This is negated by the Tanner's -1 Cover Modifier. Regardless, Van Hall rolls a 3, killing the Tanner.

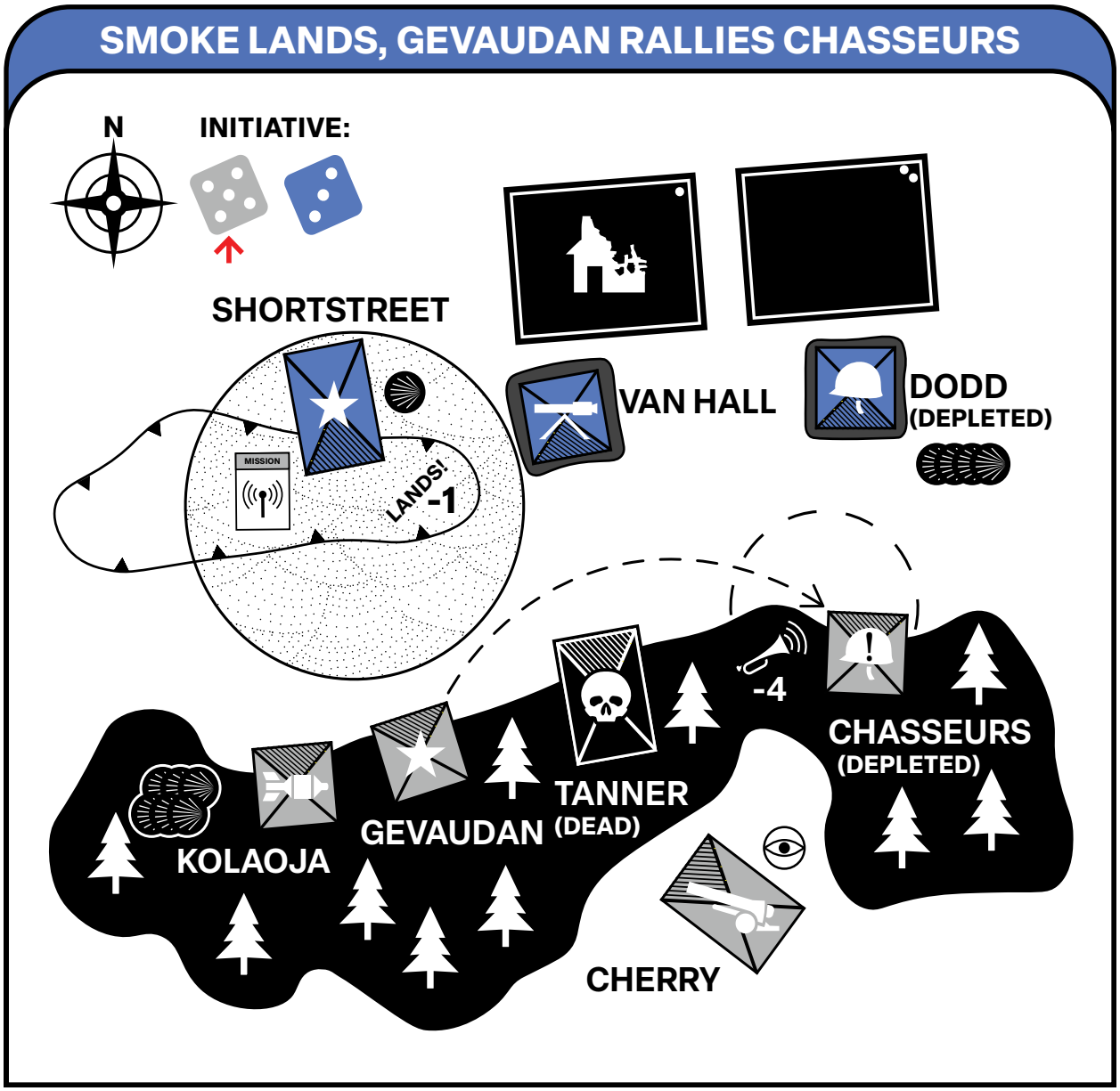


8. **FOURTH EBON FOREST FIRE TURN**

The final time-to-target token on the Ebon Forest artillery barrage has ended, and now it resolves as a free action. As the ammunition fired was *Smoke*, the barrage hits automatically. Instead of doing damage, it lays a *Radius* of thick smoke that breaks spotting (but not LOS).

The Ebon Forest player's main fire action involves Capitaine Gevaudan. He lobs a signal salt grenade at his own depleted chasseurs on the right flank. Within its *Radius*, the chemical scent *Rallies* his depleted chasseurs, removing their pin and refocusing them on the attack. As a *Light Indirect* weapon, he only needs any friendly's LOS—not necessarily his own—to the target point on the ground in order to lob.

The Federals have no further units that can fire in this phase. The lupar could fire with their depleted chasseur squad, but they do not, aiming to sprint instead. The Fire Phase ends and the Maneuver Phase begins.



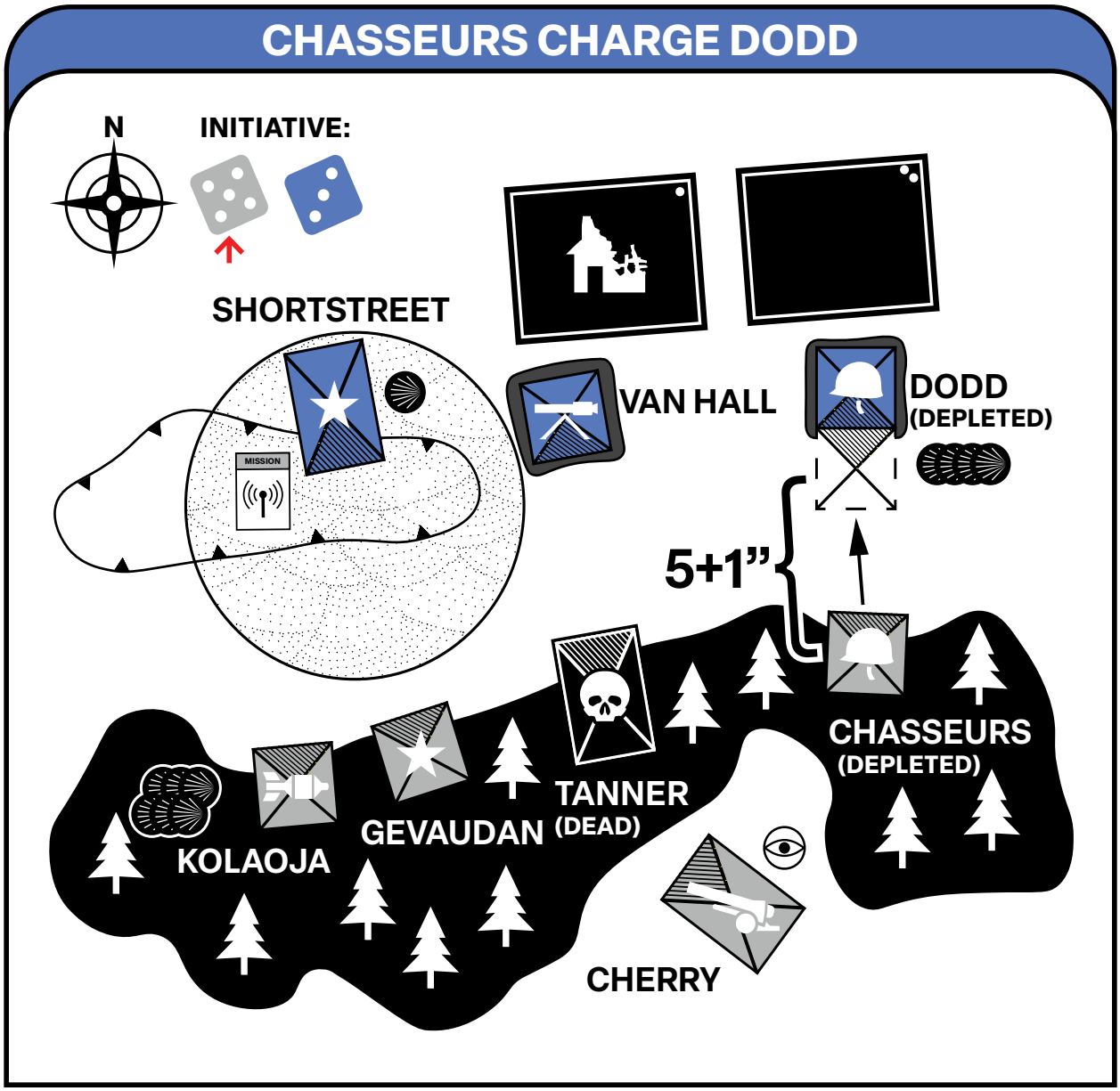
9.

FIRST LUPAR MANEUVER TURN

Having won initiative at the top of the round, the lupar again act first in the phase. While it is not always best to move first in the Maneuver Phase, at such close quarters it plays into the Ebon Forest player's plan.

The depleted chasseurs spend a command token to move forward, charging into close combat against Dodd's entrenched Federals. Since all their pin was stripped by the signal salt, they suffer no penalties to their Movement speed.

Moreover, because they did not fire in the Fire Phase, they get to sprint. They add half their Quality 2 (i.e. 1") to their Movement. This gives them just enough Movement to make basal contact. Were it not for both of these, the charge would have been hopeless.



10.

FIRST FEDERAL MANEUVER TURN, CLOSE COMBAT

The Federals have no units able to join the close combat engagement, and are unwilling to quit their defenses. The Federal player declares no further movements. The Ebon Forest player agrees. Thus, the round moves onto the Close Combat Phase.

...

CLOSE COMBAT ENGAGEMENT

The actions of the close combat engagement happen simultaneously. Both engaged units start off by declaring their attacks and choosing their weapons. The Federals once again use their machine gun; the lupar draw their machetes. In both cases, think of these as the "standout" weapon of the close combat action. Rifles, grenades, bayonets and other arms are certainly being used as well.

In close combat, all fire is stationary, and enjoys the +1 half range Accuracy bonus. The Federals' base to-hit number is 4+, but they are suffering a cumulative -1 to hit because the half range bonus is being overwhelmed by -2 Accuracy from their current pin. As a result, they're roling at an overall disadvantage. The Federal infantry roll a 1 and a 6, modified into a 0 and 5, respectively: one hit. This is likely their only chance to take the Chasseurs out, even if they have to go down with them.

Even if the Federals manage to kill all the Chasseurs, however, the close combat is still simultaneous. The lupar have their chance to counter-attack no matter what. With machetes, they roll two dice, and at Accuracy 1+ with no pin, they needn't roll at all to score two hits.

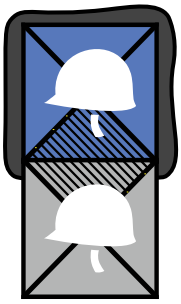
Now it's time to roll kills on both sides. In close combat, no pin is generated, so the Federals' miss is simply discarded. Using half range Strength, Dodd's squad pits Strength 1+ against Toughness 1+, for a 4+ to-kill roll. But they score only a 3, and fail to kill the few remaining lupar. The lupar do not accrue pin from this failed kill.

The chasseurs' machetes are Strength 1. As Cover Modifiers do not apply to close combat, the Federals do not benefit from their entrenchments, and rely simply on their base Toughness 1. Once again, the to-kill roll is a 4+. The lupar roll a 4 and a 5, scoring two kills.

The lupar win the engagement, cutting down the Federal infantrymen in close quarters. They use their overrun move to spend an inch to enter the entrenchments.

DODD AND CHASSEURS' CLOSE COMBAT

1. BEAT COMMENCES

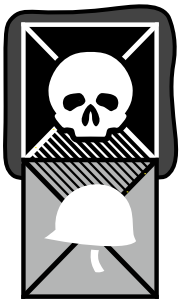


DODD
(DEPLETED)

CHASSEURS
(DEPLETED)

HIT: 4+
KILL: 4+

2.

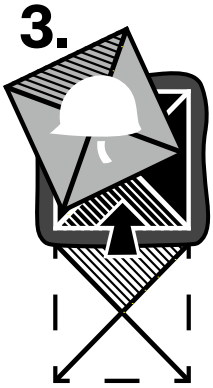


DODD
(DEAD)

CHASSEURS
(DEPLETED)

HIT: 1+
KILL: 4+

3.



DODD
(DEAD)

CHASSEURS
(DEPLETED)

BEAT ENDS
DOGS WIN
& OVERRUN

7-12 - A ROUND OF FIRELOCK EXPLAINED

APPENDIX A - UNIT SPECIAL RULES

This appendix section lists every generic unit special rule in Firelock 198X. For faction-specific unit special rules, consult each faction's field manual.

Active/Decoy Protection (X)

This unit is fitted with one of two protective systems, forcing certain incoming attacks to confirm hits. They cannot be reloaded, but may trigger *X* times before running out of ammo.

i. Trigger conditions

Protection of either type cannot trigger on units carrying desanting infantry, nor against *Radius* attacks. Triggering is voluntary. You must declare whether you are using it or not *before* the roll to kill.

Active Protection may trigger against *Slow Rounds*, and *Decoy Protection* against *Radar Anti-Air*; both may trigger against *Guided Missiles*. *Protection* can't be activated multiple times per attack resolution.

Decoy Protection is unusable by landed aircraft. If triggered during close combat, it only lasts for the beat in which it was triggered.

ii. Effects

When *Protection* triggers, one ammo is spent to affect a certain number of dice from eligible attacks during a simultaneous attack resolution. Attacks from multiple different weapons may be affected by a single *Protection* activation so long as those dice came from eligible weapons.

Active Protection forces one die which hit in a single attack, once per turn or beat, to be confirmed at an unmodifiable 6+ to-hit.

Decoy Protection affects *all* eligible dice. It forces confirms at the original target numbers, with the same modifiers.

Failed confirm rolls in either case result in misses that apply three pin.

Afterburner

If this plane waves off, and is not already at max pin, it may choose to both rotate 180 degrees *and* make a full move in the same action, in exchange for one pin.

Amphibious

This unit may swim through deep water, without any movement penalty. It must pay 1" of Movement to enter or exit Swamps and Deep Water.

Assault Specialist

This infantry unit is specially trained and equipped for close-quarters battle.

If it charges into close combat, then combat with it will *not* be simultaneous in all beats of the engagement. In each beat, it may resolve its attacks first; then, other units (friendly and enemy) will get to simultaneously act as normal.

Opposing *Assault Specialists* resolve combat simultaneously and before other units in the engagement. Embarked and desanting units don't benefit from being *Assault Specialists*.

Assault Specialists that are the defenders in close combat behave as normal, i.e. they do not resolve their attacks first.

Brigade (X, Y")

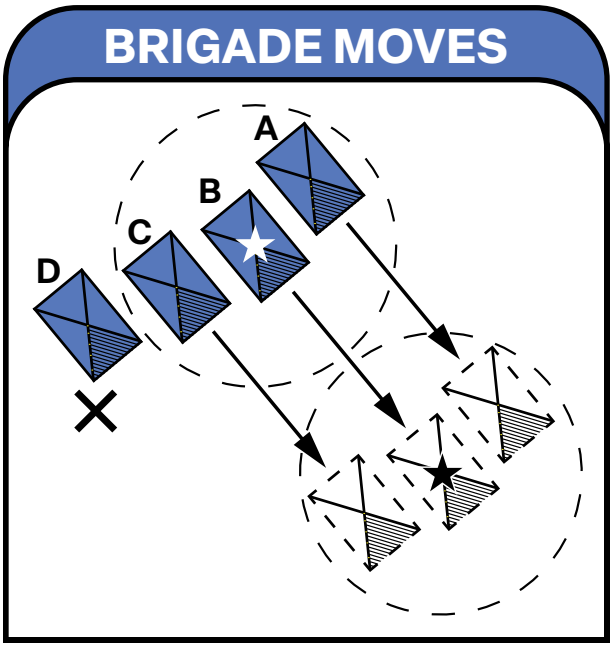
This unit (the **brigadier**) may spend a command token to declare a **brigade move** in the Maneuver Phase. A "brigade move" does not literally mean a "brigade-level" movement—it's just jargon to describe movements coordinated by an officer.

When executing a brigade move, you must indicate which unit is the brigadier. The brigadier may move as normal. Then, up to *X* additional friendly units may also move in the same turn, so long as they remain within a Radius of *Y* inches from the brigadier at the start and end of movement.

Neither those units, nor the brigadier, are eligible to move again in the same Maneuver Phase—they just moved already!

Infantry units participating in a brigade move can embark or disembark from vehicles as part of it, but not both in the same move.

Units which cannot move cannot participate in brigades.



Unit B declares a brigade move targeting Units A and C. All of them simultaneously move on Unit B's turn, and must end their move within Unit B's radius. Unit D is too far away to participate.

Fearless

This infantry unit does not lose movement from pin tokens.

Loiter

This plane's tight turning circle and low stall speed permit it to loiter in place. It may choose to stop moving forward at any point during a Fire Phase movement.

At the end of the Fire Phase, it may choose to stay on-map, holding its target between rounds. It may still be given new targets through support missions, in which case its new strafing line is drawn from its current position through that of the target. The plane does not have to reenter the board, but may simply choose to resume moving to the target from its current position.

NBC

This unit has nuclear, biological, and chemical protection. It, and units embarked inside of it, do not suffer kill rolls from *Chemical Weapons* or Scorched terrain (see **APPENDIX I**).

Paradrop

This unit may **parachute** onto the table, from unseen heavy transport aircraft, as a form of special deployment.

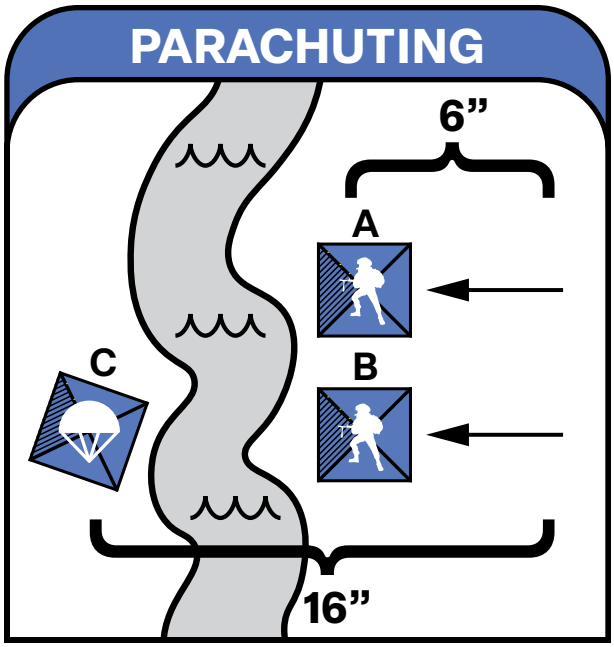
Parachute deployment happens after all other units deploy normally, after which they take turns deploying. Parachuters may deploy anywhere on the board, so long as they are not spotted by an enemy, or within 8" of an enemy unit, deployment zone, deployment board edge, or objective.

Parachuting units do *not* get a deployment move. During deployment, parachuting vehicles may not tow anything, or carry embarked or desanting infantry.

After deployment, parachuting units gain two pin per every non-parachuting enemy with Air or All-targeting weapons (which have a chance of killing the parachuter) within half range.

Those enemies that cannot possibly kill the parachuter—out of arc, carrying desants, not enough Strength, or otherwise—don't apply pin. LOS is not factored when determining this, meaning that terrain shadow and occluding terrain is ignored when factoring what units apply pin. These pin tokens are *not* lost during the first Support Phase's Upkeep.

Dummies may be deployed as parachuters, even if your faction's roster has no units with *Paradrop*.



Units A and B have deployed at the table edge, as normal, and move 6 inches toward a river. Later, Unit C parachutes 16" from the table edge without taking a subsequent move action, landing across the river well forward of Units A and B.

PC (X, Arcs)

This vehicle or aircraft is a **personnel carrier**, capable of carrying up to *X* infantry units inside itself, in addition to any desanting infantry on the exterior (if a vehicle). As when desanting, squads count as two teams when determining capacity. (For example, a *PC (2)* carrier can embark two teams or one squad.)

Embarked infantry must disembark the vehicle from the listed *Arcs*. Aircraft must land to embark or disembark carried infantry.

A carrier can embark as many dummies as you'd like, even if it is already full of real infantry.

i. Trigger conditions

Carried infantry may not use their weapons except for *Small Arms*. They may fire at stationary accuracy without losing their subsequent Maneuver Phase action (or that of their carrier). They use the carrier's pin when attacking, not their own. They may draw LOS and spot from their carrier.

A carrier may use its own weapons normally while carrying infantry. As with the carrier's weapons, the presence of desanting infantry blocks embarked infantry from firing.

ii. Pin & targeting

Carried infantry cannot be directly targeted or hit by attacks on the carrier, and do not accrue pin from being attacked. They do not inherit the carrier's pin when they disembark.

When a carrier is destroyed, teams inside it are killed and squads are depleted. Any infantry in an airborne carrier that are killed are removed from play immediately.

iii. Close combat

Embarked infantry are obligated combatants. They can fight in close combat, but cannot screen the vehicle. Embarked infantry in a carrier that is destroyed suffer the usual kill result, but do not accrue pin.

Resupply (X)

This unit can **reload** up to *X* Ammo (for any number of weapons) to one friendly unit during Upkeep. That friendly must be within 6". LOS and spotting are not required to reload. *Resupply* units cannot reload themselves, nor can they resupply airborne units.

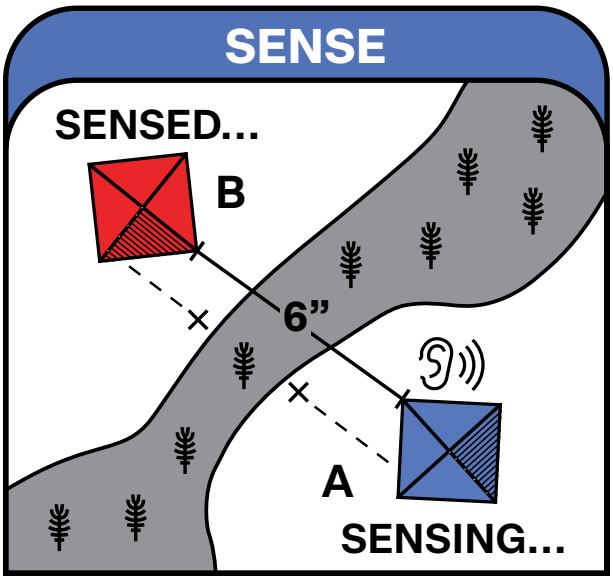
For every unit of Ammo granted to a friendly, this unit spends one point of *Resupply*.

Reloading gives up the *Resupply* unit's move action in that round's Maneuver Phase. It may still fire in the Fire Phase.

Sense (X")

This unit can spot all enemy units within *X* inches, even without LOS. If it is a TACOM, it may call missions on those spotted enemies as well. Embarked units cannot spot with, or be spotted by, *Sense*. As with normal spotting, you can choose not to spot with *Sense*.

Sense is measured edge-to-edge, not center-to-center like a *Radius*.



Unit A and Unit B are both too short to look over the fields. Unit A senses Unit B without LOS from an edge-to-edge distance of 6" away. Unit B cannot detect Unit A whatsoever.

Tow (X)

This unit may tow any friendly vehicle with a (highest arc) toughness of *X* or less.

i. Hitching & chains

To **hitch** a vehicle to a tower, the tower must be in basal contact on its rear arc with the front or rear arc of a towable vehicle. The hitched vehicle then moves with the tower at the tower's speed, remaining behind it until the tower **unhitches** it.

A tower may choose to hitch or unhitch any vehicle once, at any point during its movement, but it may not hitch or unhitch multiple times. A unit can't be both hitched and unhitched in the same round.

Units which fired stationary or have already moved themselves cannot be hitched. Units which were moved by a tower count as having used their move action.

If the towed unit also has *Tow*, you can form a **tow chain** of vehicles. Sum the highest Toughnesses of all units within to see if the tower can haul the chain.

ii. Unit class traits

Carriages may be hitched even if they already moved in the Maneuver Phase; they do not count as having moved when their tower moves, allowing them to be activated to use their own move action for a separate command token after being unhitched.

Aircraft may only hitch and unhitch towed units while airborne. They cannot land while towing, nor form tow chains, and they cannot both land and unhitch in the same turn. Units under airborne tow are considered aircraft for targeting purposes. Conversely, landed aircraft may be towed as if vehicles.

iii. Movement & firing

Towers and towed units activate and move as one, using the towing unit's Movement statistic. For every full 45 degrees (past the first, which is free) that a tower rotates, it must pay 1" of movement per unit under tow (including those in a chain).

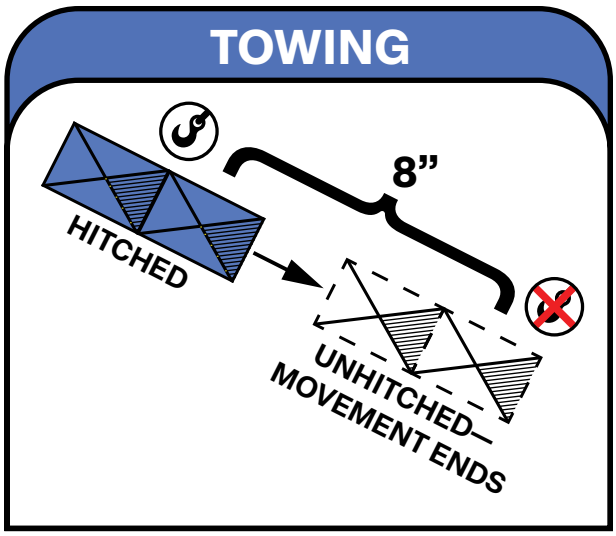
Towing units can fire all weapons. Towed units may only fire *Small Arms*.

Landed aircraft under tow that are moved into occluding terrain (that they couldn't land in) cannot take off from said terrain later.

iv. Deployment under tow

Deploy a tower first, with its rear arc touching the edge of the map as normal. Then move it forward and place the towed unit in basal contact at the rear. Repeat this for tow chains.

If there is not enough space to fit a towed unit, it must deploy on a separate turn during the Maneuver Phase.



Unit A starts in back-to-front basal contact with Unit B. Unit A previously hitched Unit B. It moves 8", then unhitches at the end of its turn.

v. Close combat with tows

All units in a tow chain are considered to be in the same close combat no matter what part of the chain was charged. Tow chains can't reform, but may fall back.

Watercraft

This unit is a boat of some kind. It can only move and unhitch onto Swamps, Shallow and Deep Water. When moving through Deep Water, it enjoys a 2x Movement multiplier. It cannot be towed by ground units: only by other *Watercraft* or aircraft.

APPENDIX B - WEAPON SPECIAL RULES

This appendix section lists every generic weapon special rule in Firelock 198X. For faction-specific weapon special rules, consult each faction's field manual.

Air-Filling

This weapon's misses apply *two* pin rather than one unless the weapon cannot possibly kill its target. For weapons with variable Strength, roll Strength even on a miss.

Barrage (X) / Barrage (X, Point)

This weapon may simultaneously fire up to *X* times in one fire action. Each attack consumes one Ammo and may use a different shot type. Declare the number of attacks *before* resolving. Targets can be spaced up to 2" away from each other unless the weapon is *Barrage (X, Point)*.

The first *Barrage* attack called in a fire mission must be directly on target and within the firer's LOS. The rest can be spaced 2" from each other regardless of LOS to the firer.

Chemical Weapon (X")

This *Lingering* weapon has a *Radius* of *X* inches. Embarked infantry are affected, but airborne units are not.

Ground units inside *Chemical Weapons* cannot lose more than one pin at once by any means (including via Upkeep pin loss or *Rally*).

They cannot participate in brigades or in support missions (although they can still be targeted by one).

During Upkeep, any non-*NBC* unit affected by *Chemical Weapons* suffers an unmodifiable 6+ to-kill roll. A unit standing inside multiple *Chemical Weapon* radii only rolls for one kill.

Defensive CC / Defensive CC (Inf.)

This weapon cannot be fired if the unit charged into close combat; if tagged *(Inf.)*, the weapon can be fired at aircraft and vehicles, but not infantry.

Designator

This is a laser or mechanical target designator that provides the precise location of the target it's aimed at. It causes its target to become immediately spotted. Mark it with a **designator token**.

Designation is maintained indefinitely, round after round, so long as the designator is alive, doesn't fire at a new target with any weapon, doesn't move, and the target remains within weapon arc, range, and the designator's LOS.

Designators fired simultaneously with other weapons can immediately spot for them. *Designators* can't be fired or maintained through *Smoke*, or if the firer is at max pin. Currently designating units that reach max pin have their designation broken immediately.

Support missions can target designated units, even if the target isn't within LOS of the calling TACOM.

Designators can target planes.

Discreet

This weapon does not identify the firer, nor causes the firer to lose concealment. You needn't indicate which unit fired it.

Firing a *Discreet* weapon on a vehicle with desanting dummies still causes the dummies to disappear.

Door Gun (Arcs)

This aircraft weapon may fire while landed, but it may *only* fire in the listed arc(s). If a unit with this weapon charges into close combat, but has no weapons that can fire in its frontal arc, the unit may may rotate to use one of its armed arcs against the defending unit.

Guided Missile (X)

This is a guided missile that may be steered in flight, but which flies much more slowly than most projectiles. It is a time-to-target weapon that takes *X* turns to resolve after being fired.

Guided Missiles do not gain half range Accuracy bonuses. Instead, they reduce time-to-target by one within half range. Air-targeting *Guided Missiles* may target planes, and never confirm hits against airborne targets.

Guided Missiles are susceptible to *Active/Decoy Protection*. Remember: *Active Protection* won't trigger if the *Guided Missile* has a *Radius*.

Heavy / Light Indirect (X)

This weapon conducts indirect fire barrages that are slowly "walked" onto the target by observing the fall-of-shot. It is a time-to-target weapon that takes *X* of your Fire Phase turns to resolve after you fired it.

Indirect weapons do not benefit from half range bonuses at all, whether to their Accuracy or reduced time-to-target. A roll result of 6 on an *Indirect* to-hit roll, if not blind-fire, counts as a *Rear Attack*.

Indirect weapons are divided into Light and Heavy categories, depending on their size and level of authority needed to call their fire.

i. Light Indirect

Light Indirect weapons include mortars and other low-level fire support. They do not cause the firer to be identified (if blind) when fired. They still cause firing vehicles to lose the benefit of ambush.

Light Indirect weapons may fire upon targets not within their own LOS, so long as the target is within LOS of another friendly unit on the board.

While units with *Light Indirect* weapons may choose to respond to an indirect fire mission, they do not require a mission to fire on targets outside of their own LOS.

ii. Heavy Indirect

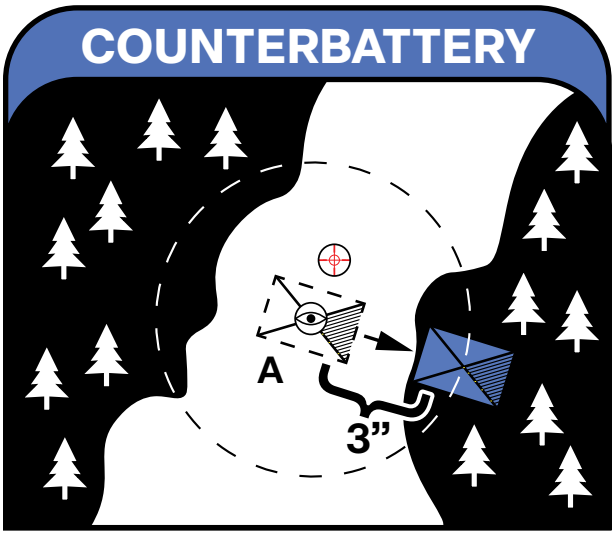
Heavy Indirect weapons include artillery pieces. They may fire upon units within their own LOS as normal, but if they want to fire upon a unit outside of their own LOS, they require an indirect fire mission to do so.

A *Heavy Indirect* weapon that fires creates a **counterbattery token**. A unit with a counterbattery token counts as spotted to all enemy units on the field, even if no individual unit is able to directly draw LOS to it.

Counterbattery tokens are *not* removed until the end of the next round's Support Phase. If a unit with a counterbattery token moves, the unit loses the counterbattery token. The token **lingers** at the formerly-spotted unit's original position.

If, in the ensuing Fire Phase, the *Heavy Indirect* weapon does not fire again (i.e. does not gain a new counterbattery token), and is not otherwise spotted, that fire mission will become a de facto blind-fire once the counterbattery token is removed at the end of Upkeep.

Heavy Indirect weapons cannot fire if the unit is concealed, due to dangerous obstruction of the weapon by overhead cover.



Unit A had a counterbattery spotting token. It has moved 3" away, leaving the token on the ground where it once stood. A Radius 3" attack is declared on the token, which is wide enough to hit Unit A regardless. However, the attack is now blind-fire.

Homing

This *Guided Missile* has a fire and forget seeker. Once it has been declared, its to-hit roll cannot be modified by anything except by the target's Evasion or *Smoke*. Even if the firer dies, or spotting/LOS to the target is lost, the attack continues unmodified by anything but the above two mechanics.

Homing attacks always resolve, even if the target exits the board, while all other attacks miss.

Ignore Cover (X)

This weapon ignores up to *X* points of the target's Cover Modifier.

Lingering

This *Radius*'s effects persist on the table after it has landed. Units inside a Lingering *Radius* are hit according to the weapon's Accuracy statistic when it lands. If they are still inside the *Radius* during subsequent Upkeeps, they are hit automatically. The to-kill rolls (if it has Strength) do not apply pin on failed kills.

If a *Lingering* weapon has multiple dice, it creates a number of separate radii (as if a thicker cloud) on the same point. These independently roll to kill.

After all Upkeep to-kill rolls, roll once (per each radius). On a 4+, the *Radius* persists. Otherwise, it dissipates and is removed from play.

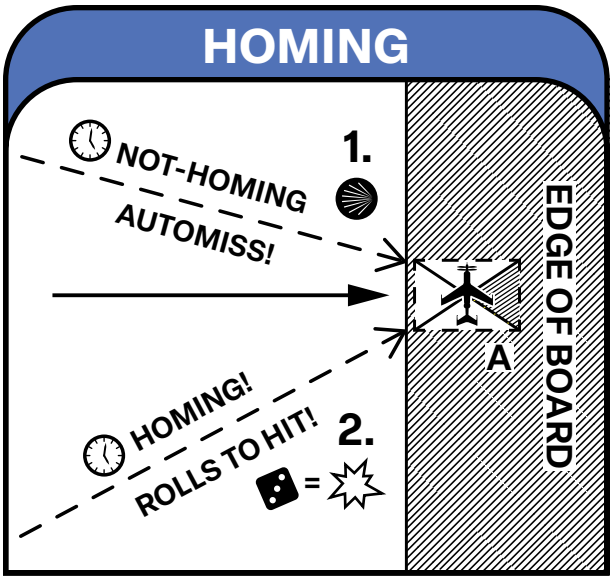
MCLOS

This *Guided Missile* is manually steered by a gunner, instead of automatically following his reticle. Consequently it demands intense concentration and is easier to throw off.

For *each* pin token on the firer (not two), this weapon suffers a -1 Accuracy modifier.

Melee

This weapon may target an enemy in any of its arcs, but only in Close Combat. It does not benefit from half range. Can't be used in Close Combats across impassable terrain.



Unit A is a plane being pursued by two attacks by guided missiles: one is Homing, and the other is not. Unit A exits the board before either can land. The non-Homing attack was fired first, so it resolves and automatically misses. The Homing attack resolves next. It can still try to hit at 3+. The attack rolls a 3, and the missile hits!

Multi-Gun

This weapon may be simultaneously fired with other weapons on this unit, including other *Multi-Guns*, during a single fire action. It may be used against a different target from that of the "main" weapon.

No CC / No CC (Inf.)

This weapon cannot fire at all in close combat; if tagged *(Inf.)*, the weapon can be fired at aircraft and vehicles, but not infantry.

Nuclear (X"-Y"-Z")

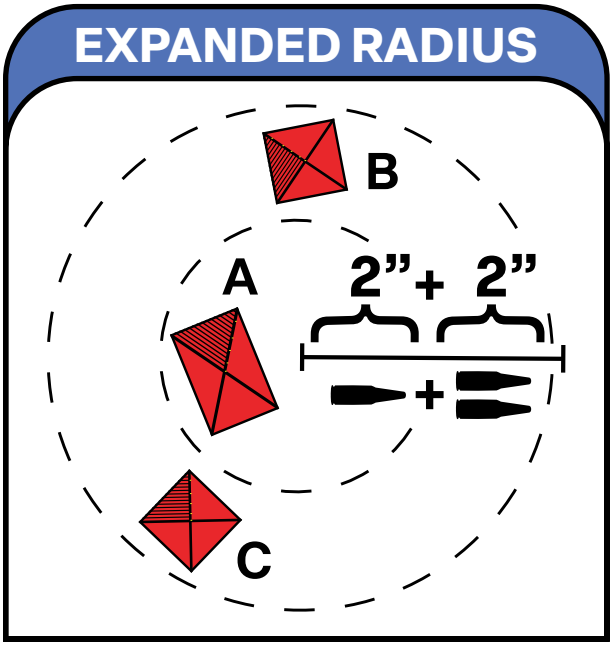
The final argument. See **APPENDIX I**.

Radius (X") / Radius (X-Y")

This weapon affects all units (except planes) whose base centers are within *X* inches of its impact point, regardless of LOS. If it has Accuracy, it rolls *independently* to hit each unit covered. *Radius* attacks against unspotted units are considered blind-firing.

A *Radius (X"-Y")* weapon has a base Radius of *X* inches. It can expand its *Radius* in increments of one inch, up to *Y* inches, by spending one Ammo per extra inch. This does not create multiple attacks, but only increases the *Radius* of a single attack. The base *Radius* still only costs one Ammo.

Radii can potentially hit friendly units. It is permissible to call a *Radius* attack on enemy units that hits some of your own units if the majority of units in the *Radius* are of the enemy or the attack is of pressing importance. Remember: friendly fire always counts as spotted (i.e. Murphy's Law applies).



The area is being struck by a Radius (2-4") attack. The initial Radius of 2" is only large enough to affect Unit A in the center, and only one Ammo is spent. However, if the firer spends an extra two Ammo, he may add an extra +2" to the attack's Radius, which can then strike Unit B and Unit C.

Radar/Tracking Anti-Air

This is an anti-aircraft weapon. It has sufficient gunlaying capabilities to target planes.

Tracking Anti-Air weapons do not have to confirm attacks against aircraft within 12". They are not susceptible to *Decoy Protection*.

Radar Anti-Air weapons do not have to confirm hits against aircraft at any range. They also blind-fire at aircraft at 4+ (or base accuracy, if worse), *even if* blocked by *Smoke*. They are susceptible to *Decoy Protection*.

Rally

This weapon restores friendly units' fighting spirits. Any friendly unit targeted by this weapon immediately loses all of its pin tokens. It may always be fired at max pin.

If a *Rally* weapon fires simultaneously with others, its pin-clearing effect applies before the other weapons resolve.

Rear Attack

This weapon strikes either the top or rear of a target (i.e. its thinnest armor). Its attacks automatically hit the target's weakest arc, regardless of the firer and targets' positions.

Scoped

This weapon is equipped with a powerful magnified optic, making it easier to find targets that are not fully visible. It blind-fires at 4+ unless firing through *Smoke*, and gains *Ignore Cover (1)* against infantry.

Scoped weapons with *Thermal Sights* blind-fire through *Smoke* at 4+.

Shaped Charge

This weapon is a powerful explosive penetrator. It does *not* use its second Strength value as half range Strength.

When hitting vehicles at any range, it uses its first Strength value. If this Strength is greater than the target's Toughness, add a +1 modifier to its kill roll (before any Cover Modifiers).

1+ attacks that are modified by *Shaped Charge* become ++ and apply two kills when they hit.

When hitting infantry at any range, this weapon uses its second Strength value, and gains *Ignore Cover (1)*. A Shaped Charge that hits desanting infantry uses its first Strength value, since they are tightly clustered.

Slow Round

While not slow enough to qualify as time-to-target, this projectile is large and slow enough to trigger *Active Protection*.

Small Arm

This is a man-portable, shoulder-fired weapon. It may be fired at stationary Accuracy while embarked, both in the Fire Phase and in close combat. It may target enemies in any of the firer's arcs.

Smoke (X")

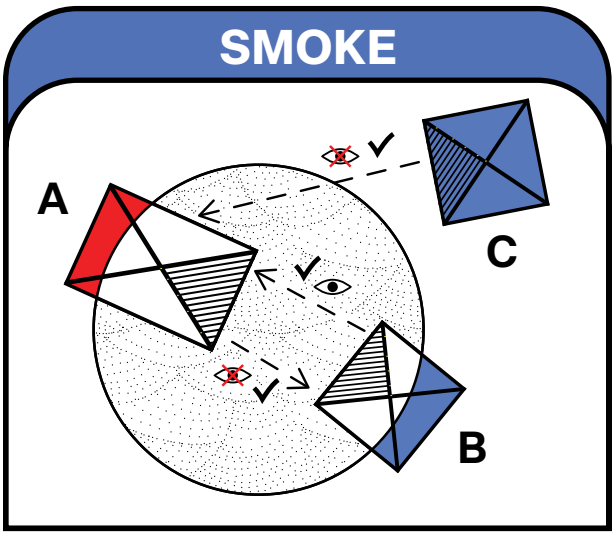
All Smoke weapons have a *Radius* of *X* inches, and are *Lingering*. Only LOS, not spotting, can be drawn through (or into) *Smoke*. Fire through (or into) *Smoke* is thus always blind-fire unless the target is otherwise spotted (e.g. via *Thermal Sights*). In that case, it incurs a -1 Accuracy modifier.

Airborne units are flying high enough to look over *Smoke* clouds. The only way for spotting to be blocked to and from an airborne unit and another unit is if a ground unit is directly inside of a *Smoke* radius.

Smoke fired simultaneously with other weapons does not block spotting until after their attacks resolve.

A *Smoke* weapon with a Strength, unlike other *Lingering* weapons, only hits targets when landing, not during subsequent Upkeeps.

Designators are blocked by *Smoke*. TACOMs cannot call missions through *Smoke*, unless the TACOM itself is spotting the target via Sense. LOS through *Smoke* cannot be used for friendly indirect fire.



Unit A and Unit B are in a cloud of Smoke. Unit A does not have Thermal Sights, so its attack on Unit B does not count as spotted. Unit B does, so it spots Unit A for the duration of its attack and does not have to blind-fire upon it. Unit C also fires at Unit A, but it doesn't benefit from Unit B's Thermal Sights, and must blind-fire as well.

Standoff

This plane weapon can be guided towards its target while the pilot is maneuvering away from the battlefield.

When a *Standoff* weapon is fired, the plane which fired it may choose to immediately rotate 90 degrees clockwise and remain stationary until the attack is resolved.

When the *Standoff* attack resolves, the plane which fired it rotates *another* 90 degrees clockwise (for a 180 degree total turn) and begins automatically waving off the board, returning to the direction from whence it came.

Strafing

If this weapon is fired at moving Accuracy, the helicopter must *immediately* move itself forward 12" without rotating after the attack is resolved. A strafing attack cannot be declared if the movement would result in a charge.

Turret

This weapon is mounted on a turret with 360 degrees of traversal. It may target an enemy in any of its firers' arcs, not just its front.

Thermal Sights

This weapon can see through *Smoke* when attacking. It still accrues the -1 Accuracy penalty from firing through *Smoke* at a spotted unit unless the weapon is also *Homing*, in which case the fire suffers no penalty.

Thermal sights in this era are limited in capability. They do not allow a unit to proactively spot through *Smoke* for friendlies, to spot for indirect fire, or to identify enemy blinds. They only negate *Smoke* for this weapon's own attack on its own turn.

Scoped weapons with *Thermal Sights* blind-fire through *Smoke* at 4+.

Planes with *Thermal Sights* still can't spot for themselves, but they fire at -1 Accuracy through *Smoke* if the target would have been spotted by a friendly if not for the *Smoke's* presence.

Underbarrel (X)

This weapon is mounted under the barrel of a parent weapon, *X*. It may be fired simultaneously with that weapon, at the same target. The *Underbarrel* weapon uses its parent's Accuracy and half range modifier.

Underbarrel weapons benefit from *Thermal Sights, Small Arm*, and *Scoped* if the parent weapon has these.

Undetectable

This trap is exceptionally hard to locate before it's too late. When moving 2" or less, this trap may roll a 6+ check to trigger regardless. The trap does not consume Ammo if the 6+ roll does not pass.

APPENDIX C - LIST OF PLAY MATERIAL

This appendix section lists all materials needed for a game of Firelock 198X. While printable tokens are bundled with this manual, basic designs are suggested below for making your own.

0. A table with a map! See **CHAPTERS 4 & 5**.

1. Round tokens made of any material (plastic or cardboard are recommended), ideally somewhere from 15mm to 25mm wide, in the following colors and quantities:

Command: Faction color, many as possible.
Pin: Purple, 6 per unit (if not using dice)
Depletion: Brown, 1 per infantry squad
Airborne: Cyan, 1 per helicopter
Gone to Ground: Green, 1 per infantry unit
Desanting: Magenta, 1 per infantry unit
Spent Ammo: Black, 1 per weapon
Ground Zero: Yellow, 1 per nuclear weapon
Stationary Fire: Red, 1 per unit
Time-to-target: Orange, 1 per relevant weapon (if not using dice)

As many spotting tokens as possible, color-coded in blue and differentiated by icon:

Spotting: Eye
Counterbattery: Mortar Shell
Designator: Laser Hazard

2. As many dice as you like for rolling hits in faction-appropriate colors, plus enough color-coded dice for your list:

Ammo: Black, 1 per weapon
Pin: Purple, 1 per unit (if not using tokens)
Time-to-target: Red, 1 per relevant weapon (if not using tokens)

Some units have multiple ammo-consuming weapons, so it may be useful to have different colors for distinguishing them.

3. At least five flat circles (old cereal box cardboard works well) for drawing 2", 3", 4", 5", and 6" radii from a single point on the table. If possible, have a few in each listed size.

4. A tape measure, for movement and LOS. It's best if every player has their own.

5. If you do not have models on bases available to represent units, then any tokens of the correct base sizes (40mm x 40mm and 40mm x 60mm) will do. Even still, be creative; illustrate or label them to make it clear what unit each is.

Printable **standees** (folding paper miniatures) are provided for you to create unit representations quickly and cheaply. Consult the following page's instructions.

6. A number of generic blinds equal to that of the units in the match, corresponding one-to-one with their base dimensions, with each unit & corresponding blind identified in your secret army key (e.g. an index card with unit and blind names written on them).

If using flat bases and not standees, the bottom of the base may be used as a blind (marked with its ID). Simply flip the base over to identify the unit. Alternately, you could find a way to freely attach and detach a standee or model into a base (doing so once it's identified).

Blinds or flat token bottoms may also be used for husk and corpse bases.

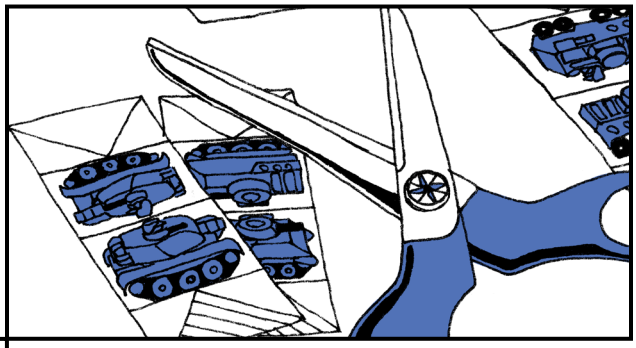
7. Up to 5 paper or cardboard mission cards with distinct fronts and backs, in faction colors. Official printable cards available as well.

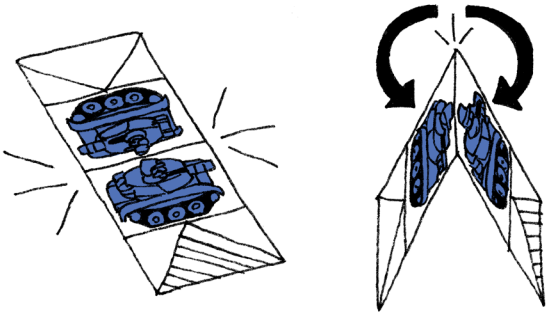
8. Factional special rules may mandate the use of extra materals not mentioned in the core rules. Always consult your army's field manual when preparing materials for your match.

YOU NEED: SCISSORS - SCHOOL GLUE - 3/8” WASHERS - STANDEE SHEETS - A PLACE TO DRY

1.

Cut out the standees from the left side of the page. Reserve unused space on the right side to use as a glue mat later. Every official standee sheet has a marked space for this (a "drying barracks" or the like).



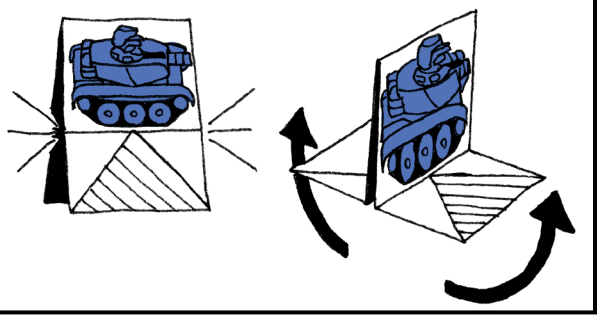


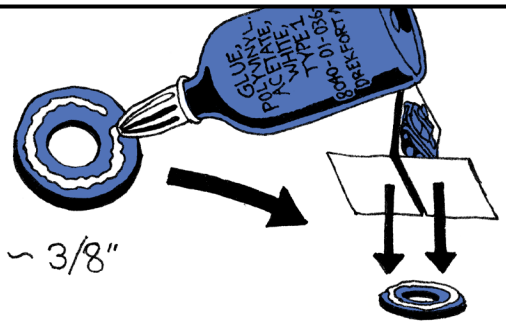
2.

Fold the standee down the middle, at the center fold line.

3.

Fold at the the front and back fold lines, first folding inward (so you can see the line on the outside), then outward to make a T-shape. Now, looking from above, you should be able to make out the unit base and its arcs.



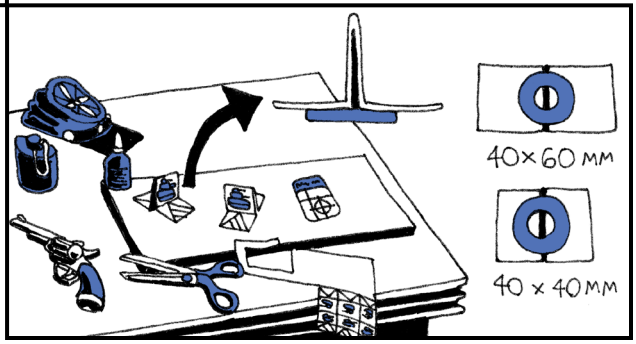


4.

Grab a washer and squeeze a thin circle of school glue onto it, then paste the washer onto the bottom of the standee, keeping the T-shape from coming open. Don’t add too much glue.

5.

Place the standee upright in your drying area. If you don’t have a proper glue mat, this is where the paper from the first step comes in handy. Give it about 1-2 hours to dry if possible.



APPENDIX D - TERRAIN & STRUCTURE TYPE LIST

This appendix section lists all terrain and structure types that can be used in game maps.

Suggested colors (if you're not using detailed models) are listed, plus terrain type symbols. A color swatch is provided in the background color of the header. Descriptions are suggestive. You are encouraged to make whatever suits your imagination.

As a rule of thumb, structures should be able to fit at least three infantry bases inside. Buildings should never be larger than this to prevent infantry from "teleporting" through them.

PLAINS TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: 0 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0" Inf / 0" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: 1

Suggested Visuals: Light green; felt surface; your backyard. The "default" terrain type.

ROAD TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: 0 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0" Inf / 0" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: 2

Suggested Visuals: Light gray; smooth surface; yellow lines or cracked asphalt.

DUNES TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: -1 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0" Inf / 0" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: 1

Suggested Visuals: Tan; rolling heaps of sand. Your desert.

FIELDS TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 1
Cover Modifier: 0 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0" Inf / 0" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: 1

Note: Wheeled pays 0" to enter, helicopters may land, heavy indirect weapons may fire, and partial shadow does *not* provide cover.
Suggested Visuals: Yellow-green; grass, shrubs.

DEAD GROUND TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: -1 Inf / -1 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 1" Inf / 1" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: 1

Note: Infantry inside considered in ambush.
Suggested Visuals: Deep yellow-green, or a physical depression in the terrain.

ROCKY GROUND TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: -2 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 1" Inf / 0" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: Inaccessible

Suggested Visuals: Medium gray, or dense, jagged rocks which preclude vehicles.

FOREST TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 2
Cover Modifier: -1 Inf / -1 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0" Inf / 0" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: ½

Suggested Visuals: Green; tree miniatures.

DENSE FOREST TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 3
Cover Modifier: -2 Inf / -2 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0" Inf / 0" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: ¼

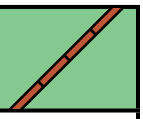
Suggested Visuals: Dark green; tree miniatures.

FLATTENED FOREST TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: -1 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0" Inf / 0" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: ½

Note: Replaces both Forest and Dense Forest.
Suggested Visuals: Green-brown; stumps or overturned trees.

WALLS TERRAIN TYPE



Occlusion Height: 1, 2, or 3
Cover Modifier: N/A
Entrance & Exit Cost: Inaccessible
Vehicle Multiplier: Inaccessible

Note: Impassable by ground units. Provides terrain shadow. Infantry may scale if H1.
Suggested Visuals: Brick red; hewn stone.

WOODEN BUILDING STRUCTURE TYPE

Structure Height: 1, 2, or 3
Cover Modifier: -1

Suggested Visuals: Wooden civilian infrastructure. Rural housing, huts, barns, so on.

STURDY BUILDING STRUCTURE TYPE

Structure Height: 1, 2, or 3
Cover Modifier: -2

Suggested Visuals: Larger, sturdier buildings or industrial halls of stone, metal, or concrete.

TOWER STRUCTURE TYPE

Structure Height: 4
Cover Modifier: -1

Note: Garrisons only one unit (not *Tercios*).
Suggested Visuals: Tall, thin turret or minaret.

BUILDING RUINS STRUCTURE TYPE

Structure Height: 1
Cover Modifier: -1 (wooden), -2 (sturdy)

Note: Cover Modifier corresponds to the type of building the ruin was before the blast.
Suggested Visuals: Ruined, roofless buildings.

ENTRENCHMENT TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: -2 Inf / -2 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 1" Inf / 2" Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: ½

Note: Units within are in ambush.
Suggested Visuals: Dark brown; ditches.

SHALLOW WATER
WATER TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: 0 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0” Inf / 0” Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: 1

Notes: Accessible to all units including *Amphibious* and *Watercraft*.
Suggested Visuals: Light blue; fordable water.

DEEP WATER
WATER TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: 0 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0” Inf / 0” Vec*
Vehicle Multiplier: 2**

Notes: Inaccessible save for units with *Amphibious* and *Watercraft*.
Suggested Visuals: Deep blue; waves or surf.

**Amphibious* units pay 1” to enter and exit, but not *Watercraft*.

***Only *Watercraft* get double movement, not *Amphibious*.

SWAMP
WATER TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: 0 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0” Inf / 0” Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: ½

Note: Accessible to all units. Infantry also affected by this terrain's Vehicle Multiplier.
Suggested Visuals: Blue-green; murky, grassy-forested water.

BRIDGE
TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: 0 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0” Inf / 0” Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: 2

Notes: May pass over water.*
Suggested Visuals: Hatched light gray; sturdy steel or earthen bridge.

FOOTBRIDGE
TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: 0 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0” Inf / 0” Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: Inaccessible

Notes: May pass over water. Permits only infantry to cross it.*
Suggested Visuals: Hatched brown; wooden plank and rope bridge.

*If a unit ends its movement under this terrain by entering the water-side, it is considered to be in ambush.

VOID
TERRAIN TYPE

Occlusion Height: 0
Cover Modifier: 0 Inf / 0 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost: 0” Inf / 0” Vec
Vehicle Multiplier: Inaccessible

Notes: Inaccessible to all land units. If a land unit somehow ends up in the void, it’s gone.
Suggested Visuals: Steep or bottomless pits, the edges of floating islands.

APPENDIX E - UNIT CLASS QUICK REFERENCE

This appendix section recaps all traits special to the game's unit classes.

Infantry

- Infantry bases are 40mm x 40mm (multiple troops).
- Can be a **team** or a **squad**. Squads can survive one kill roll, becoming **depleted**. Squads *immediately* **overkill** without depleting if hit with 8x Strength to their Toughness.
- Can **sprint**, **go to ground**, and **garrison** structures.
- Can rotate for free.
- Retains ambush after firing.
- Suffers -1" Movement per each pin token, and -1 Accuracy for each two pin tokens.
- Can **clear** emplacements in Upkeep.
- Can avoid triggering traps by moving a total of 2" or less in total.
- Can **encircle** unscreened vehicles in Close Combat.
- Can **screen** friendly vehicles in Close Combat against encirclement.
- Can **embark** on *PC* vehicles. May **desant** on any vehicle unless otherwise stated.

Vehicles

- Bases are 40mm x 60mm (one vehicle).
- Can be **tracked**, **wheeled**, or **carriages**.
- Affected by vehicle multiplier (unless a carriage).
- Pays 1" to rotate 90 degrees and 2" to rotate 180 degrees during a move action. Pays 2" per 1" reversed. Carriages rotate for free.
- Carriages can move after unhitching.
- Wheeled pays an extra 1" to enter/exit occluding terrain but may **road dash**.
- Loses concealment/ambush after firing.
- Suffers -1 Accuracy per two pin tokens.
- Cannot enter structures, but can enter close combat with the infantry inside.
- Cannot fire while infantry are desanting.
- Gains -1 Cover Modifier from **hull down**.

Aircraft

- Bases are 40mm x 60mm (one aircraft).
- Must be **landed** or **airborne**, marked with a **helicopter token**.
- When landed, can be targeted in close combat, counts as a vehicle, and cannot fire weapons other than *Door Guns*.
- Pay 1" per full 45 degrees rotated.
- Pays 4" to **take off** or **land**. Cannot do both in the same turn.
- When airborne, has infinite height, and always has **vantage**.
- Cannot land in most occluding terrain.
- LOS to airborne units can be broken by concealment and terrain shadow.
- Does not use Cover Modifier.
- Loses concealment after firing.
- Suffers -1 Accuracy per two pin tokens.
- Gains -1 Cover Modifier from **intervening cover**.
- Hits against airborne units must be **confirmed**, unless by *Anti-Air*, *Guided Missiles*, or other aircraft.
- Aircraft and ground units cannot enter close combat with each other.

Planes (Subset of Aircraft)

- Can be **CAS** or **CAP**. CAS cannot target other planes as mission targets. CAP gets +3 to initiative in dogfights.
- Called onto the table from **reserve** by **support missions** during Support Phase.
- Always count as spotted.
- Vulnerable to **close-in fire**.
- May **dogfight** other planes.
- May fire any weapon at their mission target, or a *Guided Missile* at another plane.
- May only be targeted by *Guided Missiles* and *Anti-Air*.

APPENDIX F - KILL ROLL & MODIFIER TABLES

This table plots kill roll target numbers for Strength vs. Toughness matchups for values from 1- to 20 as a quick reference. Strength and Toughness values may sometimes exceed 20.

ATTACKER'S WEAPON STRENGTH \ TARGET'S TOUGHNESS	1-	1	1+	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20
1-	4+	5+	5+	6+	6+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+
1	3+	4+	5+	6+	6+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+
1+	3+	3+	4+	6+	6+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+
2	2+	2+	2+	4+	5+	6+	6+	6+	6+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+
3	2+	2+	2+	3+	4+	5+	5+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+
4	1+	1+	1+	2+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	7+	7+	7+	7+	7+
5	1+	1+	1+	2+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	7+
6	1+	1+	1+	2+	2+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+
7	1+	1+	1+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+
8	++	++	++	1+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	6+	6+	6+	6+	6+
9	++	++	++	1+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	6+	6+	6+
10	++	++	++	1+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	6+
11	++	++	++	1+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+
12	++	++	++	1+	1+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+
13	++	++	++	1+	1+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+
14	++	++	++	1+	1+	2+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+
15	++	++	++	1+	1+	2+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+	5+
16	++	++	++	++	1+	1+	2+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+	5+
17	++	++	++	++	1+	1+	2+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+	5+
18	++	++	++	++	1+	1+	2+	2+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+	5+
19	++	++	++	++	1+	1+	2+	2+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+	5+
20	++	++	++	++	1+	1+	1+	2+	2+	2+	2+	2+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	3+	4+

BLIND-FIRE TARGET NUMBER	
Unspotted target:	6+
Scoped not targeting through ***Smoke***:	4+
Radar Anti-Air targeting Air (including through ***Smoke***):	4+

Weapons without the Anti-Air rule have to confirm hits against airborne units.

TO-HIT MODIFIERS	
Attacker at half range:	+1
Target spotted through ***Smoke****: *6 always hits if not also pinned.	-1
Per 2 pin on attacker*: *Per 1 pin if ***MCLOS***.	-1

TO-KILL MODIFIERS	
Strength > Toughness with ***Shaped Charge***:	+1
Per 1 Cover Modifier after ***Ignore Cover (X)****: *6 always kills, if target number was not 7+.	-1

Remember! *Blind-fire doesn't get positive modifiers. Add negative modifiers last. If base accuracy is lower than blind-fire target number, roll at base accuracy.*

F-1 - KILL ROLL & MODIFIER TABLES

APPENDIX G - CORE RULES RECAP

This two-page appendix summarizes Chapter 4 for quick reference during a match.

DEPLOYMENT, p. 5-1

Roll initiative. Take turns moving your army onto the table. Place units with their rear arc touching your board edge, then move them onto the table normally (see **III. MANEUVER PHASE, p. 5-12**). Keep in mind:

- Units can sprint, road dash, and deploy while being towed, embarked, or desanting on a vehicle, but can't *Brigade*.
- Embarked or desanting infantry can disembark and move away from their carrier as a move of their own on a separate turn. Whether it has units desanting on it,
- All units *must* deploy, unless stated otherwise.
- Deploying doesn't cost command tokens.

After standard deployment, units with the *Paradrop* rule may **parachute** anywhere on the board (with some restrictions). They can't be spotted by enemies or be within 8" of an enemy unit, deployment zone, board edge, or objective. They gain 2 pin if landing within half range of an Air or All-targeting weapon that can possibly kill them (ignoring terrain shadow).

After deployment, check LOS, spotting, and identification then resolve close combat.

I. SUPPORT PHASE, p. 5-3

If playing with a round timer, advance the timer by one now.

1. Upkeep. Remove pin and stationary fire tokens. Roll to kill units in *Lingering* clouds, then roll to linger. Declare all *Resupply*.

2. Generate **command tokens**. Keep your total number a secret.

3. Declare **missions**. Take turns passing or activating a TACOM to reveal a support card. One turn per TACOM.

4. Take turns **declaring targets** or withdrawing support cards. Draw **strafing lines** between plane **entry points** and the mission's target, if any were called.

5. Declare **close-in fire** on incoming planes. One per TACOM that didn't act in step two.

6. Remove **counterbattery tokens**.

II. FIRE PHASE. p. 5-6

Place planes on their strafing lines at the point on the table edge closest to the calling TACOM, if any planes were called in during the Support Phase. Then, take turns following the turn sequence:

1. Remove **time-to-target tokens** from attacks declared by you in a previous turn.

2. Resolve **time-to-target attacks** if any token stacks hit zero in the previous step.

3. Move forward every **plane** you own for its full Movement statistic. Stop to **dive** when you make basal contact with the target. On its next obligatory movement, it must overshoot.

4. Resolve **dogfights** that occur from basal contact between opposing planes.

5. Declare (and resolve, if landing immediately) all free attacks from diving planes and close-in shots.

6. Declare your main **fire action** from any unit other than diving planes. Resolve it immediately if not time-to-target.

Remember the unit classes. Infantry make best use of cover and concealment; vehicles make the best use of roads; aircraft can land and have vantage while airborne.

Consult **APPENDICES A & B** for a recap on all special rules and **APPENDIX E** for all special traits of the different unit classes.

To **declare** a fire action:

1. Choose a unit that will fire.

2. Choose a weapon, target, ammo type(s), whether you are firing stationary or moving, and measure range.

3. Identify the firer unless a special rule indicates you don't have to.

To **resolve** a fire action:

1. Roll to hit. Use the weapon's Accuracy for the target number unless blind-firing at an unspotted target (then, 6+ with no positive modifiers). +1 within half range; -1 if enemy spotted but through Smoke; -1 per two pin tokens on firer. Track each hit roll separately.

2. Roll to kill. Each hit is a separate chance to kill. +1 to kill roll if eligible with Shaped Charge. Apply Cover Modifier if present. See **APPENDIX F**.

3. Apply pin tokens if not killed. One pin per missed die; three per failed kill.

Remember:

- **Time to target** attacks (including Guided Missiles and Indirect) do not resolve on the same turn they were declared. They use the firer's pin when the attack resolves, not when it was fired. Neither gain Accuracy bonuses from half range.
  » *Guided Missiles* lose one time-to-target token within half range.
  » *Heavy Indirect* requires a fire mission on a target, or its own LOS; Light Indirect doesn't require fire missions.
- **Radii** hit any unit whose base center is covered. Friendly fire counts as spotted!

III. MANEUVER PHASE, p. 5-12

First, do any obligatory moves before entering the main phase (e.g. luparic *Bloodlust*).

Second, take turns spending command tokens to **move** or **brigade move**. Units with the *Brigade (X, Y")* special rule can move up to *X* friendlies (spending one command token for the whole) alongside themselves, so long as the friendlies start and end within *Y*" of the brigadier (who also moves, and so spends its turn).

Note terrain Entrance/Exit Costs and Vehicle Multipliers. See **CHAPTER 6.**

A unit that moves into basal contact with an enemy, and can enter close combat, is said to **charge**. If it can't enter close combat, it can't be placed in basal contact. Aircraft can't charge ground units.

Make note of special actions you can declare for a unit. Consult **APPENDIX E**.

IV. IDENTIFICATION PHASE, p. 5-15

Make sure to re-check which units are **spotted** or **identified** after the Maneuver Phase. Consult **CHAPTER 6**.

V. CLOSE COMBAT PHASE, p. 5-16

Take turns picking close combats to resolve. Close combats consist of repeating, simultaneous **beats** until one side wins.

- All units in mutual basal contact may spot, draw LOS to, and fire at one another regardless of *Smoke*. No Cover Modifiers apply. All attacks at stationary Accuracy, and with half range Accuracy and Strength.
- Infantry encircle enemy vehicles unless those vehicles are screened.
- Aircraft may not fight close combat with ground units.

Instead of firing, a unit can **reform** or **fall back** on its turn in a beat. When one side wins, it **overrun moves** 2" with free rotation.

VI. OBJECTIVE PHASE, p. 5-18

Check to see who is winning. Advance any victory counters (if the scenario has them) and resolve relevant effects.

END OF ROUND - RINSE, REPEAT

APPENDIX H - OPTIONAL RULES

This appendix lists some optional house rules which can be used to shake up a standard match or be integrated into a scenario.

OPTIONAL RULES

i. Deployment Zones

Rather than deploying from the table edge and marching toward the enemy, agree upon a number of inches from the deployment edge which is to be each player's deployment zone. Alternate placing units directly into your zones without deployment moves.

ii. Target Confirmation

Unless a unit has fired a weapon or been designated, units may only be identified during the Identification Phase.

iii. Reinforcements

Each player holds a certain amount of his force in reserve. During any Support Phase, a player can use a TACOM to call a mission to deploy a number of reserve units equal to that TACOM's *Brigade* number from his deployment edge.

Other conditions for the deployment of reinforcements from reserve can be negotiated according to context.

Reinforcements which are called automatically, based on the status of an objective or a round timer, may enter the board doing a standard deployment move during the Objective Phase.

Not recommended for low-point games.

iv. Low-profile

Units in the force are in **low-profile**, laying low to avoid detection. Units in low profile cannot spot enemy units. In exchange, the first attack against a unit that is in low-profile is forced to become a blind-fire, even if the target is currently spotted. A unit exits low-profile after the first attack against it resolves.

Units can also exit low-profile when objectives are met or based on other conditions which are appropriate to the scenario.

Recommended for asymmetrical, attack-defense battles and battles where the enemy force may need more time to maneuver into position without being spotted.

v. Information Warfare

Each player receives a number of free dummies equal to the sum of all of their army list's command tokens.

Each player also has double the amount of available command tokens, but half of these tokens are "fake tokens" which are used exclusively for activating dummies.

vi. Dicey Firefights

Infantry cannot both charge and disembark from a carrier on the same turn unless doing an *Assault Dismount* (see **FM 100-1-8X - APPENDIX A**). Enemies may draw LOS to and spot concealed units from up to 2" away regardless of terrain.

vii. Crew Bailout

Whenever a vehicle (or aircraft, if desired) suffers a successful kill roll, a second roll at the same target number as the original kill roll is made to see if the crew inside of the vehicle are also killed.

If the kill roll on the crew fails, they successfully bail out. Place a "Vehicle Crew" unit from that faction's respective army book somewhere in full basal contact with the dead vehicle's husk and apply three pin to that unit.

Vehicle Crews may bail out during Close Combat, in which case they are considered to be fighting from the position of their former vehicle's husk until the close combat concludes and they may overrun out of it. Crews which bail during close combat do not gain three pin when they are placed on the board.

Construct vehicles do not produce Vehicle Crews when they die.

viii. Unit Morale

Units must make **morale checks** with a target number equal to 6 minus its Quality.

Units at max pin in the Fire Phase must make a morale check, or else be forced to **retreat** directly toward the player's deployment edge at the end of the Maneuver Phase as an automatic move, costing no command.

If a unit is in close combat for more rounds than it has Quality, it must make a morale check, or else be forced to fall back.

ix. Night Fighting

All Spotting Distances are halved. Units are not identified until they are spotted, so all weapons may fire without identifying the firer; counterbattery and designation do not automatically identify. When a unit fires stationary, it may be spotted at full spotting distance, but only until the beginning of the next Fire Phase.

Units with *Thermal Sights*, and any luparic unit (see **FM 100-2-8X**), get their full Spotting Distance. Weapons with smoke shells (other than Smoke Launchers) gain an "Illumination" ammunition type with the *Lingering* rule and a *Radius* equal to that weapon's smoke shell. Units within this radius may be spotted at the normal distance.

x. Nuclear Exchange

Each player is given access to a single tactical *Nuclear (4"-8"-24")* missile at the beginning of the third round to be called as a mission by a TACOM in the Support Phase. They may withhold its use to subsequent Support Phases. Further nuclear missiles cannot be purchased.

To employ a tactical nuclear missile, declare you are launching it (with the appropriate severity). Select a TACOM to call the mission (as if they were calling a fire mission) to place a **ground zero token**. See **FM 1-8X - APPENDIX I** for what happens next.

xi. Finite Smoke

Rather than rolling 4+ for *Lingering* during Upkeep, roll a D3 for every *Lingering* radius on the board after the shot lands. The die result is the number of rounds that the cloud will persist. Reduce every *Lingering* die by 1 every ensuing Support Phase. When the die hits 0, remove the radius.

Adds certainty to lingering weapons, enabling more precise counterplay.

USING OPTIONAL RULES

These optional rules can be used to put an interesting twist on the generic objectives described in the forepart of **FM 1-8X-2**. They may also be utilized as part of advanced narrative scenarios.

APPENDIX I - NUCLEAR WEAPONS

This appendix contains all rules relating to the use of nuclear weapons and the special interactions between nuclear weapons, units, and terrain.

USING NUCLEAR WEAPONS

Nuclear weapons are an optional gameplay feature designed for high-point games and certain scenarios. Low-yield nuclear weapons may also be fired by certain expensive special units. It is not advisable to deploy them in small-scale games as their effect is destructive to tightly-clustered forces.

Some nuclear weapons are launched by on-map units. These cannot be reloaded.

NUCLEAR WEAPON EFFECTS

Nuclear weapons have three radius effects: fireball, overpressure, and thermal radiation. These three radii all extend from the same point on the ground: **ground zero**. Units within only suffer one effect at a time. Place a **ground zero token** where the nuke has landed.

First, a nuclear fireball extends from ground zero. Everything other than planes in the radius—units, structures, and terrain—is wiped clean. Leave the ground zero token to indicate the radius of new **scorched terrain**:

SCORCHED EARTH TERRAIN TYPE	
Occlusion Height:	0
Cover Modifier:	-2 Inf / -2 Vec
Entrance & Exit Cost:	1” Inf / 2” Vec
Vehicle Multiplier:	½

Note: Non-NBC units suffer two automatic 6+ kill rolls in Upkeep while inside.

Suggested Visuals: Deep, scorched red or black.

Scorched terrain presents a high radiation hazard. Any non-*NBC* unit standing on scorched ground during Upkeep suffers two automatic 6+ to-kill rolls. No pin tokens are generated if this fails.

Past the fireball, units suffer from overpressure. Structures and forests of any kind are replaced with Building Ruins and Flattened Forest, respectively, while fields, walls, bridges, and roads are removed completely (see **APPENDIX D**). All non-plane units within radius suffer a number of 6+ kill rolls equal to six reduced by Cover Modifier. Survivors receive max pin.

Past overpressure, units suffer from thermal radiation. All non-plane units suffer a number of 6+ kill rolls equal to D6 reduced by double their Cover Modifier. Survivors receive max pin.

A standard tactical nuclear missile has 4” of fireball, 8” of overpressure, and 24” of thermal radiation, i.e. *Nuclear (4”-8”-24”)*. For perspective, its thermal radiation spans the entire short edge of a standard 6' x 4' table.

ON-MAP NUCLEAR WEAPONS

Some on-map units carry lower-yield weapons with the *Nuclear* special trait. Because of the destructive effect of these weapons, they require a complex sequence of actions to arm. Being pinned can cause their crews to fail.

As nuclear weapons have a tremendous area-of-effect, it is impossible for them to truly “miss”; their accuracies are always A++. However, a unit with more pin than its Quality statistic *must* pass a separate 4+ roll to successfully arm and deliver the payload when the attack is resolved. If this roll fails, the firer's turn is spent and the weapon’s ammo is refunded. Next round it may try again.

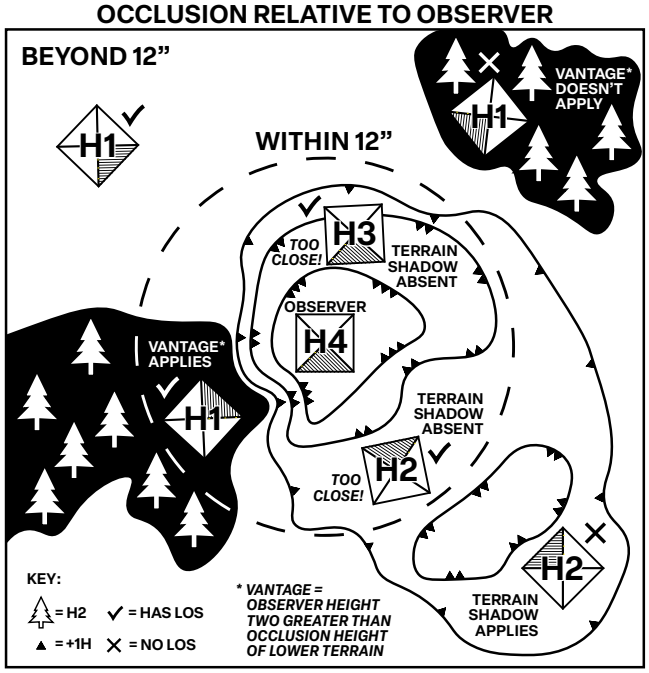
STRATEGIC NUCLEAR WEAPONS

Firelock 198X accurately models the effects of high-yield strategic nuclear weapons. If at any point such a weapon detonates on the table, sweep the entirety of its contents onto the floor and shake hands with your opponent.

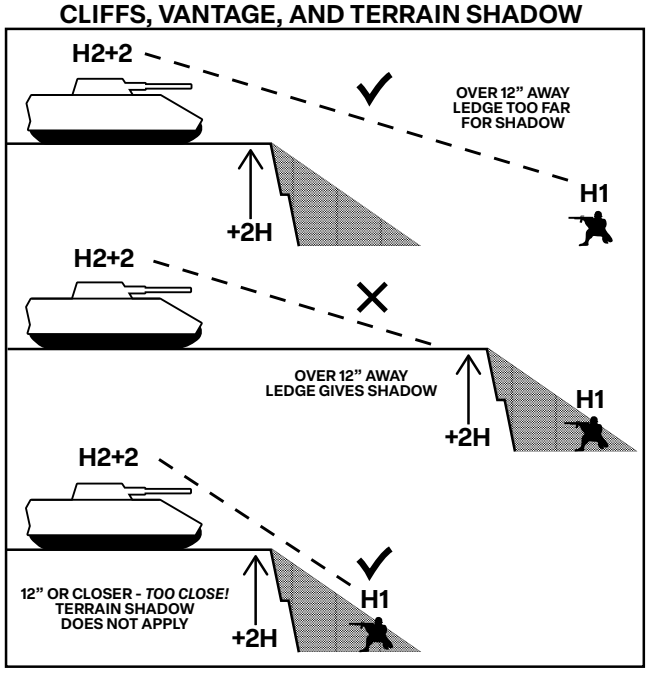
APPENDIX J - LINE-OF-SIGHT VISUAL RECAP

This image uses the applied rules of height, vantage, and shadow to create a visual recap of information about LOS from Chapter 5. It may be used as a learning tool before your first game, or as a quick reference during play for determining whether units have LOS to one another.

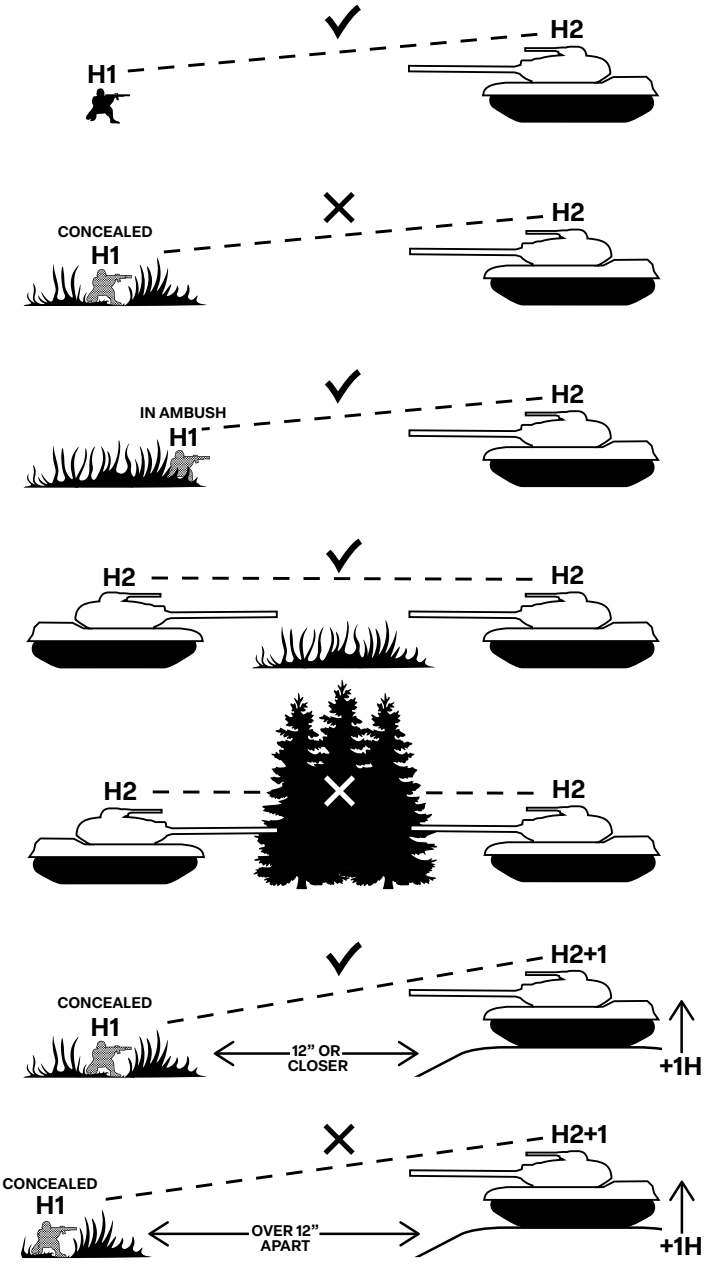
OCCLUSION RELATIVE TO OBSERVER



CLIFFS, VANTAGE, AND TERRAIN SHADOW



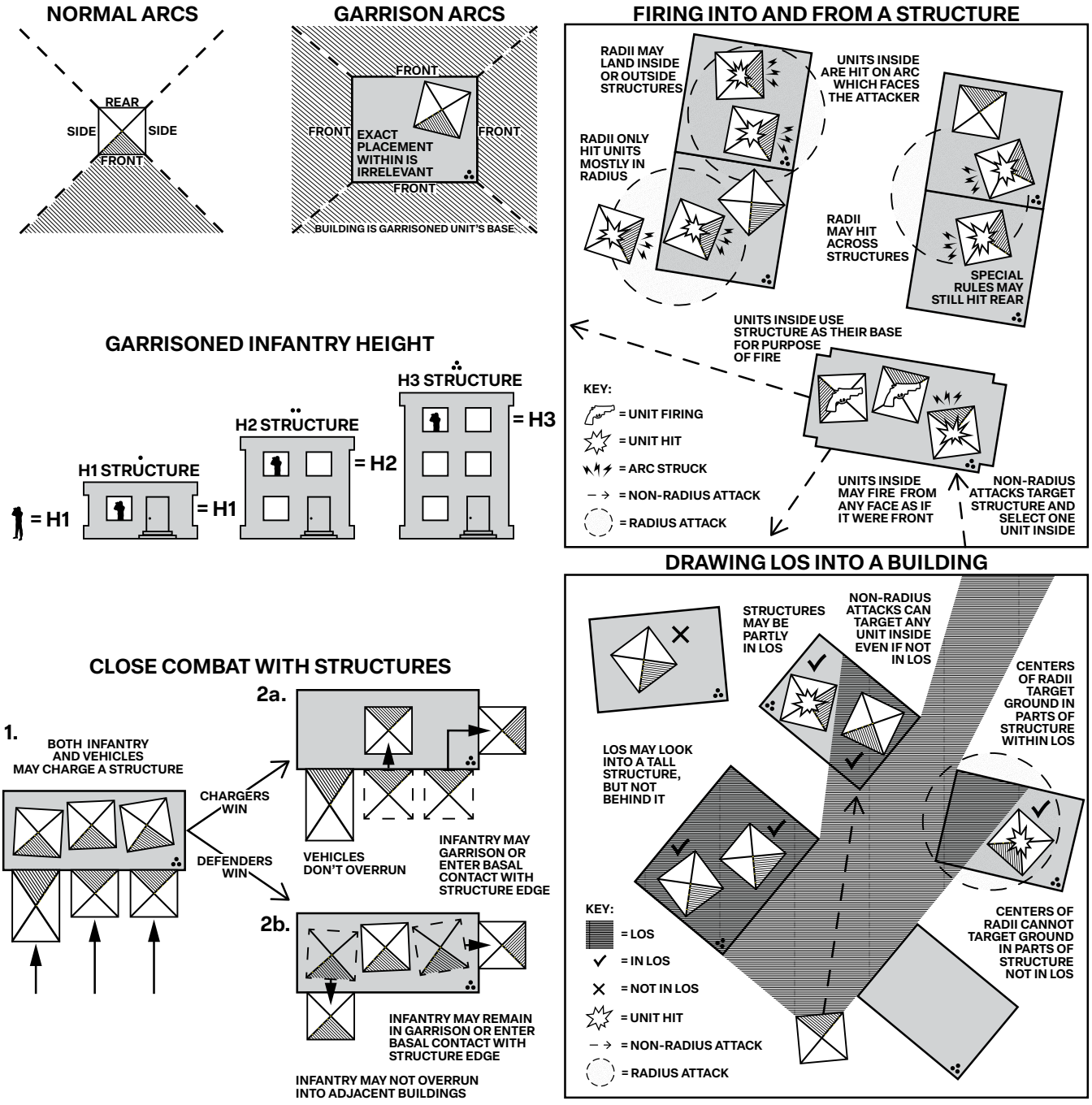
COMPARING HEIGHT TO CHECK FOR OCCLUSION



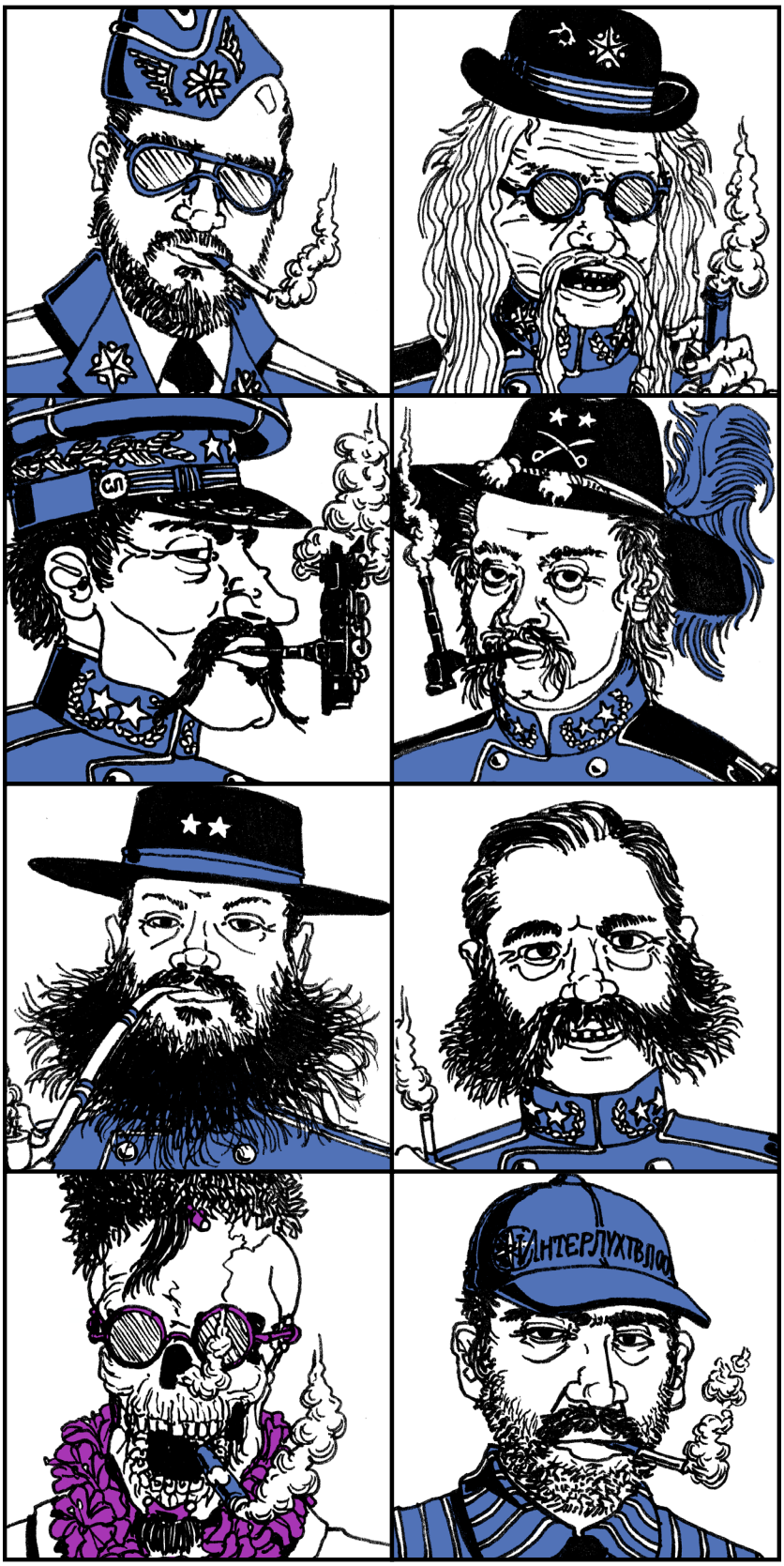
This chart only pertains to LOS, *not spotting!* Remember, it is possible to see something without spotting it. Check the Spotting Distance and consider vantage, concealment, and ambush before declaring a that unit is spotted. Vantage always allows *mutual* LOS within 12".

APPENDIX K - GARRISON VISUAL RECAP

This image uses the applied rules of garrisoning to create a visual recap of information about buildings from Chapter 5. It may be used as a learning tool before your first game or as a quick reference during play for determining how LOS and movement are affected by buildings.



Remember to always consult special rules. *Rear Attack* and *Heavy/Light Indirect* are the only two ways that garrisoned units are not hit in the front.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